



summer swap

KT MORRISON

SUMMER SWAP

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

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All characters are over the age of eighteen.

SUMMER SWAP

A Hotwife Swinger Novel

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PROLOGUE

Penny slid her roller chair close to Cheyenne's workstation so she could whisper a confidential question. "How rich is Cody, anyway?"

Cheyenne rolled her head toward Penny, a chewed up pen sticking in one side of her mouth. She regarded Penny, one eyebrow raised. Yes, Cody was rich, but the question seemed to have come out of nowhere and needed more context. When Penny stared and offered no more, Cheyenne said, "I don't know. Pretty rich, I guess. Why?"

"How much does it cost to rent a yacht for two weeks?"

"Oh," Cheyenne said, removed the pen from her mouth and tossed it underneath her iMac. She stretched, and then checked her watch. Two hours until go-time. She said, "We all pay our own way. The yacht belongs to a friend of Cody's, but we all chip in."

Though the truth was, Cody and Carla *might* be paying more. They *were* getting the suite with the attached bathroom, after all. No one called Cody and Carla on it because it *was* suspected that Cody might be floating more of the bill than the rest of them. Byron loved to do math in his head, and laying in bed a few nights ago, Byron told her he thought Cody probably

paid half, and the other seven of them split the other half. Byron suspected Cody paid almost eighty-grand for the charter.

Penny said to herself, “I bet it’s like two-hundred thousand.”

“I don’t think it’s that much,” Cheyenne said. “And we’re paying our *own* way.”

“Cody is so hot,” Penny said, again muttering it to herself, chair still butted up against Cheyenne’s, her eyes staring off dreamily out the tall transom windows. “I listen to his podcast. He’s hilarious.”

Cheyenne said to Penny: “What could you find interesting about a bunch of ex-soldiers talking about politics and guns?” Penny wore baggy grandfather cardigans, wool skirts, and vintage chambray work-shirts she buttoned right up to the collar. Her nose was pierced, her arms and hands completely tattooed with a dark-fantasy nautical theme, long hair but with a fringe of micro-bangs cut only about an inch long. This made room for the enormous librarian glasses she wore.

Penny shrugged. “It’s not my style, but I feel like I know the guy.”

“He’s come by here a *handful* of times.”

“I know. But we talk.”

Cheyenne regarded Penny—her star employee—and waited for her to come out of her reverie. When Penny finally looked her way, Cheyenne said, “Thank you for your service.”

Penny rolled her eyes and looked offended. “They talk about more than just war and politics.”

“Cody’s married, Penny. You know I know him through his wife, right?”

“Yeah-yeah, you went to school with her. Sorority sisters.”

“No. Well, kind of. We weren’t the same sorority, just the same campus. Cody’s in love with Carla,” she said, intending it to be the end of the conversation about the attractiveness of her friend’s husband, rolling back to her workstation to get some work done before it was time to leave for the airport. But she wheeled the chair back toward Penny to add: “And Carla’s the kind of girl you wouldn’t want to cross.”

Penny said, “Cody’s hot, but so are his *friends*.”

Carla’s husband, Cody Weber, invested in a watch company after he got out of the army and the company took off. All their friends watched this guy they used to know as a soldier, who was married to one of the girls, become a multi-millionaire. Carla did well on her own, selling Manhattan real estate, but when Cody’s dad passed away, the Weber brothers divvied up their modest inheritance and Cody took his whole stash and gambled it on a business startup with some special forces guys he knew. The startup was a military watch company. Now the company did more than watches, had a big social media presence, and Cody had become a sort of underground celebrity.

Cheyenne said, “I’ll put in a good word for you. But those guys don’t seem your type, Penny.”

Penny stared at her screen, a swooping black velvet swatch over a royal purple background, and said, “I think I’m tired of my type. I wouldn’t mind a guy who hates New York and has his shit together.”

* * *

The flight left in three hours and they were still an hour from LaGuardia. And Chey wasn’t even in the car yet. Outside the Uber’s windows, Tribeca foot-traffic bustled along past the graffiti-scrawled walls and down the fire-

escape alley that divided Chey's building from her neighbor. Byron sat in the back sending emails from his phone, dealing with last minute stuff from the office and working with the general contractor building their new place in Westchester. Last thing he wanted, going away on a yacht vacation in the Virgin Islands, was dealing with general contractor headaches. He'd set up a schedule of minor milestones for the GC to accomplish over the next two weeks, things that wouldn't need consultation. The next two weeks were about very few things. Eating, drinking, swimming, sleeping, drinking, sunning, and drinking. Maybe some snorkeling and some scuba.

It'd been a while since the whole crew got together. Times changed fast. Four years ago, they all lived in the same neighborhood, saw each other down at the Blue Bottle or The Knitting Club, three nights a week at least. It sucked getting older. Despite how many great things were going on in all their lives, those early post-college days were pretty golden.

He set his phone down, smiling, then looking out the window. Still no Chey. He groaned and rubbed his forehead.

The Uber driver said, "Plenty of time still."

"She can be a little late or a lot of late. You never can tell with her."

Cheyenne and two of her friends from their former Park Avenue design workplace, branched out on their own, doing designs for garment companies, specializing in sneakers and sneaker collaborations. They'd got themselves a second floor office in a Franklin Street five-story, and a handful of decent clients, and put out the word *Bergamôt* was in town. He didn't get the *accent circonflexe*, but Chey assured him it was cool and had powerful symbolic meaning.

The Uber driver said, "That her?"

Byron scooted between the front seats to look out the window. A young woman with long chestnut hair had bounded out of the building on the north side of Franklin, arms splayed out in the pose of apology. Cheyenne saw him in the Uber and mouthed a theatrical *Sorry* as she waited for a car to pass on the one-way so she could cross to the Uber.

“That’s her,” he said, chuckling. His cute and design-savvy—but also somehow tomboyish—wife trotted across Franklin to the driver-side rear door. Byron shoved it open for her. Chey jumped in, all long and skinny legs in black denim, sporting all-white Japanese sneakers. She darted him a kiss and pulled the door closed. “You bring all my stuff?”

“In the trunk, Chey,” he said as the Uber driver pulled the Tesla into traffic and got them heading out of lower Manhattan. Fuck, he hoped it wasn’t going to be tight—he hated getting stressed about shit like that.

“Oh my God, I’m so excited,” she said, breathy, settling into the seats and looking out at the pedestrians as they right-turned onto Lafayette. Byron took her hand and held it between them. Chey leaned forward and said to the driver, “Be honest, did he trash talk me while he was waiting? Saying how I was going to be late.”

The Uber driver said, “He said only kind things,” but gave Cheyenne a wink like they both knew it was a fib.

“I’ll bet,” she said, settling in next to Byron again, smiling to herself. “I need this vacation so bad.”

“Me too,” he said to her, leaning in to kiss her temple.

“Did you get the thing straightened out about the garage floor foundation or whatever?”

“I did—”

“You know they called me, right?”

I know.”

“Said he couldn’t get an answer from you, and they needed to—”

“It’s all taken care of now, Chey,” he said soothingly, stroking his thumb on her palm. “I put them on autopilot for the next two weeks so we can just relax.”

“Oh man, I’m so stressed, babe,” she said, running her hair back with her free hand. “I need to relax.”

“We’ve got two weeks with our friends in the Caribbean. Two weeks of nothing but fun and sun.”

Chey purred a low sound and snuggled to his side. Then she looked up to him. “Not *too* much fun.”

“There’s a limit?”

“Not like the old days, babe,” she said and smiled. “Let’s keep it sensible.”

“Chey,” he reassured her, “We’re adults now. All of us are grown-ups. We’re not twenty-two. We’re practically middle-aged—”

“Hey,” she said, aggravated.

He chuckled. “Thirty is around the corner, babe. Get used to it. All I’m saying is all of us have matured through the years.”

CHAPTER 1

Nine people, forty minutes past midnight, on a hundred-foot luxury yacht on bobbing black water somewhere near Watermelon Cay, off the coast of Saint John. Four married couples, making eight people, plus one man newly divorced, a total of nine, all sitting around a card table on the yacht's fifth-floor deck, the one with the hot tub. Music they listened to in college beat from the stereo system. Littered around their feet and interspersed on their table were the emptied bounty of their awesome sunshine day on the water. Knocked over tubes of sunscreen, the caps popped open. A snorkel. One Flipper. Countless beer cans depleted of their sudsy contents. Empty White Claws. Two drained bottles of Canadian rye. A sopping wet T-shirt. Abandoned flip-flops . . .

Byron looked at his three cards through beer-bleary eyes. Ace of clubs, king of hearts, and the seven of spades . . . The spades were useless. The king might be okay. But if Scarlet had a higher spade, she could beat his king. The rules were complicated in their impromptu card game, and the stakes were high. He did not want to have to choose Truth or Dare.

"By-ron, By-ron, By-ron," his husband-friends were chanting now in a low hushed sound as he contemplated. Some of the wives told them to be quiet.

The girls peered over Scarlet's shoulders, assessing her cards, but they couldn't see Byron's.

When Cheyenne whispered in Scarlet's ear, Sullivan slapped her arm, saying, "No cheating."

"How is it cheating," she said, "if I don't know what Byron has?"

"It doesn't matter if you know what Byron has. Scarlet is going to make this choice by herself."

Cheyenne said, "I wasn't talking about her cards."

"Oh boo-hoo," Sullivan said, "you're such a liar."

"I'm not lying," she said but began to smile.

Byron said, "Stop lying and cheating, Cheyenne."

"Just play your card already," she told him.

He made his decision. He lay down the King. Scarlet wouldn't have what she needed.

Cheyenne smiled, peering over Scarlet's shoulder again, and now Scarlet smiled, too. Scarlet was about as iffy on the rules as he was, but she liked the way Cheyenne smiled. She picked her card and lay it down . . .

* * *

The girls cheered and laughed. Carla pointed a finger at him and sneered in his face. "You fucking lose, Byron!"

The married guys covered their faces and groaned; someone punched him in the arm. He would have to take his lumps.

“Truth or dare, bro?” Cody asked.

It wasn’t going to be truth. His friends—no, the *girls*—were ruthless.

“Dare, I guess.”

Cheyenne said, “Sorry, what was that?” She leaned forward with a hand cupped at her ear.

“Dare,” he said, louder. Then, quieter: “I guess.”

Now he covered his own face in his hands and winced, waiting to hear what they would have to say.

So far this evening, Sullivan had to streak across the deck below them, running down the stairs with his hands on his junk, diving not the yacht’s pool, swimming across, then covering up and running up the opposite staircase. The girls had tossed Pringles and empty beer cans at his naked body from above. Then later Carla had to do it too. And what a boon that had been. Carla had big honkers. All the guys wondered what Carla would look like with her top off (except for her husband Cody)—and then they’d watched tonight in the dim light as Carla trotted stairs and dove and swam. Those big pillowy breasts of hers mashed between her forearms, sometimes swinging around, jostling and jiggling. It had been quite the sight—not to mention what a fucking turn on it was, so long as Cody wouldn’t get mad at them.

Carla leaned next to Scarlet and whispered in her ear, sly eyes on Byron.

Scarlet smiled. “You sure you want a dare, Byron?”

“I don’t want truth,” he said.

Cody said, “Sounds like Byron’s got a mistress.”

There was a lowing sound amongst the crowd, everyone looking at Cheyenne.

Cheyenne scowled at Cody. “You’re such an asshole.”

“I’m kidding,” Cody said.

“I don’t want truth. I’ll take the dare,” Byron said. “And, no, I don’t have a fucking mistress, you idiots.” He smiled at Cheyenne.

Scarlet laced her fingers together and leaned forward, prepared to reveal to him the parameters of his dare. Carla leaned close and repeated her suggestion in Scarlet’s ear. Scarlet said it. “Toilet paper game.”

There was a snicker, everyone else looking around, mystified. *What the hell was the toilet paper game?*

Carla whispered in Scarlet’s ear again.

Scarlet snickered, covered her face, embarrassed. “Toilet paper tube game. Boy, that’s a mouthful.”

“What the hell is a toilet paper tube game?” he said, trying to figure out what he would have to do with a toilet paper tube.

“We need a referee,” Scarlet said, looking to Cheyenne, then shaking her head no. “No, I can’t trust you.”

“Can’t trust me to what?” Cheyenne said.

Then around to Carla again, Scarlet said, “Carla it was your idea, you ref.”

“All right, champ, come on with me,” Carla said, standing up now, wavy hair hanging in damp ringlets. Carla wore a cut-off sweatshirt, and still sported her skimpy bikini bottom. She held out a hand and wiggled her fingers. “Let’s go, Byron.”

“What do I have to do?” Byron said, standing up shakily.

“Oh, this is cruel,” Cody muttered.

Byron looked to Cody. “What is it? What do I have to do?”

Cody laughed.

Byron said to Carla, “I’m not putting the toilet paper tube up my butt, I can tell you right now, we can go back to truth.”

“Your asshole is safe,” Carla said. “But we have to go downstairs.”

* * *

The yacht they’d rented was huge. Seven bedrooms, multiple lounges and dining areas, a gym, a massive kitchen, a cinema, its own pool, hot tub, helipad, a boat garage with jet-skis, and probably cooler stuff he hadn’t even yet seen. They were four couples, plus one divorced dude, Philippe, looking to get away in the middle of the summer, and they all chipped in a decent chunk of cash to rent this yacht—Cody and Carla may have chipped in more. All the amenities were top-notch. Tile floors, marble counters, walnut cabinetry. Carla led him down the steps onto the fourth floor and into the nearest bathroom, holding his hand.

He said, “What are we doing?”

“Just get in here,” Carla said, coming in behind him then closing the bathroom door behind her. The place was luxurious but small and he felt cramped.

“What do I have to do with a toilet paper tube? Or are *you* going to do something?”

“Trust me, I’m not doing anything. I have to be here to verify.”

“Verify what?”

In the trashcan next to the toilet there was an empty roll of toilet paper. Carla plucked up the cardboard tube and said, “These are a standard size, Byron.”

“Right,” he said, still not getting it. “I don’t want to have to drink anything either. I had enough to drink today.”

“What, you think you’re going to shotgun something with a toilet paper tube? Who am I—MacGyver?”

“Oh no,” he said, “do I have to put my dick in it or something?”

Now Carla smiled, pushed the toilet paper tube against his chest. “That’s *exactly* what you have to do.”

“Why?”

“It’s a size test, dummy.”

“So what about my size?”

“Are you worried? It’s too late to choose truth now.”

“I’m not worried,” he said.

“Then put your dick in the tube and let’s see what happens.”

“What the hell is going to happen?”

“It’s a dumb sorority thing we used to do, Byron. Is your boyfriend bigger than a toilet paper tube.”

“That’s a thing?”

“You want your boyfriend to be longer than a toilet paper tube and thicker. Or the other girls will make fun of you.”

“Oh, okay,” Byron said. “I think I can do that.”

“Mr. Braggart. Wow, look at you, a regular porn star. Do I need to back up when you do down that zipper?”

“I’m not a porn star,” he said. “But I think I’m bigger than a toilet paper tube.”

“I don’t know,” she said, taking back the toilet paper tube and examining it. “I think this is like average size. You need to know, looks can be deceiving.”

“A toilet paper tube? It doesn’t look that big.”

“All right then, tiger, show me what you got.”

“I can’t do it with you looking—Cheyenne will fucking kill me.”

“I’m going to turn around. You’re going to put your dick in the tube. Then you tell me and I’ll turn around and take a quick look and then I’m looking away again.”

He looked at her pretty, unblemished face for a long moment, waiting to see if this was a joke. “Fine,” he said at last, “turn around.”

Carla turned around in place, bare feet padding, and he was looking at the backs of her legs now. She was cold, and had her hands tucked up under her sweatshirt.

He said, “Wait a second.”

“What?”

“I’m supposed to be *hard*?”

Carla half-turned. “What’re you, stupid? Of course you have to be hard.”

“I’m not getting an erection with you in the bathroom, Carla. Cheyenne will kill me. And what about Cody?”

“What do you think we’re going to do? Just get a boner and put the toilet paper tube on your giant dick like a little top hat and we can both get out of here.”

“I can’t get hard with you standing here.”

Carla glanced over her shoulder at him, smiling. “Most guys get hard with me standing here.”

“This is crazy,” he said.

“Hey, Byron . . .?”

“What?”

Byron looked up as Carla flipped up the low hanging hem of her sweatshirt and exposed to him her bikini-clad butt. A nice one. Generous and fleshy, but so *round*. She wagged it left and right. Then covered it up again. “Getting hard?”

“My God, this is *so* weird,” he said.

“Is it getting hard?”

“I’m just standing here—I’m not doing anything.”

“*Hurry* up, Byron . . .”

“Okay-okay, hold on,” he said, frowning, glancing at his reflection in the mirror, standing in his T-shirt and sweatshirt and his baggy shorts, a toilet paper tube in his hand. He pushed down the elastic waistband of his shorts, taking his underwear down with it to mid-thigh, checking to see if Carla were to glance aside, would she get a peep of his penis. But there was a

bump out, and Carla leaned against it. If she looked left she wouldn't even see the mirror, even though they were standing so close together.

But there *was* something happening. Even though this was weird and awkward, and deep down he knew Cheyenne would be mad at him standing with Carla and his dick hanging out, he began to stiffen. He said, "I have to put my hand on it."

"I don't care what you do, just hurry up. I left my drink up there."

"Okay," he said, now putting his hand on his dick. "Fucking Cody is going to be so mad at me."

"Why?"

"I'm trapped in here with you with my dick out."

"I've got my back to you. You're such a prude."

"I'm not a prude at all."

Carla flipped up the hem of her sweatshirt again, and shifted her hips left and right making her butt bounce. "Just get this done already."

"Oh my God," he said.

Carla said, "Pretend this is Cheyenne's butt. Forget I'm even here."

Now Carla let the hem of her sweatshirt down again and he closed his eyes, trying to manhandle his dick as quietly as he could. Getting it aroused, but it was tough to get a hundred percent. There was something about the anxiety of being in this room with her like this that was preventing full hardness.

"You hard yet?"

"It's getting there."

“Don’t tell Cody,” Carla said.

“Don’t tell Cody what?” he said, as Carla turned around. He shoved the hanging hem of his shirt down to cover his penis. But Carla wasn’t looking, she had her face away and eyes turned up. Before he could ask her what he was doing, she scrolled up the front of her sweatshirt and exposed her bikini-clad breasts. He hitched a breath. Her thumbs tucked under the bikini bra, pulled the cups up and outward and she jounced in place until her big breasts hopped free and swung and bounced before him.

“Holy fucking shit,” he muttered.

Carla wagged her chest making her breasts go left and right and around and around. They made soft fleshy sounds when they bounced together. They were big and beautiful, her nipples were soft but slightly puffed. A cheery brownish pink not much different than the color of her natural skin.

“Hold on,” he said, staring at her breasts while jerking his cock underneath the front of his sweatshirt. “Oh my God, holy Jesus, Carla, don’t tell Cody.”

“You don’t tell Cody,” Carla laughed and shook her breasts again.

“Holy fuck, this is working,” Byron said.

“Good. What’s the big deal anyway, all you guys stood there watching me go around the outside of the boat without a stitch on. You saw my cooch.”

“You can show me your cooch if you want,” he said—completely joking.

Carla rolled her eyes, still looking away, held up her sweatshirt with one forearm now, then thumbed down the front of her panties showing off the shaved cleft mound inside them.

“Oh my God,” he laughed. “Carla, you are fucking crazy!”

“Is it hard?”

“Yeah, it’s hard,” he said, “a fucking hundred percent hard right now.”

“Then do it,” she said, letting her bikini bottom snap back in place and the sweatshirt fall around her waist again.

“Yeah,” he said, tugging up on the front of his shirt now, his erection sticking out straight ahead. “Shit, where the fuck did I put the toilet paper tube?”

Carla looked around. “It’s fucking on the counter, you dummy.”

“Are you looking at my dick?”

“I’m supposed to be looking at your dick, Byron, just get the toilet paper tube on it.”

“All right,” he said, and Carla wasn’t averting her eyes. Standing there and watching. He took the toilet paper tube, lined it up with his erection, then began to slide it over his penis. The head went in, the toilet paper tube continued, and he was surprised that he would fit inside it. And embarrassed now. He thought this thing wouldn’t even fit.

“You’re going to be longer,” Carla said.

He better be longer. Jesus.

The toilet paper tube pressed down into his pubic hair and the head of his cock poked out beyond the end of the roll.

“Looks like you were wrong,” Carla said.

“Whatever,” Byron said, yanking the toilet paper tube off, mad, tossing it in the trash. He pulled up his shorts, angled his erection to the side and up. “It’s longer.”

“It *is* longer,” Carla said, leaving *but not thicker* unsaid.

“That’s what you’re going to tell everybody.”

“Thinner than, but longer than.” She was smirking at him.

“Is that bad?”

“No, Byron, it’s not bad at all. That’s normal. Even better than normal.”

“That’s what you said at the sorority?”

“As long as it was longer or thicker. Didn’t have to be both. Though both was definitely better.”

“I’m longer.”

“You pass the test, Byron, just relax already,” Carla said and patted his chest. “I just think it’s hilarious you thought you were to be splitting that tube in two.”

“Can we just go already,” Byron said. “Don’t you need your drink or something?”

CHAPTER 2

When they returned to the upper deck, their friends were waiting for the result. It was Carla up ahead of him, hopping up on the deck and waiting for him to join her.

Scarlet said, “Well?”

“Drumroll, please,” Carla said, and Arlo abided her, drumming his fingers on the table top. There were less people on the top deck than there should be. Byron scanned, looking to see who was missing. Cheyenne wasn’t here. Was there someone else not here? He said, “Where’s Cheyenne?”

Carla said, “Byron is longer than a toilet paper roll.”

Scarlet exclaimed, “Yay,” and clapped her hands, winking at him. Lily joined in, smiling at him affectionately, clapping her hands. Arlo laughed.

Cody said, “You guys were sure down there long enough.”

Carla squeezed in behind Lily, saying, “What?—we had to fuck, Cody, what do you think?”

“Such a bitch,” Cody laughed, and Carla leaned over and kissed him on the lips. He rested a hand on her bare thigh, thumb stroking her skin.

Byron said again, “Where’s Cheyenne?”

Scarlet said, “Girth?” leaning back in her chair to get Carla’s attention.
“Carla— girth?”

“Not so good,” Carla said, and Scarlet laughed.

“Aw, you guys are so cruel,” Cody said.

Byron squeezed in past Arlo, and took a spot on the bench seat leaning back in the leather. “Did you miss the part where I’m longer than the toilet paper tube, dip shit? Where’s Cheyenne?”

Scarlet said, “Oh.”

“Oh what?”

“You guys were down there so long we played the next hand. She’s off doing her dare.”

“Oh yeah?” Byron said. “What’s Cheyenne’s dare?”

Cody said, “Touché, pal. Toilet tube test or whatever you call it.”

“What do you mean?”

“Cheyenne lost her hand just like you,” Cody said.

Scarlet waved at him. “Sorry, buddy. I picked the same thing.”

“What do you mean? Toilet tube test with who?”

“With Philippe.”

“Are you serious?” Byron said. “Wait, she’s down doing the toilet tube test with Philippe?”

Sullivan thought this was uproarious, holding his stomach and laughing. “Oh, how the tables have turned. This guy practically fucking tripped over himself trying to get down stairs to do it with Carla.”

Byron said, “I didn’t even know what it was, Sullivan.”

Scarlet said, “Well, if it makes you feel better, Cheyenne doesn’t know what it is either.”

“How long’s she been down there?”

Cody said, “You know how it is. Long enough to fuck.”

“Are you guys fucking with me? Is this part of my fucking dare? See how long I can keep my shit together?”

They all laughed, and while he liked provoking humor, he was scanning their faces. It had to be a joke. “You’re joking right?”

“What? No, we’re not joking. Cheyenne’s doing the toilet test thing with Philippe.”

Cody nudged his arm. “Just go down there, kick the door in.”

Carla put two fists in front of her mouth milking and circling, miming the act of sucking a cock.

“Oh my God,” Cody said, mimicking Cheyenne’s voice, “you’re so much longer and thicker than a toilet tube.”

“I’ve never seen *anything* thicker than a toilet tube,” Carla said in the same imitation-Cheyenne voice, almost unintelligible because she was laughing so hard.

Arlo groaned and sat back saying, “You guys are fucking twisted. I mean seriously. Holy shit . . .”

“What?” Cody said. “We’re only joking.”

Arlo said, “Yeah, but seriously, miming that, like she’s down there blowing Philippe? It’s funny, but seriously, that shit hurts.”

“I can take it,” Byron said. “There’s no way Cheyenne—”

Cody said, “Is sucking his cock?”

Sullivan said, “Oh my God, what an asshole.”

“I’m still joking,” Cody said, acting incredulous that nobody else thought this was funny.

“Who’s next, anyway?” Scarlet said.

Arlo said, “I’m up,” and took his spot in the chair for the guys’ side, waiting for Scarlet to shuffle cards.

But now Byron’s leg was jumping, trying to act casual, leaning back on the cushy bench seat. He was looking out into the blackness, listening to the soft breeze pinging the wind chime hanging on the deck below them and the soft lapping of the waves against the ship’s hull.

Cheyenne right now was downstairs in the bathroom with a guy he hardly really knew, and this guy had his dick out. They were going to measure his dick together. Cheyenne was going to see if Philippe’s dick was bigger than a toilet paper tube.

What if it was bigger? What if it was *way* bigger than a toilet paper tube?

Or what if it was smaller?

What if tonight when you got into bed Cheyenne realized how lucky she was? That was possible too.

He chewed his cheek and shook his head. Every time his mind wandered and fell onto the thoughts of what Cheyenne was doing right now in the bathroom with a guy whose shorts were probably down mid-thigh.

But Cheyenne was only doing what he had done with Carla. Nothing bad happened between him and Carla. Although Carla did show him her tits. He should tell that to Cody right now.

Oh yeah, smart mouth, your wife showed me her tits so I could get hard. Oh sorry, did I hurt your feelings? How about this one: she showed me her cooch, too. How about that, buddy? Flipped down her bikini bottoms to show me her pussy. Your wife wants me to fuck her so bad.

Cody would say *But you're not even as thick as a toilet paper tube, Byron.*

* * *

Arlo won his hand and everyone shouted.

Byron looked up, lost in thought, but suddenly brought back to reality, everybody laughing and clapping.

“Truth or dare, truth or dare?”

Scarlet was blushing. “I don’t know . . . I don’t know what I want to do . . .”

“Pick dare,” Cody said to her, “one of can take you down to the bathroom and measure your dick.”

More laughter, but all Byron could do was crane his neck around, trying get a peek down to the deck below to see if Cheyenne was headed up the steps yet.

How long were they going to be down there? How long did it take for this guy to get hard and pop his dick into a toilet paper tube? What the hell were

they doing?

Scarlet shook her hands out, saying, “Okay, okay, I guess . . . Dare. I pick dare. But I don’t want to go swimming.”

Cody rubbed his hands together. “Guess who’s going swimming . . .”

“It’s dark out there. Please, don’t make me do that.”

“Oh, that’s exactly what you’re doing, Scarlet. Naked, and—”

Scarlet’s husband Sullivan leaned over to whisper something in Cody’s ear.

“No,” Cody said, laughing. “That’s cruel. I think it might be illegal—”

Carla burst out of her chair. “Hey,” she said, “here they are . . .”

It was Cheyenne coming up the stairs to the deck, and Byron jolted, relief hitting him. Cheyenne was blushing bright red, her eyes a little glassy looking, coming up in her sweatshirt and shorts, flip-flops slapping her naked heels.

Cody shouted, “Well, what’s the verdict?”

Cheyenne shook her head no, and Philippe was coming up the steps behind her now with a smug smirk on his face.

“Verdict! What is it?” Carla pointed at Cheyenne.

Cheyenne waved her hands back and forth like she didn’t want to answer. She looked Byron’s way. Their eyes met and she looked away. Cheyenne looked guilty and apologetic at the same time.

Carla said, “Arlo, drumroll again.”

Arlo drummed his fingers on the table’s edge, going on and on and on, waiting for Cheyenne to give them their answer. Philippe came into the

group, sat at the end of the bench, three spots down from Byron.

Carla waved off the drumroll saying, “Cheyenne, we need an answer.”

Cheyenne rolled her eyes, plopped down in her seat. She said, “Not even close.”

The small smirk on her face punched Byron right in the heart. Like she’d been impressed with what had happened down in the bathroom with Philippe. Impressed with what she had seen.

Everyone broke out laughing.

Carla grabbed Cheyenne’s arm, trying to get her to look her way, needing clarification. “What wasn’t even close?”

“It wasn’t close,” Cheyenne said, looking a little stunned.

“Longer?”

“Yeah,” Cheyenne said. “Yes. Longer.”

“And girth?”

Sullivan started his drum roll again. Cheyenne giggled, covered her face for a second, pressing her cold fingers to her hot cheeks. She said, “What do you mean girth?”

“Could he get it inside?”

“No,” she said, rolling her eyes up, “I told you: not even close . . .”

More laughter. Arlo rolled his gaze Byron’s way sympathetically as if to say Sorry, man, I know how this must feel.

* * *

No one ever pursued Scarlet on her dare, and Scarlet blended into the background with an expression showing she couldn't believe she'd got away without doing it. But nobody wanted to make her swim underneath the boat; it was only funny because she was so afraid. It was late, and making someone swim under the boat when they were afraid to was a dumb idea, and unsafe, and in the end they all just hung out talking on the deck, their impromptu and made-up game of *hearts-plus-war-plus truth or dare* becoming a memory.

Except for Byron, who couldn't stop thinking how his wife had gone down to measure another man's penis. And it had been bigger than his.

So—even though once Cheyenne finished her drink and went to the cooler to get herself another, came around the table and curled up next to him on the bench, cuddling in the space between his arm and his ribs—everything was still not okay.

Byron cradled Cheyenne against him, kissed the top of her damp hair and she hugged him and sipped on her White Claw. The whole while all he could think was that she had been down in the bathroom—much like the one he was in with Carla—with a guy who was good-looking, tall, masculine and hairy, and his dick was apparently bigger than a toilet paper tube.

And why had they been down there so long?

That was still a puzzle. Could Philippe not get it up? That should make Byron feel pretty happy, but it didn't. It only reminded him that his wife was persistent, waiting Philippe out until he got erect. And what did she do to get him erect? Did she thumb down the front of her bikini bottoms and show this guy her sweet little pussy?

It was crazy: that thought made him hard.

With his sweet wife curled up next to him, he was shifting in his spot, lifting a leg so his bulge wouldn't show.

Philippe drifted off, and eventually Cody and Carla fell asleep together, Carla in Cody's arms.

Cheyenne kissed Byron's cheek, then gathered up his hand in both hers and stood, guiding him to follow. "Come on, baby, let's go to bed," she said.

"Good night, guys," he said, standing—then hunching, realizing his erection hadn't gone away yet. It was still humped out in his shorts, and he shoved the front of his shirt down to cover it, scooting between the bench and the seats, Cheyenne still holding onto his wrist.

CHAPTER 3

They descended the stairs, Cheyenne going first, then they entered the lower lounge and into the hall with the sleeping cabins, going to their bedroom suite. A king-size bed took up most of their space, sunken in a step down, a couch at bedside, a window looking out on the water, a built-in wardrobe, and a table with a comfy chair and a mirror.

Cheyenne turned on the bedside lamp and climbed into bed, patting the spot next to him. Byron slung off his shirt and climbed up to join her. Her lips were on his as soon as he was on the mattress. She had her small warm hands cupped to his neck and then his cheeks, and she breathed deep while she kissed him.

It made him mad. Cheyenne was horny.

He should be excited that his wife was horny, but instead all he could think was that he was not the source of her arousal. It was another man. It was being in that bathroom with Philippe and his big dick that got Cheyenne's motor running. But he went with it, holding Cheyenne's waist and kissing her in return.

Cheyenne let her hands off his face, shrugged off her sweatshirt, sitting in bed now with him in just her shorts and a bikini top. He untied the back, let

the cups fall free and thumbed her nipples. She gasped and moaned, ran her nails through his hair.

He said, “You’re horny.”

“So horny,” she said.

“Yeah?” he said, getting them both on their sides and laying down face-to-face, kissing her and rubbing her hip. She was almost naked, her perfect body taut and warm under his palm. “You’re horny for me?”

“Are you horny for me?” she said, thumbing down her shorts and bikini bottoms, pulling her legs out of them.

He pushed down on his shorts, taking his underwear with them, and Cheyenne cooed seeing his erection bouncing between his legs. He lay on his back, tossed the shorts off the bedside.

Now he craned his arm to the bedside and flicked off the light. Cheyenne’s mouth went down on his hard cock and he groaned and tightened his stomach feeling his wife’s slippery wet mouth sliding down his shaft. He palmed her head while she bobbed her mouth on his throbbing cock and gently squeezed on his balls.

Byron lay in the dark now, eyes rolled up with pleasure, thinking of his wife exactly like this, getting Philippe hard so they could see if his penis would fit inside a toilet paper tube. Cheyenne trying, and saying, *Oh my gosh, it won’t even go in the tube.*

He palmed her neck, pulled her off his cock and guided her up to his side again. He held her in his arms, and she kissed him, pumped her stomach against his hip, put a knee up on his thigh, wanting his cock inside her.

“You’re so horny,” he said.

“I’m so horny,” she laughed.

“Why?”

“Who knows why, let’s just do it,” she said, chuckling.

“I want to talk about what happened.”

Cheyenne’s body stiffened, but then the stiffness eased away. He could picture her face, too. That face she did, knowing where he was headed with something and not wanting to go there, and putting on a sly smile to change the subject. Only he couldn’t see her face right now so she was powerless against him.

Cheyenne said nothing, rubbed the inside of her thigh up and down the belly of his erection.

“We should talk about it.”

“What’s there to talk about, Byron?”

“Aren’t you mad at me?”

“No.”

“You’re not mad at me at all for that toilet roll thing?”

“No.”

“Are you going to ask me?”

“Ask you what?” Still kissing, still stroking, trying to change the subject.

“Are you going to ask me if I’m mad?”

Cheyenne sighed and there was a grumble of discontent hidden inside it.

“What?”

“Fine. If you’d rather talk.”

“We’ll talk first, believe me, Cheyenne.”

“Okay, let’s hit it. Where do you want to start?”

“It was a stupid game,” he said.

“It was nothing. It was just stupid fun.”

“So you thought it was fun?”

“Didn’t you think it was fun?”

“What are you insinuating, because I was down there with Carla?”

“You sure went down there in a hurry.”

“I didn’t know what it was. I wasn’t in a hurry, by the way.”

“You were pretty eager to get down there. Probably thought it had something to do with Carla’s tits.”

“That’s not even fair. Why would you even say that?”

“Because you’re trying to make this about being jealous, and I’m arming myself against your argument. Did you go down there to see her big titties?”

“No.”

“And what did I do?”

“Are you saying I’m thinking you went down there to see his big dick?”

“That’s where you’re trying to get to. I’m just trying to shorten the route.”

He said, “Why are you mad at me?”

“I’m not. I told you I’m not. You want me to be mad at you because you’re mad at me. You want to turn this into a fight and I don’t even want to fight. . . . It was funny. She went down there and you didn’t know what it was. I believe you. I know nothing happened between you and Carla. You’re going to tell me she didn’t show you her tits but I’ll ask Carla tomorrow and she’s gonna say yes, she showed you her tits. I’m not going to be mad. You already saw Carla’s tits. I don’t care. She has nice tits and I know you like them.”

“No, I don’t.”

“Byron, it’s not weird to like tits. Don’t touch them, that’s all.”

“I didn’t touch them.”

Cheyenne raised an eyebrow. “So she showed them.”

“Oh my God,” he said, “how is this on *me* now?”

“Do you think it was such a great idea to start this conversation? We could be fucking right now. You could be coming inside me, but you’d rather turn this into something dumb and boring and cardboard.”

“That’s what you think of me, I’m cardboard?”

Cheyenne rolled her eyes. “Yeah, *that’s* what I was saying.”

“Again, you’re mad at me. I didn’t do anything.”

“And there’s that insinuation again that *I* did something.”

“You *did*.”

“I did the exact same thing *you* did, Byron. I went down to the bathroom to see what a toilet paper game was. I had an idea, *yes*, I knew it would have something to do with a penis. It’s pretty obvious because a toilet paper tube

is cylindrical. I'm not a dummy. But I knew it wasn't going to be anything bad."

"You don't think it was bad?"

"Byron, you did the same *thing*. You put your dick inside a toilet paper tube in front of Carla. You have *nothing* to say."

"I wasn't . . . it wasn't my idea."

"It wasn't *my* idea," she shouted.

"Okay, okay," he said soothingly, looking for her wrists and then holding her hands. "I'm sorry."

"I don't mean to shout."

Byron was quiet a moment. "I went down there, and I didn't know what it was. Carla turned her back and I was reluctant. But then she was encouraging me to just get it done, and she wasn't looking. I tried to get hard. I couldn't get all the way hard and I didn't ask her to, but yes, she flashed me her chest. Okay?"

"And that got you hard?"

"Oh God, I should've seen that coming." He'd walked right into it.

Then, surprisingly, instead of being mad, Cheyenne touched a finger to his lower lip. She said, "Carla's got nice tits."

"They're not terrible," he said.

"Okay?"

He shook his head and sighed. "Talk about shortening the route."

"What does that mean? What route?"

“Now I’m following your path and I see your destination.”

She said, “What’s my destination?”

“Your destination is for me to understand that it’s okay for you to appreciate that Philippe has got a great big good-looking dick.”

And instead of being aghast or offended, Cheyenne chuckled.

“You think that’s funny?”

“No, what’s funny is that was pretty insightful.”

“It was?”

“Yeah, I called you out on it, and I left myself open. You saw right through me.”

“So I got it right?”

“I’m not saying Philippe has a big good-looking dick, you dummy. But I want you not to be mad at me, that’s all.”

“So what happened down there?”

“Nothing happened, Byron. Seriously, nothing happened.”

“You were down there for so long.”

“Yeah, whatever. We were talking.”

“Talking about what?”

“Just about stuff.”

“What kind of stuff? You were down there talking with him and his pants were down?”

“No. His pants weren’t down. We were just hanging out in the bathroom and talking.”

“That doesn’t even make sense, Cheyenne, sorry, I don’t understand what you’re telling me. You went down there and nothing happened? You just were sitting there and talking? Like, it sounds suspicious.”

“Suspicious how? What do you think I was doing down there? Philippe’s a nice guy. We were just chatting. He’s divorced from Paloma, and he’s having a hard time getting used to it. I mean we know that he was the one who called it off with Paloma, and that’s okay. And he was okay with it and they didn’t fight, and everything’s fine now. But he’s trying to get back out and dating, and everything is just so shitty.”

“At what part did you measure his dick?”

“We didn’t have to.”

“What do you mean you didn’t have to? Did you guys cheat or something? Philippe just told you that he was bigger than a toilet roll?”

“No, he just . . .”

“Could he not get it up?” And now he was worried what Cheyenne would’ve done to get Philippe erect. And would she tell him?

“No, he didn’t *get it up*.”

“Aw, that’s bull shit. See? You guys *were* cheating.”

“No, we were not cheating.”

“Then how can he be bigger than a toilet roll tube, how can you say that?”

“He was bigger than a toilet roll.”

He was silent a long time waiting for her to finish. But slowly he realized her response spoke volumes, and reality began to pool around his feet. “He didn’t have to . . .?”

“Get it up? No. He showed me before he . . .”

“So, you’re saying . . .?”

Cheyenne nodded, lips slimmed. “It was bigger already.”

“Without being hard?”

“Yeah.”

“Jesus Christ,” he muttered.

“That’s not crazy,” she said. Then: “*Is* that crazy?”

“You don’t think that’s crazy?”

“I don’t know *what* to say.”

“Can I ask you a real question?”

“Okay. Go ahead.”

“Is *that* why you’re horny?”

She made an exasperated sound.

“Well?”

“Like . . . Maybe. But it wasn’t just that. It was the whole day and the whole night. And it wasn’t just Philippe, it was seeing fucking Sullivan streaking around the deck and he was naked—that was kind of, I don’t know, *hot* . . . and Sullivan didn’t have a . . .”

“Have a what?”

“Sullivan has a normal dick. It’s not like Philippe showed me the size of his and now I just *have* to have sex.”

“And you didn’t show him anything?”

She narrowed her eyes into mean slits. “No. I’m not Carla.”

“You guys had a good chat down there. You were down there forever.”

“Yeah, we did have a good talk.”

They were both silent for half a minute, both of them on their backs now and looking up at the ceiling. He rolled toward his wife, rested his hand on her hipbone. The tips of his fingers traveled that valley down between her legs, and he found her sopping wet. He began to stroke at her opening, going low, coming up high, finding her petals fully engorged and her clitoris swollen. Cheyenne breathed deeply while he fingered her, then she raised her knees and let her legs fall open wider. He pushed fingers inside of her, and she touched his arm, her other hand holding his wrist. He fingered her until his eyes grew adjusted to the dim, and the pale moonlight began to settle on his wife’s soft curves. He could see the raised ridge of her rib cage, the hard bolt of a nipple. He watched her breathe, charcoal light playing on her supple body. Cheyenne’s pussy made soft wet smacking sounds around his plunging fingers. He twirled her clitoris, then plunged and cupped his fingers inside her. He got her panting.

He said, “How did you prove he was bigger than the toilet roll?”

Cheyenne mumbled a complaint, but then whispered her reply. “He showed it to me and it was obvious.”

“You didn’t check?”

“He pulled his pants down and I laughed because it was like we didn’t even *have* to check.”

“But you checked?”

“I held the toilet roll next to it.”

“You touched it?”

“Not my skin, Byron, just the toilet roll.”

“And it was longer?”

“It was longer. And then I tried to slide the toilet paper tube onto it, but like the head wouldn’t even get in the opening at all.”

“Are you laughing?”

“It was so funny,” she said.

“Should I think it’s funny?”

“No.”

“Why’s that? Should I be worried?”

“No,” she said. “Now *that’s* funny.”

“And you didn’t touch his dick?”

“Nope,” she said, beginning to hump back against his plunging fingers.

“That feels so good,” she whispered.

“You’re changing the subject like you always do.”

“Would you please just fuck me.”

Byron brought his fingers out, swirled her clit, then mashed on it, kneeling her to roll over toward the window. He spooned behind her, thumbed his aching ramrod of an erection upright till the tip found the hot wet groove of his wife’s opening. He slid himself up inside her, and all he could think

about was Cheyenne alone with Philippe and his big dick. “He said he wasn’t even hard at all?”

“Not at all,” she whispered, her soft, airy voice strung tight at the feel of his erection sliding inside her. She moaned when he got deep. “Oh God.”

“Just a big old dangling dick,” he said.

“Just a big, hairy, soft dick,” she gasped.

“You’re turning me fucking on, Cheyenne.”

She chuckled, then reached behind her and dug her nails into his thigh. “Fuck me,” she said.

And he did, going slow, knowing she wanted it hard and fast but wanting her to beg him. He slid out, then all the way in, and almost all the way out again. Keeping the pace dreadfully slow, watching her silvery moonlight profile the whole time. Studying her. He said, “Would it be too big for you?”

“No,” she said.

Byron jolted and Cheyenne liked the feel of him stabbing into her deeply. “You could take his big dick?”

“Yeah,” she gasped.

Now his stomach squirmed, his intestines like a nest of snakes. She said it wasn’t crazy seeing that big dick, and now she said she could take it. Dirty talk with your husband would suggest saying you *couldn’t* take it. But Cheyenne said she could. A curious interest in his wife’s mind, he was sure of it. And now he was thinking maybe she’d had it before. A big dick. Another boyfriend with a huge dong. He said, “You could take it?”

“Yeah,” she gasped again, rolling her hips against him, her butt cheeks patting against his hipbones.

“You could take a big dick like that?”

“Mm, yeah,” she said.

“You could take it *deep*?” he said, thrusting himself inside her, hard and all the way, every inch he had.

“I could take it deep,” she gasped, and now he was the one who was losing control, gripping her arm, the strokes getting fast, erratic.

His hand swept around, fingers mushing through his wife’s soaking sex, two fingers finding the hard knot of her clit in all those luscious slippery folds and swirling hard on it while his iron-hard cock thrust in and out of her. Cheyenne went wild. “This little pussy’s too tight for a big dick,” he growled.

Cheyenne mewled and grabbed her own breasts. “God, yes, Byron, oh God,” she cried.

“You want his big dick inside you?”

Cheyenne stammered, unsure but still aroused. “No,” she croaked.

The right answer, but he demanded she say yes. He told her: “Tell me you want it, Cheyenne.”

She complained in her throat, knowing saying such a thing would be depthlessly taboo, but getting into the dirty talk with her husband. “I . . . *want* his big dick.”

The words sent him off like a rocket-ship in the most unexpected way. Hearing his wife say something so sexually awful ignited the combustion low in his belly that would erupt the contents of his balls. The wheels were

already in motion, his cock sending out streams of pre-come inside her right now, making their union slippery. “Tell . . . tell me you’ll take his big dick.”

“I’ll take it,” she cried, writhing underneath him, her legs kicking as he fucked her hard from behind, not side-by-side anymore but him almost on top of her, Cheyenne with one leg splayed out, her feet curled in the bed sheets.

He grabbed her knee and pinned her to the bed and fucked her hard, wanting to come deep inside her. Thinking of someone else doing it. Thinking of her making these exquisite sounds because she was being spread apart by a dick that wouldn’t fit inside a toilet roll even when it was soft.

Cheyenne was the first to come, and once she stiffened and squeaked and gasped, it was all over for him too. The thought of Cheyenne right now imagining another man’s oversized cock fucking her proved too much and he exploded inside her. It sent Cheyenne off again and she wailed with pleasure.

He pushed in as deep as he would go, cock flexing and twitching, streams of his ejaculate filling her up.

He collapsed on his wife and rolled to the side. The frivolity of the day, the quantity of beer, the heat of the daytime sun, and his incredible orgasm, all had his eyes closing and his mind slipping into deep unconsciousness, Cheyenne still moaning at his side.

CHAPTER 4

In the morning light the dirty talk seemed strange and otherworldly. Like it hadn't been him who'd uttered those terrible words. Like it hadn't been Cheyenne who'd responded to them.

They both lay in bed, side-by-side, both naked and wound in a tangle of their bedsheets. Cheyenne's naked hip pressed against his naked hip. He groaned, stretched, turned toward her but wouldn't meet her eyes. In his periphery he saw that she was awake, but instead he looked out at the view.

"Nice day out there," he said, putting an arm around her and cradling her body against his. Outside, the morning sky was a bright blue, the water choppy, and churning blue-gray. "A little windy," he added.

Cheyenne kissed his neck, patted his chest, turned in his clutch to look out the window. "It's supposed to be nice later."

"I hope so," he said. "Yesterday was perfect."

"Yesterday was pretty perfect," she said. And now he was thinking of alternative meanings to that phrase.

Were the events of yesterday perfect, Cheyenne? The part where you huddled in a small bathroom with a guy who had his pants down, his big

dick hanging there? Was it perfect how you two chatted together, alone and sequestered?

Despite the anger that this thought provoked, the seething jealousy, his heart pounded a little faster and he hugged her tighter.

“You’re squishing me.”

“I’ll squish you if I want to squish you,” he said.

Cheyenne kneed him in the balls. Just in her cute and playful way. Not hurting him, only jabbing the front of her thigh against his junk. It got him to grunt. “You’re such a tiger,” he said.

“I am feisty,” she said.

Before he could stop himself, he jabbed back, “You were real feisty last night.” He winced. He hadn’t intended to bring up how they fought before they had sex and how she responded during sex.

“I can’t believe we got so crazy last night.”

“You and me?”

“All of us,” she said, and patted his cheek. Her eyes scanned his, looking for his thoughts. Cheyenne had blue-gray eyes, but the way the sun came in sideways through the window, level with the bed, flecks of gold sparkled. He kissed the tip of her nose.

He confessed: “I had fun last night.”

“I had fun, too.”

Now he could think that she meant fun with Philippe and his giant dick, but then she could come back with yeah, you had fun with Carla and her big tits. They *both* got a little crazy last night. But it was all in good fun. And

yeah he got turned on by Carla's bared breasts. And so what if Cheyenne got turned on by what Philippe had between his legs. A girl could be aroused by things. That was all right. Even if it was your wife.

If he wanted this to go away, it would have to be him to smooth it over. He kissed her forehead, ran his hand under the sheets, along the softness of her back, then over to grab one of her butt cheeks. He patted it. "I'm hungry," he said.

"So, we're not going to fight about *that* anymore?"

"What's there to fight about?"

* * *

Despite the luxury and expense of their yacht rental, the grand kitchen was cluttered like they were all still in college. Opened bags of bread, dirty plates and forks and knives, unclean cooking pans, open jars of jam, cereal boxes with tops popped.

Byron and Cheyenne weren't the only ones up: Arlo and Sullivan were drinking coffee on the back deck, and Scarlet was in the bathroom. The rest of them were in bed while Byron cooked toast and scrambled eggs on the propane burner. The kitchen was spacious and modern. Out both sides they had views of the water and the pale horizon beyond. Cheyenne sat on a stool on the opposite side of the kitchen island reading messages on her phone.

Byron flipped the eggs in the pan, said over his shoulder, "That better not be work stuff, Cheyenne."

"Uh-oh." Cheyenne laughed.

“Phones away,” he said now, dumping their two plates with the scrambled eggs. He pushed Cheyenne’s plate toward her, and when the toast popped, he also threw two pieces on it. He shoved a bottle of ketchup across.

With his plate, he came around to join Cheyenne, both of them sitting side-by-side at the countertop. She put her phone away, hiding it in her sweatshirt’s pouch.

“What do you want to do today? You want to take the jet-skis, maybe go to shore, go shopping or something?”

“I want to stay on the boat.”

“What do you feel like doing?”

“Laying in the sun.”

“You already look tanned.”

“Practice makes perfect,” she said, squirting ketchup in a zigzag across the pale yellow reef of scrambled eggs.

“Maybe I’ll go fishing with Sully. See if those guys want to go out.”

“You could do that,” she said.

“Thanks for your permission.”

Cheyenne laughed, leaned close and bumped her shoulder against his, took a bite of her toast and said, “I mean it’s a good idea.”

“I know what you meant.”

There was a yawn from behind them, someone coming in from the bedrooms, squeaky bare feet moving from the tile floor onto the hardwood.

It was Carla, coming around the island now and into the kitchen space, going to the sink and pouring herself a glass of water. She was still yawning, saying, “Good morning,” but almost unintelligible.

“Look at you, up bright and early,” Byron said.

“I’m so wrecked today,” Carla replied, drank a swig of water, popped the top on her multivitamins, tossed one into her open mouth, then knocked back the water to finish it off.

Carla wore an oversized T-shirt as a nightshirt. It clung to her curves, and it was clear she wore no bra. Her nipples were up and ready for the day as well. The front of the shirt had an image of a dog with messy hair; the T-shirt slogan underneath saying *Dog Tired*. Hardened nipple-bolts poked out on either side of the dog’s cartoon face. She said, “You guys are up too early.”

Byron said, “Arlo and Sullivan were up first. They’re out back having coffee.”

“Couple of nerds,” Carla said and laughed, put her empty glass in the sink and brought down a cereal bowl. Now her back was to them again, and he was watching her butt move underneath the pale blue T-shirt.

Cheyenne was watching him.

Byron look to her, smiled, making himself look innocent. He couldn’t help what Carla was wearing.

Cheyenne made no expression, then finished her scrambled eggs. She took his plate from him even though he still had half a piece of toast left, brought them both to the sink, dumped the remaining food in the trash compactor, pushed the foot pedal to grind it, and then began rinsing the dishes. She said, “Is nobody doing dishes around here?”

Carla chuckled, said, “Somebody’s crotchety in the morning. Usually it’s me.”

“Cheyenne’s not crotchety,” Byron said, hugging his arms and leaning on the counter, watching the two of them side-by-side.

Carla tumbled a boatload of Froot Loops into her empty bowl and splashed milk in it. She came across to the opposite side of the counter with her elbows leaning, began spooning Froot Loops into her mouth. She wore no makeup this morning, her blonde hair tied back, hanging down in wisps across the nape of her neck and down one side of her face. There was something about the way her lips moved, something sexy about her confidence and demeanor.

But Cheyenne was wary, washing dishes and looking over her shoulder to see what Carla was doing. Cheyenne didn’t do all the dishes, only scrubbed their two plates and the pan that he’d used. She put them in the drying rack, came to stand next to Carla, both girls facing him. Cheyenne said to him, “You want to go sit in the sun?”

“Yeah, good idea.”

Out of nowhere, Cheyenne turned to Carla, saying, “And in the future, why don’t you keep your tits to yourself?” Then she turned on a heel, headed out of the kitchen and down the narrow hallway toward the steps that would take her up to the third floor lounge where she could sit in the sun.

Carla made no reaction, continued munching her Froot Loops, watching the space where Cheyenne had stood.

She tossed her spoon back in the bowl. It rattled. She palmed her hands on the counter and looked at Byron with serious intent. “You fucking told her that? You’re *such* a big mouth.”

Byron smirked awkwardly, shrugged, showed her his palms. “I don’t have secrets.”

“You could have a *couple* of secrets, Byron, you fucking moron. Way to go.”

Byron laughed. “She’s fine, don’t worry about it.”

“You’re such an idiot,” she said, gathered up her bowl, held it to her stomach, then left the kitchen in Cheyenne’s wake, looking to catch up with her.

* * *

For a couple of minutes Byron sat at the kitchen counter by himself, still amused by what happened. There was something good with Cheyenne’s jealousy. Jealousy made him happy. Maybe his jealousy would make her happy, too.

Gradually, though, his amusement at the situation waned and he began to feel bad for having confided the truth in Cheyenne. Of course he should have told her. That was obvious. But he *had* betrayed Carla. Carla had done a funny thing that didn’t mean much. She flashed her tits at him when they were joking around, and kindly asked him not to tell Cody. And yeah, he didn’t tell Cody, but now Cheyenne knew. Maybe soon somebody else would know and then it would get back to Cody. It was kind of shitty. He’d apologize to Carla, but for now he’d let Carla and Cheyenne work it out between them, and he left the kitchen in the opposite direction, going out toward the front of the second level where he knew Arlo and Sullivan were sitting.

There was a short deck at the end of the hallway that threaded between the upper level rooms, and that’s where he found his two buddies, sitting on

wicker sofas facing each other. Their coffee cups sat on a low table between them, and they were laughing.

“What’s so funny?”

“Sully said he couldn’t streak around the boat last night if he wasn’t drunk,” Arlo said.

“You were doing a dance, that’s for sure. And naked,” Byron said. “It’s a good thing you didn’t fall in the water.”

“I would’ve been all right.”

“What if you hit your head? I don’t think any one of us would’ve been able to save you.”

“I don’t think any one of you could save me, stone cold sober.”

Arlo agreed, raised a beer bottle, then took a swig.

“You’re drinking already?”

Sullivan laughed, hoisted up his own beer bottle saying, “You can’t drink all day—”

Arlo finished, pointing at Sullivan saying “If you don’t start in the morning.”

They all laughed, and though it wasn’t even 9:30 in the morning, now Byron was craving a beer or two. He said, “Hey, you guys want to go out in the jet-skis later, bring some rods, we’ll go fishing?”

“I’ll tell you what,” Arlo said, “if I’m not passed out by two o’clock, we’ll go.”

“Sounds like a deal,” Byron said. “Let me go grab a beer, I’ll join you guys.”

“Bring us a couple more,” Arlo said as Byron headed down to the kitchen again.

While the morning had looked tumultuous, Cheyenne was right, the weather was already calming. Now he was too hot in his sweatshirt.

In the kitchen, he pulled out three beer bottles and set them on the counter. But he left them there, heading to the steps that would take him to the lower level where the bedrooms were, looking to get out of his sweatpants and into some shorts, and file away his hoodie.

Down on the lower level, Scarlet was heading into her bedroom, next to his. He said, “Little early for a nap.”

“What are you doing, you’re heading for a nap?”

He hoisted his sweatshirt saying, “No, I gotta change. It’s hot out now.”

“I’ll meet you outside in a couple minutes,” Scarlet said, heading into her bedroom.

He called out, “Me and Sully and Arlo are having beers on that little deck up on the second floor.”

“Beers?” Scarlet laughed then closed the door behind her.

It was kinda crazy, but it was a beautiful vacation morning and why the hell not?

He pulled open the bedroom door and jumped back. Cheyenne was in there with Philippe. They stood together and startled as he opened the door, Cheyenne scooting back from Philippe like they’d been close. His heart pounded with shock, and then his brow lowered feeling that angry jealousy come on.

What the hell were they doing together like that in the closed bedroom?

CHAPTER 5

Philippe smiled the way someone does when they want to disarm you. Either placating or guilty, Byron couldn't tell. Maybe it was both. Philippe said, "Hey, Byron," calm and collected.

"Hey," Byron answered, scowling and unable to hide the terrible thoughts crossing his mind.

Cheyenne gave him an easy, indolent expression, eyes soft, brows high. She'd folded her arms. She said, "I'm coming up in a second."

"Yeah, okay, but I came to get changed. You think I could come in and put my shorts on? I didn't know you two were in here."

There was an awkward moment where no one said anything, all three expecting someone else to do it, a long tense moment waiting to pop.

Philippe looked to Cheyenne and said, "I'm going to get out of here. Thanks for the talk, Chey."

"No problem, Philippe," she said, "and thank you, too."

"My pleasure," Philippe said, squeezing past Byron to get out. Byron didn't give him much leeway, standing his ground in the doorway.

Philippe was taller than him, and bulky, and for whatever reason, all of a sudden he didn't like Philippe very much. But Philippe was all smiles, passing by him through the open doorway and into the hall. There was a certain aloofness, like the guy knew it was a bad thing to get caught in another man's bedroom with his wife.

With Philippe gone, Byron said, "What the fuck, Cheyenne," closing the door behind him.

Cheyenne flashed an angry look and dashed her hands up, then walked to sit on the bed. "It's nothing, Jesus, can you not, Byron?"

"You're mad at me for not knocking, coming into my own bedroom? I had no fucking idea you were in here with big dick Philippe."

"Don't call him that."

The way Cheyenne said it—sitting on one leg, the other hanging off the bed's edge, arms crossed, and looking away—made him aware of a stark detachment from her, a powerless feeling he didn't like. It angered him, and the anger got him chasing after Cheyenne, incredulous she wouldn't admit right away what was an obvious transgression. "What? What the fuck, Cheyenne, seriously."

"Don't make a big deal out of it, okay, Byron, please." She studied his face a long while but he could see in her eyes, as mad as she was about his reaction, there was a reasonable source for it.

Gazes connected, he said slowly: "What the fuck, Cheyenne."

"Look," she said, eyes rolling up and posture sagging. "I know how it looked. I know-I know."

"I'm fucking mad, Cheyenne."

“I get that you’re mad,” she said, “but you have to calm down about it.”

“I come in here and you guys are practically fucking *hugging*.”

“We weren’t *hugging*.”

“You guys were talking real close. Were you trying to slip another toilet roll over his giant dick?”

He’d meant the words as angry and confrontational but they made Cheyenne laugh. When she laughed, the absurdity of his own statement occurred to him. It *was* stupid. Then he smiled, and palmed his forehead.

“All right, just tell me what the hell you were doing in here.”

She said very seriously: “We were just talking.”

“Why were you in our bedroom talking to him?”

She nodded toward the door. “He was passing by.”

“Okay, but why would you close the bedroom door? Do you need privacy?”

“Kind of.”

“I don’t know what to tell you, Cheyenne. I’m not too happy.”

“Oh, come on Byron. You’re making it sound like you can’t trust me.”

“*Can* I trust you?”

After he said it, he knew it was too far.

Cheyenne wasn’t pleased. “That’s not even funny, Byron. Look at me.”

His eyes met hers, and she showed him an unimpressed expression.

“Can you trust me,” she said coldly.

“I can trust you.”

“If something were going on that you shouldn’t know about, would Philippe and I do it in my bedroom?”

“*Our* bedroom, first of all, Cheyenne,” he said, “and you’re *really* thinking this out. Like when you *do* do something with Philippe, you know exactly not to do it in this bedroom.”

“You’re being a dick right now,” she said, plain and matter-of-fact.

“Right,” he said, laughing, taking his sweat pants off now, a strange urge coming over him to hide the bulge in his underwear from Cheyenne because it might not be as impressive as what she’d seen between Philippe’s legs. He hunched over, pulled his shorts off the hook on the wall and put his legs in them. “If you came in here and I was up close and personal with Carla, you’d be fine and dandy? I told you that thing about her last night in confidence, and you went after her this morning. That wasn’t very nice.”

“I know,” she said sulkily. “I don’t know what came over me.”

“Are you jealous?”

“You’re the one that’s jealous,” she said, coming nearer to him, looking for a hug. He put his arms around her.

“Did you work it out with Carla?”

“We worked it out. I’m not even really mad at her. I don’t know what came over me. I just felt really stabby.”

“Well you stabbed her good,” he said and squeezed her tighter.

“I don’t know what it was, maybe just that T-shirt thing she was walking around in, you can see all her stuff through it.”

“She was walking around naked last night.”

“But that was funny because we were joking around.”

“But . . . I saw her. What does it matter?”

“You can’t even argue it, can you?”

He laughed. “Not really.”

“It was different.”

“Yeah, in the bathroom it was. But this morning she was just wearing a nightshirt.”

“I told you I worked it out with her. Can we just drop this, please?”

“Can you promise me I’m not going to walk into another room and find you making out with Philippe?”

“We weren’t making out, stupid. It was a continuation of our conversation last night.”

“Of the conversation when he had his dick out?”

“Yeah,” she said, “that one. Anyway, I gave him some advice and he texted Paloma this morning.”

“What are they doing, patching it up?”

“No. That’s his business. I shouldn’t say. He’s just making . . . amends. Okay? He was just saying thanks and telling me what Paloma said and he didn’t want somebody else with a big mouth overhearing.

“Who? Carla?”

“Carla or anybody else who wants to gossip about him talking to Paloma again.”

“I guess it’s okay.”

“What are we doing now? You want to go sun ourselves?”

“Yeah, it’s hot now. I’m gonna go sit out front with Sullivan and Arlo. We’re hitting the beers already.”

“Great,” Cheyenne said and rolled her eyes. “It’s going to be one of those days.”

As she left, he gave her butt a quick snapping backhand that made her yelp and jump and laugh. She shot him a cute look over her shoulder out in the hall, and then disappeared.

* * *

After an hour and a quarter on the front deck with Arlo and Sullivan and three beers each, he headed back inside. He stopped in the can to drain off the beer he’d consumed, then continued. Then paused at his door, staring at its blank rectangle space.

It was hard not to recall that punch of dread in his stomach opening it and seeing his wife with another man. His heart pounded just staring at the door.

Jesus Christ, for the whole time he’d been on the deck drinking those beers he’d erased all of that fear and jealousy. Two seconds looking at his bedroom door and it was stabbing his heart again.

His hand went out, as he pictured what could be behind the door. Pushing it open, finding Cheyenne in Philippe’s arms. They were kissing . . .

Only, when he switched the latch over and shoved the door open, he found the bedroom dim and empty. Beyond the window it was bright and sunny and the choppy waves had ceased.

It was a bad thing to think, and there were better things to do. Like right now he should be finding Cheyenne, sitting with her, spending time together. But as he passed through the hall, he tried to remember which door was Philippe's—

Now his stomach was alive with butterflies again. He rested a hand over top his middle and scrunched his T-shirt in a fist, continuing on down the hall.

Relief was found in the kitchen.

Philippe was there by himself, wearing a tank top, drying a dish in a towel. The kitchen was spotless. All the dishes done. Boxes of cereal closed up, lids on jars, all lined up neatly at the back splash. Everything in its place.

“Hey, did you do this?”

Philippe turned, smiled, said, “We’re all total pigs. If we don’t keep on top of it, it’s going to be a super shitty final day if we have a boatload of cleanup to do.”

Byron laughed. “Yeah, a boatload for sure.” He closed the space between them, needing into the fridge to get another beer.

Philippe put a dried plate in the cupboard, turned and leaned on the counter. “Hey, Byron, man, look—”

“The bedroom thing?” Byron said, opening the fridge door.

Look, Byron, I know how that must seem . . .”

“It wasn’t cool,” he said. “Beer?”

Philippe checked his watch. “This early?”

“Early? Really? This will be like my fourth. And I’m not the only one.”

Philippe said, “Yeah, all right, shoot me a beer.”

And now, trying to be nice, here he was handing a beer over to this good-looking guy who'd been spending illicit time with his wife. Shit, one o'clock this morning, Cheyenne was closed in the bathroom with this guy, finding out just how huge his dick was. And then he'd encountered them in the bedroom together, awfully close. . . . *Now you're passing the guy a beer? Now you're all buddy-buddy?*

He passed over a beer and Philippe held the bottle against his stomach. "It's not how it seemed. Cheyenne gave me some advice."

"Yeah, Cheyenne told me about it. I trust her. It's not a big deal, it's just not something that felt so great walking into. But I trust my wife."

"Cheyenne is awesome, Byron. You're the luckiest guy in the world. I hope you know it."

"Trust me. I know it. You don't have to tell me."

"I don't want to sound like a jerk, I don't mean to make it sound like that."

Byron smiled. "Well, you are telling me something I already know."

"Cheyenne gave me advice. I took it. It worked out pretty good. I just wanted to say thanks to her."

"Yeah, I know. She told me. You don't have to say anything."

"So, we're cool?"

"Philippe . . . I'm not some fucking crazy jealous boyfriend. It's totally cool. And I don't care whatever happened in the bathroom last night, either. It's not a big deal. I was down in the bathroom with Carla. Cheyenne's madder at me for that than I am at her, trust me."

"Okay, okay. That's pretty cool."

“Yeah, I’m a cool guy. I don’t stress. I trust Cheyenne.”

CHAPTER 6

Philippe mounted the steps ahead of him, beer in one hand, the other holding an apple with a bite out of it. They emerged into the hot and bright sunlight. Along the curved bank of seating at the rear, Sullivan sat with his wife Scarlet, the two of them close, Scarlet holding a pillow to her stomach and watching the waves while Sullivan flicked through his phone. Cody sat on an upright chair, long blond hair tied up in a man-bun, chatting with Carla who was laying flat on a lounger in a bikini. Her eyes might have been closed. It was hard to tell behind the black sunglasses.

Byron was happy to see Cheyenne stretched out with Carla, paperback folded open in one hand, the two of them side-by-side, his wife trying to get some color on her skin while she read the newest bestseller. Both girls were beautiful, but it was interesting to see their two distinctly different bodies compared, practically naked. Carla was all woman; big breasts, generous curves, soft tummy but a narrow waist. And Cheyenne was all lean girl curves, long legs and long arms, pert and perky breasts that sat more upright, even when she lay on her back. If you set a golf ball on Carla's tum, it would sit steady in the cup of her navel. If you set it in Cheyenne's, it would roll away and plop to the deck.

Philippe went to sit with Colby, the two of them fist-bumping, then Cody scooting his chair to make space for Philippe to slide one closer. Byron took a spot sitting on the lounge next to his wife, feet on the deck. Philippe's eyes roamed the two women, then looked out to the horizon. Cody looked to Philippe, then to Carla, leaned closer and rested a hand on her knee.

Byron asked Cheyenne how she was doing. She moved a finger on the paperback page like she didn't want to lose the meaning of the sentence while her dumb husband interrupted her. She traced the finger down to the end of the paragraph, then lowered her book. "Peachy, Byron, how's the day-drinking going?"

"I need a nap already," he said.

She ran a hand on his knee, said, "Lay back on the lounge, put your feet up."

"Maybe I will," he said, set his beer bottle on the table behind the loungers, and pulled off his T-shirt. It wasn't even lunch time but the sun was hot. It felt incredible on his bare back. "Yeah, this is perfect," he said.

Cheyenne set her paperback down, and sat up. "Let me get some lotion on you."

"Nah, I got it," he said, "I'm going to lay on my back first, anyway."

He lay down, brain feeling beer-heavy, squirted lotion in a palm, then applied it to his chest, stomach, and arms. Cheyenne resumed reading, Carla stayed quiet, Cody and Philippe leaned close together, talking quietly, Cody still with his hand on Carla's knee, running his thumb on the kneecap.

Carla knee-nudged Cody's hand. Cody lifted the hand and Carla rolled over to lie belly-down. The act of rolling over involved her getting to her knees and elbows for a moment, putting her sexy bubble-butt up in the air. Cody

spanked it and laughed. Carla made an annoyed sound. Her breasts hung forward between her arms. The stretched triangles of the bikini bra could barely contain them, especially when they wanted to hang down.

Carla flattened herself on the lounge, and Byron watched her feet kick, ankles crossed over—

And then caught Cheyenne side-eyeing him.

Byron gave Cheyenne no expression, and she gave him nothing back either. He couldn't help feeling *caught*. But he was just looking that direction, and Carla was on the other side of Cheyenne, so technically he was looking at his wife.

He said to Cheyenne, "How's your book?"

"It's not too bad actually. I didn't have high hopes—"

"Then why are you reading it?"

"Everybody says it's good."

Playful: "You do everything people say is good?"

Cheyenne ignored his dumb statement—she was mad he looked at Carla's tits—and continued. "I don't know, it was just a neat idea about an underwater investigator—a scuba diver—and she has to solve the mystery of this body she found while she was fishing."

Cheyenne continued to tell him about her book. Carla lowered until her breasts squashed on the lounge and turned her head away from them. Philippe was telling Cody how to manage some home renovation project he'd embarked upon. Cheyenne resumed reading, and he settled back in his lounge.

Carla raised up on elbows again, said something to Cody. Cody leaned out of his chair, and untied the back of Carla's bikini top, and flicked the strings away so his wife could get sun on her back without making lines. When Carla began tugging at her bikini bottoms, Byron checked to make sure Cheyenne wasn't watching him again.

Carla scooted the bikini bottoms lower over her butt, and rolled them rearward to get as much sun as she could on her bottom without removing them. His eyes lingered a moment, but then looked away before Cheyenne caught him.

Carla got up on her elbows again, and he shifted his eyes to get a glimpse of her chest. Her breasts were squashed between her arms. Bare. There was something more exciting about not quite being able to see them. The girl had flashed them to him last night, bounced them around while he'd tried to get himself hard, but for some reason, catching this *forbidden* glance was more exciting than that. Carla was looking his way, and he moved his eyes from her breasts.

But Carla was looking at Cheyenne. "Hey, Cheyenne?"

Cheyenne held a finger in place where she was reading. "Yeah?"

"I want to get some sun on my butt. You think it's okay if I strip down?"

Philippe overheard, raised his eyebrows, smirked, and sat back in his chair. Cody followed him, leaning closer and continuing about the carpentry project.

Cheyenne said, "Go ahead."

"You sure?"

Cheyenne closed her book with a finger stuck to hold her place. She said, "Go ahead. I mean it. We all got a good look last night," nodded her chin to

the other side of the deck. “And not just at you.”

Carla looked down her body to where Scarlett and Sullivan still sat far removed from them at the back of the boat, in the curved bench seat. She said, “We got a *real* good look at Sullivan.”

“We sure did,” Cheyenne agreed with a light chuckle.

Carla checked again. “You sure?”

Cheyenne said, “I’m totally fine with it. If there weren’t all these guys around I might join you.”

Philippe said, “I’m totally fine with that too.”

Cody laughed. “Me too.”

“Oh goody,” Cheyenne said sarcastically. “Let me just strip down then.”

Carla stood topless, adjusting her bikini bottoms, pulling them out of her butt crack. Byron looked, then looked away. Looked again—wary of getting caught.

Carla said, “I don’t see what the big deal is. Just join me. We’re the only ones out here.” She scanned the horizon on all sides. “We’re the only ones on the lake.”

“Enjoy yourself,” Cheyenne said, returning to her book.

Carla thumbed down her bikini bottoms, and pulled her legs out of them, her husband, Cody, sitting right behind her looking at her bare ass. Byron stole another quick glance, getting a look at the dimpled cleft between her thighs before she got face down on the lounge again. But now he saw those big breasts dangling free between her arms, saw the nipples briefly before she lay down. He looked away quickly, getting away with it.

“I’m going to join her,” Cody said. “Anybody peeved if I strip down?”

Now Byron itched with sudden bother. Could sympathize with Cheyenne getting jealous when he was looking at Carla. Cody was a good-looking guy, with a head of cool hair and everything. And while he wasn’t some big musclebound dude, Cody was definitely fit. He definitely had a good body. He’d done two tours in Afghanistan as a Ranger. And the guy stayed in shape. They’d seen him all day yesterday with his shirt off. He was lean and tanned, sported abs. Cheyenne had peaked at Cody a few times, and it had bugged him.

With the shirt off, Cody got out of his chair, unbuttoning his shorts, but thankfully leaving the vicinity, walking across to the other side just past Byron’s feet then looking down the side of the yacht to the water far below. He said, “I’m going to do it today.”

Carla looked over her shoulder to see what Cody meant. “Go ahead.”

“You’re not gonna stop me?”

“It’s early in the morning and you haven’t been drinking. Jump away. And like I could stop you, anyway.”

The yacht was four stories tall. A forty-foot drop if you were to jump off from this height of the deck. The water was clear, the day was bright, there was no danger.

Cody said, “Hey, who’s coming with me?”

“I’ll go,” Philippe said, then looking his way: “Byron, you want to jump?”

Byron said, “Carla won’t let me because I’ve been drinking.”

Carla said, “I don’t care if you jump when you’re drunk. I need Cody’s income.”

Cheyenne laughed, reading her book. But now he was watching his wife's profile. She was still facing the book she held open between her knees, but her eyes were raised above the paperback. She leaned aside, grabbed her sunglasses off the table and put them on. Now Byron couldn't tell *where* his wife was looking.

Philippe shrugged off his shirt. He wasn't as lean as Cody, but was bulkier. They were both the same height, an inch or two above six feet. They stood side-by-side, looking over the railing, both of them shirtless, Cody with his shorts unbuttoned.

Cody and Philippe talked, pumping each other up, and made the decision they would do it. They were going to climb over the railing and jump from the outside of the yacht, forty feet to the water below.

Cheyenne said to Carla, "They're crazy."

Byron agreed: "You wouldn't catch me doing it."

Cheyenne laughed and looked his way, but he couldn't read her eyes from behind the sunglasses. She said, "Ever the actuary."

"You might want to tell Carla I would flag her claim if I knew her husband was jumping off of boats like this."

"They already know Cody's a wild man," Carla said. "We pay the wild man premium."

"Shit," he said, "you got me there."

Cheyenne had turned to face the guys, and Byron followed her gaze. They were dropping their shorts. Two good-looking guys with good bodies standing naked now, stepping out of their shorts.

Carla wolf-whistled. Cody spanked his own ass for her.

There was one thing on Byron's mind: wanting to see what his wife had held a toilet paper tube up to. The thing that hung between Philippe's legs. They still looked out over the water, taking their time like they were building up the nerve, shifting their hips, both of them with good asses he was sure Cheyenne appreciated.

Cody said, "It's just the two of us?" looking back to Byron. "You'll do it later?"

"I'm a numbers guy, Cody," he said. "I'm not jumping from the side of the yacht."

Cody shouted to the right, "You want to jump, Sully?"

Sullivan was flicking through his phone, looked up, registered that they were naked, made a weird face, and said, "Have fun, guys."

Cheyenne said, "Looks like it's just you two lunatics."

And now Philippe turned around and Byron got his look.

Philippe's build wasn't chiseled like Cody, but he lifted weights. He was muscular, with a hairy chest, and a smooth but slim midsection. Between his powerful thighs, a wild tangle of thick pubic hair grew above a huge and gnarly penis. Much bigger than a toilet roll. Much, much bigger.

Byron looked up to Philippe's eyes, then back down again, feeling his skin crawl and his scalp tighten. His heart raced thinking of Cheyenne trapped in the small space of that bathroom last night, and Philippe pulling his shorts down and showing her that monster. It was uncircumcised, a darkish red-brown color, completely flaccid but yet somehow threatening. It was the girth. It looked huge between his hairy legs. Philippe was saying, "Any girl takers? Cheyenne, how about you? You want to jump with us?"

Cheyenne was looking right at Philippe. She wore her sunglasses and Byron couldn't tell for sure where her eyes aimed. But he didn't need to verify. Cheyenne got a good look at it in the bathroom last night; he could imagine his wife was looking right at Philippe's enormous penis again.

"All right," Philippe said, "suit yourself," turning around, penis swinging, showing them his bare butt again.

Something caught Byron's attention across the way. It was Scarlet, whose eyebrows had raised high into her hairline. She'd just seen Philippe's penis and was mouthing to Cheyenne, Ooh—myyy-gaawwd!, with a hand to her cheek, mouth open in a shocked O shape—then she broke up laughing silently. Sullivan still flicked through his phone beside her, oblivious to how his wife was reacting.

"You ready?" both guys said, looking at each other, then each hiking one leg over the railing.

With one foot on the other side, they hoisted their other legs over. But in the moment that Philippe had straddled the barrier, somehow his penis had squeezed between his legs, so now his balls and big dick were sandwiched between the barrier railing and his thigh, pushed back toward his butt crack. All his masculine male genitalia contorted into a big impressive bundle of twisted meat showing below his ass. He paused a moment waiting for Cody to get all the way over before he swung his leg up so they wouldn't collide.

Cheyenne was watching. Cheyenne saw that impressive package like a big flesh-pretzel between his legs like that.

Philippe kicked a leg over, his penis and balls slid up and over the railing, and then he was on the other side as well, both guys with hands behind them on the handrail, back muscles bunching. They looked at each other,

Cody said something, then they both leapt out and up, hooting as they went down.

In a quick moment there was the splash as they hit the water.

Cheyenne said, "Should somebody go check on them?"

Carla said, "Their bodies will wash ashore."

Cheyenne turned Byron's way. "You want to go check?"

"I'm napping," he said, feeling too heavy to get out of the lounge. Plus he was concerned that moving around would show off that he'd sprouted half an erection during that strange exchange.

"Well, somebody has to."

Cheyenne looked from him back to Carla, sighed, theatrically closed her book, and pushed herself off the lounge and strode to the side. She looked down over the railing, and watched a moment. She shouted down, "You guys are crazy!"

Philippe and Cody shouted and laughed. Cheyenne stood and watched a moment, came back to the lounge chuckling to herself.

Byron said, "I take it they're alive."

Cheyenne said, "They look pretty good to me."

CHAPTER 7

The nap was real. So real, getting out of its depth was like pulling a bare foot out of a wet rubber boot. And when at last Byron was free from slumber, he was left gasping and blinking. His heart thudded slow. Big heavy bonks, like an old diesel motor trying to turn over. Like the sleep had been so deep his heart had stopped. He touched hands to his hot stomach, licking his lips and looking around like Rip van Winkle. It was bright. It was daytime. Probably hadn't been asleep for more than twenty minutes or half an hour. But his mouth was dry and his brain was foggy. Last thing he remembered was laying here with a racing heartbeat thinking of . . . that *spectacle*. Philippe with his huge dick stuck to the hand-railing. Cheyenne seeing it. Cheyenne seeing it in the bathroom last night.

With a deep inhale, he looked around to assess his surroundings. Cheyenne was absent. The lounge next to him empty. Down at his feet, he could see Sullivan and Scarlett were also gone. But on the lounge on the other side of Cheyenne's empty one, Carla still lay face down, getting sun on her naked back and bare ass. Her head was turned his way, her arms folded up above her head. Her big breasts were squashed against the lounge. Her eyes were closed.

He sat up swiftly, hissing an intake of air, still feeling woozy and groggy.
Where was Cheyenne?

The creaking of his lounge got Carla's eyes fluttering open. She was looking at him. He asked her where Cheyenne went to.

Carla tried to answer, but her lips were stuck together. She licked them. "Swimming," she said.

"Cheyenne went swimming?"

Carla nodded. "Scarlet and Sullivan and her went down."

"Oh yeah?" He tried to get out of the lounge but fell back to sit again. Trying harder, getting out of the lounge now, he walked to the railing and looked below to the lake. Sure enough, there were people swimming down there.

Someone had brought out the huge inflatable raft. It was like an enormous inner tube, but with a trampoline in the center. It was tied to the boat still, but instead of trailing off the back deck, it was now off to the side of the boat where Cody and Philippe had jumped. They were in the water down there. And so was Cheyenne.

The three of them were leaning chins and elbows on the raft's lower edge, talking to each other. It was clear that Cody was still naked because Byron could see Cody's full body, legs kicking to keep him afloat, his bare ass with the split in his crack. Philippe was clockwise from Cody on the far side. Byron could see Cheyenne's face, chin on her folded wrists while she paddled with the guys, talking. No sign of Scarlet and Sullivan.

Byron watched for a moment, but didn't call out to her. She didn't notice him either, and stayed talking with Philippe and Cody. He returned to the lounge. Carla was up on her elbows now, and she held in her right hand a

tube of Hawaiian Tropic. When she heard his footsteps, she looked over her shoulder at him, saying, “Would you get my back for me, please?”

“What, rub lotion on your back?”

Carla flicked him a look and smirked. “I can’t believe you’re not a detective or something. A spy, maybe—what with that piercing intellect.”

“Ha ha,” he pronounced. “I just want to make sure I’m understanding what you’re saying.”

“Would you, please, Byron, my good friend, take this bottle of Hawaiian Tropic that I’m holding in my right hand—it’s the bronzing oil—and apply it to my bare back, beginning somewhere near the top, perhaps my left shoulder, then working—”

“Holy shit,” he said, “what a fucking comedian you are,” and plucked the bottle from her hand.

She laughed, gave him a sly look, tracing her hair off her cheek. “Please, put oil on my back, okay?”

He sat on Cheyenne’s lounge next to Carla, put a hand underneath, and scooted the lounge closer so he could reach her. Cheyenne was down in the water swimming with two naked guys. So what was the big deal? He was going to rub oil on Carla’s back.

But, damn, it was heart racing to see Carla’s naked body right in front of his eyes like this. She had a full figure, a big round bottom, and her skin was absolutely flawless and tanned. Her ass cheeks were paler, but she must sun like this at her and Cody’s home. She raised her feet again, crossing her ankles over, and he looked at the pale soles, the way they scrunched up when she pointed her toes.

Carla said, “Are they still swimming down there?”

“I didn’t see Scarlett and Sullivan.”

“They all went down together.”

“Were they bouncing on the trampoline?” He squirted a coin of Hawaiian Tropic into his hand, then did a childish puff of the tube to blast his nose with the fragrant scent.

He rubbed his hands together over the middle of Carla’s back, droplets of the oil falling to her skin. He watched the way they melted on her beautiful tan.

“I don’t know,” she said. “I guess. I heard yelling like people were having fun.”

He paused now with his two hands hovered out over Carla’s bare back, one between her shoulder blades, the left hand at the narrow of her waist.

If they were jumping on the trampoline, they would be naked. Cheyenne would’ve been watching Philippe and Cody bouncing off that thing, doing back flips into the water like they were doing yesterday—only today their dicks would be flopping all over the place.

Would she go down there with two naked guys and watch them perform for her like that?

That wasn’t like Cheyenne.

And why was his heart racing so hard?

It was the combined thought. It should just be this naked beautiful girl he was about to put hands on—platonically—but he couldn’t help combine it with the terrible idea of Cheyenne down there in the water with two naked guys.

What about that would be thrilling? And all that dirty talk last night?

There was a real weird and kinky feeling inside he couldn't quite figure. Best way to extinguish it was to lay hands on Carla's back.

When his oily palms touched her hot skin, his eyes fluttered at the taboo of it. It was just putting some oil on her back, and it would be gross to let Carla know how much he was enjoying this. But shit, if this was not an erotic *thrill*.

He spread the oil from her ribs up her right shoulder, squeezing her shoulder blades, across to the other shoulder, down those ribs, back up again. He thumbed circles on her shoulder blades and she made a sound like it felt good and he stopped right away. That was massage. She did not ask for a massage, she asked him to put oil on her back.

His heart was beating in his throat now, and his eyes were wide. He slipped oily hands down her waist, stroking his hands up her sides, feeling the suppleness of her sun-scorched skin. "How's that?"

Carla wagged her hips. "Would you mind getting my butt, too?"

"Are you sure?"

"Would you just do it, please? I don't want a bright pink butt. Or can you not keep a secret like that? You going to tell Cheyenne how you rubbed oil on my butt, you blabbermouth?"

"No," he said, getting challenged, remembering that his wife was right now down with two good-looking guys who may have been jumping their naked bodies up and down on a trampoline with their dicks slapping everywhere. And Philippe with that big whopper. He hadn't seen what Cody had, but it couldn't possibly be bigger.

He lay hands on Carla again, putting thumbs in those divots above her ass cheeks, then swiping downward, caressing the globes of her bare ass,

sweeping upward, putting thumbs along either side of her butt crack, spreading oil up to her tailbone. “Thighs?”

“You got it,” she said, and then lightly parted her legs. It was a simple act, but it spiked his adrenaline. Carla parted her legs, and that would give him access to her most sacred and private space. Was it an invitation? *Hey, would you mind rubbing some oil on my clit, please?*

Shit, now he was erect. Scooting down the lounge, running his hands from her waist over her ass, his hands moved down to the backs of her smooth thighs. *What a figure.*

“Going to need some more oil,” he said, voice a little too low and lusty.

Carla gave no answer.

With his hands held up to his chest so the oil wouldn’t drip all over the place, he rose and trotted to the railing edge and peered down. Cheyenne was still talking with two naked guys.

When he returned to the loungers, he stopped short. Carla was rolling over. Up on one elbow, hips turned, knees together, she adjusted her hair again. Her big bare breasts hung down. Then she got on her back, shifting, weight on her elbows, slinking her legs together. Fully frontally naked before him. He returned, flabbergasted, his steps creaky and slow.

She said, “I need my front done, too. Can you do that?”

He swallowed hard. “Uh, yeah. Yeah. I can do that.”

“Checking to see if Cheyenne was still down there?”

“Yeah, she was still swimming.” The oil trickled down his forearms, weaving through the hair.

“She still naked?”

“What do you mean?”

“They all went skinny dipping.”

He said, “Just the guys.”

“No. Cheyenne did too.”

“No, she didn’t.”

“Sure she did.”

His eyes roamed from Carla’s face, her eyes watching his. He was contemplating, but in the act of contemplation, his eyes had lowered to her bare breasts. The raised puffiness of her nipples. Down lower to her navel, and the cleft of her sex between her held together thighs. He looked back to her eyes again. “I don’t care if Cheyenne goes skinny-dipping.”

“Good,” she said.

He said, “Did Sullivan and Scarlett go, too?”

“I don’t think Scarlet did,” she said, “but Sullivan got naked.”

“Uh-huh,” he said, acting like it was all no big deal. “How long was I out for?”

“I don’t know how long. Half an hour?”

“So, Cheyenne’s out there with naked guys.”

“And Scarlet in her one-piece.” Carla laughed, tossing her head back and shaking her hair out.

With the erotic sight of this naked woman before him, so confident with her nudity, confident with her sexuality, and with his wife down swimming with naked guys—naked herself—there were channels opening up inside him,

sluice gates slapping wide to allow the thundering river flow of feelings he'd never had before. Like sexual barriers had just clunked open and all these new feelings were racing through him. Like the day he first discovered you could masturbate and stuff would come out. Something that had never happened to him before, happening all of a sudden, and him liking it.

What was there to like about this situation beyond the naked woman?

He didn't feel like Cheyenne would necessarily be mad at him right now. And if she were, he would challenge her and say, "Weren't you down there with naked guys?" But she would say, "I wasn't rubbing suntan lotion on their naked bodies." And that would be a good point.

But last night, she'd come very close to touching Philippe's penis. And as weird as it was, that did not throw him into a rage. Sure, it twisted him up with jealousy and some bubbling anger, but there was this weird curious sort of dark lusting that sugarcoated those normal feelings of anger and hurt.

He drizzled more suntan lotion oil into a palm, flicked the lid closed, and rubbed his hands together. Carla spied him while he did, giving a sly, knowing look—thinking he wouldn't have the guts to do it. And he wondered if she really wanted him to do it or if this was just one of those things she liked to do to intimidate people to get control of them.

But he wouldn't back down.

Cheyenne wouldn't be up here in time to catch him doing it. And there wasn't much she could say if she did. And he didn't *want* to back down. So, with his freshly oiled hands held out, he lowered them to touch Carla's stomach. She was soft and warm, and when he stroked her ribs, he could feel a grumble inside her like she purred.

Now she closed her eyes and lay back down. A vulnerable act that turned him on like crazy. He absolutely ached between his legs.

While he didn't back down, he was still timid, and that couldn't be helped. His hands stayed to the acceptable parts of Carla's naked body. Rubbing her stomach over and over, coming up to her ribs but staying about an inch below the swell of her big breasts. Back down, thumbs touching her hipbones. But when his thumbs touched her hipbones, an electric shot went through him. It jolted between his legs, making his dick struggle inside his shorts.

Carla's eyes fluttered open. She said, "They all got naked, Byron. You can, too."

"They *all* did? Scarlett didn't."

"I just mean everybody's kinda cool today."

"You're saying I should be cool."

"Don't you want to be like the big kids?"

Byron's eyes went to hers. She had a pretty smile, and it was glossy and pink and tugged to one side right now.

He got up again, crossed over to the railing to peer down. All three of them were still in the water, but not hugging the trampoline. Philippe was swimming nearer to Cheyenne. Cody was dog paddling six feet off from the inner tube. But they weren't returning to the boat, they were just playing around. And sure enough, with Cheyenne away from the inner tube now, he could see that her shoulders were bare. No bikini straps.

A sudden furious thought seized him. He wanted to race down to the water, stand at the swimming deck off the back of the boat and wave Cheyenne in.

Give her some lame ass excuse why she has to get her naked ass back on board. Pull her close to him and protect her from those naked guys.

It took a full half minute of intense focus to stop his legs from zipping him down to the lower deck. He watched. Cheyenne smiled at Philippe. She wasn't touching him, wasn't really close to him. But they were all naked under the water. Maybe she'd seen them naked, bouncing on the trampoline. It wasn't anything she hadn't seen already.

But Cheyenne was having fun. And that was very soothing. If soothing could be *electric*. He was happy she was happy. Happy and yet twisted with worry—but not truly worried.

He looked back to Carla, laying naked on her lounge and waiting for him. Back to Cheyenne. Both sights amazing to see. He didn't know which one to choose. He wished there was a way to choose both. Rub Carla *and* watch his wife swim around naked with two good-looking guys.

Hunched over, he poked with his elbow at his erection to hide it under the bulk of his fly, then returned to the lounge.

Carla's eyes were closed, and he took the opportunity to unbutton his shorts.

CHAPTER 8

B yron unbuttoned his shorts, then slowly zipped the fly down. Carla opened her eyes when he did. Looked down to see that he was taking his shorts off. She closed her eyes again and said nothing. He slipped them down, stayed hunched, kicked the shorts off, but kept them close in case he needed to snatch them back quick. He sat down naked on the lounge next to Carla.

It took a moment of resolve, then he lay his hands on Carla again, stroking up her ribs, then bringing his hands together, like diving into a swimming pool, stroking them up the center of her chest and touching her collar, smoothing her collarbone, coming up to her neck. Carla lifted her chin. He stroked down, this time spreading his hands outward.

He was going to do it.

He brought his hands down over the swoop of her amazing woman flesh, around and over her nipples, watching her skin glisten in the wake of his oily hands, watching her nipples flick as his hands passed over them. Watched her nipples swell and grow larger. He pushed upward, going over the nipples again, down the center of her chest. He played with her like that for a while, spreading the lotion on her. His cock pinched between his

thighs, feeling like a steel rod that had been left out in the sun all day, burning hot on the skin of his inside thighs.

Carla said, “They’re not fragile. You can be a little rougher with them.”

That was a definite invitation. That was about *handling* her breasts. That was not about putting protective sun lotion on her. That was about giving her pleasure.

He ignored her, moving his hands down her ribs again, down over her hipbones, leaning over so he could alternate his hands, easing them down the fronts of her thighs. She parted them, and he could see the neatly tucked folds of her labia. His mind tumbled over, bright whiteness blotting out his vision for a second. He brought his hands up again, his thumbs scooting up the insides of her thighs, pressing down on her flesh and making it swell. But he bailed before he touched her pussy, thumbs working outward, up to her hipbones again, not coming near the part of her that he wanted to touch so bad.

Eyes still closed, Carla said, “It’s pretty bad ass, you know, how you’re not freaking out.”

His eyes focused on the soft, supple shapes of her vulva, legs slightly parted, that plump cloven mound visible to him. From the angle he looked, he couldn’t see the packed layers of her folds, but he was mesmerized getting such a bright daytime look at what should be hidden from other men. He said, “Freak out about what?”

“I like how you’re cool. Like, you checked out Cheyenne, swimming down there with two guys, all of them naked, and you didn’t clasp your hands over the sides of your head like that kid from Home Alone, you know what I’m saying?”

“I’m not exactly tickled.”

“Yeah, right you’re not.”

“I’m not. But I’m not going to freak out.”

“That’s what I’m saying. Look at Arlo and Lily. You think if Lily went out swimming with those guys the way Cheyenne’s doing, that Arlo would just like chill out?”

“No,” he said and laughed.

“Seriously, if that happened with Lily, our whole vacation would be ruined. Arlo would freak out, grab Lily, get on one of those jet-skis and take off for shore.”

“He’s good to her.”

“No, I’m not saying he’s a bad husband. I just mean there’s a certain sense of composure. Like, I know that Arlo can lose his shit over something. But there’s something relaxing about being with you, knowing how you’re . . .”

“Cool?”

“For lack of a better word.”

His eyes were still between her legs.

Carla was quiet while he massaged that area of flesh just below her belly button and inside her hipbones. Stroking up and down, wondering if he would ever have the nerve to touch her pussy. Knowing he shouldn’t. And wait—knowing he *wouldn’t*. Cheyenne was skinny dipping with other guys, but that wasn’t some kind of license.

“I think she’s having fun,” Carla said, like she knew he was thinking of his wife.

“Cheyenne?”

“I think she likes the way things have been going.”

“Yeah. We talked this morning.”

“And you guys never thought about . . . You know . . .?”

“Thought about what?”

Carla took her time, eyes still closed. Her eyebrows rose, and she said calmly: “Swinging.”

He snorted, then chuckled. “What do you mean swinging? Like messing around?”

“You know what I mean.”

Byron drew his hands away from her belly, resting them on his knees now. This was a proposition. He said, “No. I’ve never thought of it,” somehow insulted while also complimented. *Carla would sleep with him.*

“Are you sure you’ve never thought about it?”

“What would make you think I’ve thought about it?”

“That throbbing boner you have,” she said, nodding her chin to his crotch.

He closed his legs together again. “Sorry, that’s from—” And then he was embarrassed to say it was from rubbing her naked body, when he knew it was also from knowing his wife was up to questionable things herself.

“What, from touching my titties? That’s why you had it before you even started? Before I even rolled over.”

“No, I didn’t.”

“You totally did. Just relax. You’re getting uptight and I’m just having a conversation.”

She sat up a little straighter now, adjusted the lever on the back of the lounge, pushed her hair back from her face and lay in the sun again. She ran her hands up and down her stomach, evening out the oil he'd spread on her. "You ought to consider it, you know?"

"I don't think I want to do that."

"You don't think you want to, or you *know* you don't want to?"

He wasn't ready to say outright an no. The answer *was* no. So instead, he said, "Cheyenne would never go for it. She's too jealous."

"You might be surprised."

"She's really jealous."

"You are too. Up to a point."

"I like us being faithful."

"It's not unfaithful if it's something you two do together."

"Both of us?" For some reason, he'd only thought of himself as swinging. Not Cheyenne. Now he was chewing his lower lip, thinking of Cheyenne with Philippe. Thinking of her in that bathroom and how much he hated it and yet it turned him on. "I don't know. . . . Hey, are you saying you guys . . .?"

"Me and Cody? Yeah."

"Both of you guys do that? Swing, I mean."

"Yeah, sure. I mean not every weekend or anything, Byron. A couple times a year we like to have fun."

"Both of you do this?"

Now Carla opened her eyes again, and looked at him with a hand held above her brow to shield the sun. “It’s not a big deal. When we do it, it’s a great kick. And then we go to work on Monday and it’s not a big deal at all. Life as usual. Yeah—we find people we like. Cody finds somebody he likes, I find somebody I like.” She rolled her eyes around then looked at him.

It was *him*.

Did Carla get turned on by putting the toilet paper tube over his dick last night? Now he was complimented again.

“It’s really bright out,” she said. She let her hand fall against his knee. It was held not in a fist but with the flats of her fingers against the pad of her thumb. Her hand glistened with the oil she collected off of her own body. She let her knuckles roll down the inside of his thigh but his legs were too close together. He brought them closer to stop her hand.

She said, “I had a boyfriend in college who went sunning with me naked, got a sunburn on his dick so bad he almost lost his dick.”

He met her gaze, and they both looked at each other, her loose fist paused between his thighs, halfway from knee to scrotum.

His knees widened in small increments, and Carla’s hand slid along his leg, every inch he allowed. Soon her pinky knuckle touched his scrotum and he jolted. He sucked his stomach in and held his breath, eyes electric and darting, hands gripping tight the edge of Cheyenne’s lounge.

His gaze darted from Carla’s eyes to her hand to the stairs where someone might come up and see them. Every protestation formed in his brain but tumbled on his tongue.

He watched now as Carla's fingers curled along the dorsal side of his erection. She was looking at his cock, her eyes right on it. Her thumb touched the underside of his shaft, just above his hanging testicles.

"Holy shit," he sighed.

Carla slid her hand upward on his shaft, pressing along the raised cable edge of his absolutely bursting erection

"We wouldn't want you to lose this nice cock, now would we?"

Her thumb stroked back down, fingers caressing the topside, and he had to stop her. She shouldn't be doing this.

Her hands stroked up again, and a sudden hard brick formed somewhere above his bladder. His eyes opened wide and something startled him. His balls rolled over, his stomach muscles cabled.

"Oh, wait, don't—"

But Carla did. Fingers caressing up the topside, index finger tickling the flared lip of his cock head while her thumb pressed hard under the chin, stroking up to the cloven underside of the hardest erection he could remember.

His hips bucked, his ass muscles flexed. His cock ejaculated.

He hissed, squinted and grimaced. Stomach scrunched hard, holding on for dear life, like a fighter pilot ejected from a plane.

"Shit, oh shit," he grunted, ass muscles jumping, cock flexing, semen squirting.

"Oh Byron, Byron," Carla laughed, snaked her grip a little tighter, then ran the pretty pad of her thumb in dime-size circles, going fast on his frenulum. More semen spurted. Long wiggling ropes danced.

Byron heaved breath, and closed his legs on Carla's arm. She laughed the whole time, saying, "Wow, what a show, look at this . . ."

He grabbed her wrist to stop her. "Holy fuck," he said. "What did you do?"

"I didn't do anything, Byron," she said, laughing. She withdrew her hand, honestly tickled with what happened, smiling wide with her mouth open, looking at his dick. "What a fucking hair-trigger."

"That's never happened before. Oh my God, what did you do?"

"I didn't do anything. I touched you with my thumb, and you hit thermonuclear detonation. Jesus," she said, holding her hand out now, looking at the strands of pearly seamen that went from her index knuckle, zigzagged the back of her hand, across her wrist and all the way up the inside of her forearm.

He said again: "That's never happened. Like that's never happened *ever* before."

"I'm honestly sorry," she said, still laughing, leaning forward, completely buck naked, big breasts swinging. She retrieved her T-shirt, turned it inside out and cleaned her hand. "I swear to God, Byron, I was not trying to make that happen. Are you okay?"

"I'm so fucking . . ." And now the reality was sinking in. Cheyenne. Oh man. "I shouldn't have let you do that," he said.

"I was just playing around. I really didn't think *that* was going to happen."

"I'm so embarrassed."

"Don't be."

"I'm so ashamed."

“It was an accident. Don’t worry, it’s between us. Get your shorts on.”

“Yeah,” he said, “okay hold on,” bewildered, body going through regular day motions now as if the weirdest, strangest, *wrongest* thing in his whole life hadn’t just happened. He pushed his legs through his underwear, brought the shorts up, tucked his lagging erection into his underwear, zipped the fly closed.

“No harm, no foul,” Carla said. “Unless Mr. Big Mouth just *has* to tell Cheyenne.”

“I have to tell her.”

“Don’t do that,” Carla said, hand and arm clean now. “I’ll tell her.”

“Will you?”

She said, “I’ll make it right. Okay?”

“I can’t lie to her.”

“Let me deal with it. Would you let me do that?”

“I can’t believe I did that,” he said again, elbows on his knees now, grabbing his temples and running his fingers through his hair. “What is wrong with me?”

“It’s just an accident. Don’t worry about it. She won’t even be mad. She can’t be mad.” Carla patted his knee.

“What do you mean she can’t be mad?”

“The thing she did with Philippe.”

“The toilet paper tube?”

“Yeah. She can’t say anything.”

“It’s not the same thing.”

Carla’s eyebrows bowed skeptically. “Cheyenne handled Philippe’s dick. And it’s not my fault you’ve got a hair-trigger.”

“Cheyenne didn’t *handle* his dick.”

“Okay, whatever.”

“Who told you she handled it?”

“What did she go down there for?”

He scoffed. “Did *you* handle *my* dick?”

Carla raised her palms. “All right, all right. Cheyenne *didn’t* handle Philippe’s dick. . . . Mission one, Hair-trigger, is I need you to go get me a clean T-shirt okay? Go down to my room—”

He put his hand over the hand on his knee. “You need to knock off the hair-trigger thing. I am not a hair-trigger. That is *not* normal. Not for me. Like never. Not even when I first had sex.”

“You want to know what it was?”

“What?”

“It wasn’t me. It was Cheyenne.”

“What, because I was doing something wrong?”

“No, you were doing something right. Cheyenne was down there with those guys, and you were thinking about it. And you *like* it,” she said, tapping his knee with the index finger.

He should protest, but Carla wasn’t wrong.

She continued. “It’s the newness. The strangeness. Why do you think we like to swing? Do you know how crazy it is when you’ve never been with somebody before, and you’re allowed to do it? And you have, like, weird sex, and you don’t know how it’s going to go. Sometimes it’s amazing, sometimes it’s just okay. . . . Then after, when it’s over, you curl up in bed with the person you love.”

CHAPTER 9

Cheyenne entered their bedroom ahead of him while he held the door. She padded in, flip-flops clicking until she made it to the bedside, pulled her feet out of them, climbed up onto the bed and crawled to the pillows. He closed the door behind him and locked it, crossed to the bed while Cheyenne looked out the window at the water. He joined her on the bed, scooting to lean at her side. Sunlight came in, lower now later in the day, painting his wife's soft features an orangey pink and lighting up her brilliant pupils. She was beautiful, and already complex, but now even more so. And he could see that complexity in her face. That familiar face he saw every day, eyes cast out toward the sun, no makeup today, hair hanging wet around her cheeks, no lipstick, her pink pouted lips open. He could see the line of her lower teeth. He wanted to kiss her so badly. Wanted to convey to her his own complexities.

What went on in Cheyenne's mind? If she were to look at him right now, would she see the machinations working behind his eyes? Cheyenne was the girl he knew the most in his life. Had spent the most time with. And yet the events of last night and today had opened a new doorway into his understanding of her. He'd never worried about her fidelity. She wasn't flirty with other men, didn't talk about guys, didn't have some favorite hunky actor that she loved to watch on the big screen. Maybe that was what

was so intoxicating about this. Seeing her revived, seeing her riled this way. Provoked. Seeing her . . . Aroused.

Without looking toward him, she said, “What did you want to talk about?”

He peered out where she was looking to see if there was something that had her attention. Maybe some naked guys bouncing on a trampoline. But the trampoline floated alone, and Cheyenne looked only at the water. Their faces were close, and he leaned to kiss her cheek.

She bit her lower lip and there was a measurement of worry he could detect there. He didn’t want her to worry about what it was he was going to present to her. Didn’t want her for a moment thinking that this was another fight, or that he was going to drop something heavy in her lap. Although what had happened was heavy, it truly was a regrettable accident. That’s all. But that wasn’t what concerned him. It was the presentation of a crazy idea that could get him in big trouble. Could get him slapped across the face. That wasn’t impossible. He could suggest swinging. She could show a shocked face, the hurt face, lip trembling like she would cry and then *slap*. Thinking all he wanted to do was fuck Carla. And Cheyenne would storm out of here and it would ruin the weekend. Ruin the whole next week. Maybe put an irreparable rift between them. So he had to be careful. This wasn’t about Carla. Not entirely. It really was about Cheyenne.

“I don’t know,” he said, waffling again. Chickening out.

“Just tell me . . . Is it about the inner-tube again because—”

“I told you I’m not mad about that.”

“I know you did. But I also see it from your point of view. I didn’t want to . . .” She crossed her arms, leaned her back against the window, and looked up at their cabin’s ceiling. “I don’t know. I just want to have fun. It’s . . . innocent.”

“I get it.”

“People have funny relationships.”

“What’s funny about ours? What do you mean?”

She said, “No. Not *ours*. Like, take Carla and Cody. You wouldn’t think it to look at them, but they have a *different* kind of lifestyle.”

He frowned. “What do you mean?”

Cheyenne smiled, looking out the window again at whatever it was she imagined had her attention out there. She licked her lips before continuing.

“Carla and Cody are like . . . *open*. They *swing*, if you know what I mean.”

His heart thudded. Some kind of relief, but also that riled feeling again.

“Swing?”

“It’s not crazy,” she said absently, eyes cast out the window.

He said, “Did you talk to Carla? I thought you *didn’t* talk to Carla.”

“I didn’t talk to Carla. What do you mean?”

“Who told you that?”

She opened her mouth to say something, and the small smile she showed faded. She closed her mouth again. He stared at her face, deciphering now what she’d just said. Cheyenne had just done what he came in here to do. He’d come in here to do exactly that. But he didn’t even have the nerve to say it.

His heart beat faster. Carla had told her. Carla had told Cheyenne, and Cheyenne was possibly interested.

Now he was mad. That feeling he’d suspected in his wife raced through him. She wouldn’t even look at him, and he wanted to grab the front of her

sweatshirt and snap her forward . . . But why?

Cheyenne's skirting around asking the same thing you were about to ask. Why would it make you mad because she wanted to do the same thing you do?

He chuckled, groaned, then rubbed the bridge of his nose.

"What?" she said, her voice worried.

"Nothing." He leaned his head with a thunk against the wall and smiled at her.

She said, "Why are you smiling?"

"Yeah," he said. "I know they swing."

She rolled her eyes. At least the small smile returned to her pretty mouth. "I just thought it was crazy," she whispered.

"It is," he said. "Totally crazy. I couldn't believe it when she told me."

Cheyenne faced him. "When did you talk to her?"

"When you left me asleep. She was the only one around when I woke up."

"What did she tell you?"

He sighed, looked around. "She said that she and Cody mess around. Not a ton. Couple of times a year. And just . . . that it really works for them."

Cheyenne laughed, then groaned. "Can you imagine?" She laughed again and folded her arms tighter around herself.

He braced himself. "What do you think?"

She raised her eyebrows, not looking at him. "What do I think of them doing that? Like I said, everybody's got their own thing. I'm not offended

by it or anything. I mean, I can see the . . .”

“See the what? The allure?”

“No,” she said, contemplating. Her brows raised. “Yeah,” she said, changing her mind. “The allure,” she agreed.

“Really?”

“I mean, it’s not for everybody,” she said, and he watched the pointed edge of her canine tooth worry over her plump lower lip. She was nervous and couldn’t ask.

“It’s not for everybody,” he said. “But for some people, I think it makes things better.”

“Better how?”

“I don’t know. Something they can do together. Something that spices them up.”

“It would spice up their own love life,” she said, looking for clarification.

“Yeah. I mean, I’m getting this from Carla, who’s practically a swinger salesperson.”

Cheyenne chuckled, raised a knee and rested an elbow on it. Her thumb and forefinger played with her mouth, and she looked across the room contemplatively.

“You’d have to really love the person you’re with,” he said.

“Yeah,” she agreed, nodding. “You would definitely have to be totally in love with the person you are with.”

“Yeah,” he agreed. They were two people about to ask each other the exact same question, both of them knowing it, but still afraid to be the one to say

it first.

He said, “What are you thinking?”

She raised her eyebrows, sighed, lowered her knee and crossed her arms again. “Nothing,” she said. “What were you thinking?”

“I’m trying to think of what you’re thinking.”

She huffed and smiled. “Good luck with that.”

“What if I guess it right?”

Cheyenne smiled. She smiled and showed him an affectionate gaze that he hadn’t seen for a long time. It’s sparked a nostalgic feeling of togetherness they’d once had. Like when they were fully and crazy in love before they were married. That emotion-heightened time when it was just the two of them against the world. Their problems hadn’t intermingled yet, and their togetherness was a real thing and seemed to have more value. Seemed to be cherished more. The affection she showed him right now was because she’d realized he was on the same page as her and they’d found a route for them to get it on the table.

He wasn’t going to say it. He was going to guess what she was thinking. If he got it wrong, he could pass it off. *I just thought that’s what you were thinking.* If he got it right . . .

Cheyenne said, “Do you need a crystal ball?”

He laughed. “Maybe a Ouija board.”

“Hold on,” she said, “hold on.” She snatched her iPhone from the pouch of her sweatshirt and thumbed out some notes, then put it away, smiling. “That gave me an idea for a shoe design. So, go ahead Mandrake the Magic Mindreader. Scan my thoughts.”

“You were thinking this . . .”

She waited. “Thinking what?”

He said, “Thinking if you could *do* it.”

She smiled. “Do what?” She said it playfully.

“Am I close?”

“I don’t even know what you’re saying yet, Byron.”

“I think you were wondering if you would be able to do it.”

“Me?” she said, putting all five fingers to her chest.

“You were wondering if we were the kind of couple that could do something like that.”

“That’s what you think I was thinking?” Her voice had gone cold, but there was still a warm and engaging spark in her eye.

“I’m pretty sure that’s what you were thinking.”

“You were thinking that I was wondering if you and I would be able to do something like that?”

“*Would* we be able to do it?”

“Would we be the kind of couple that could handle something like that?” she said to herself.

He said, “Do you think we are?”

“Shit, Byron,” she whispered. “What are you saying?” There was a lightness and a playfulness in her tone that excited him. It *was* exactly what she was thinking.

“I got it right,” he said gleefully. “You were wondering if we were the kind of couple who could do that.”

Cheyenne smiled again. “Do *you* think we are?”

CHAPTER 10

Cheyenne's cheeks had blossomed a pinky hue under her suntan. There was a shine to her eyes. Instead of feeling jealous, he was excited for her. Excited that *she* was excited at the prospect of being with Philippe.

"I don't know," he said. "I was thinking about it, too. What kind of couple would you have to be?"

"You said they would have to be in love."

"We're totally in love."

"I really do love you. And I know you love me."

"We've never strayed."

"I've never even thought about it," she said, chuckling.

"Then *why* would we even think about this?"

"I know, right?" she said, still smirking.

"I don't think it's *that* crazy," he said.

"You don't?"

“Do you?”

Cheyenne shook her head no. Not eager, going slow and tentative, still assessing the situation.

They were quiet for a long time, both of them breathing, not looking at each other. They both stared across the room, deep in contemplation. He wanted her to speak first, was dying to hear what her next thought would be, and each heartbeat brought him closer to being the one who would blurt it out.

Cheyenne whispered, “Yeah, I wonder.”

“I wonder too.”

“I mean . . .”

“Yeah?” He turned to face her, scooted closer, and she turned her hips. He put a hand over her knee and thumbed her kneecap. “What do you wonder?”

Cheyenne took a deep breath and said it: “I wonder if we could do that?”

An unstoppable smile spread across his face. “I’ll tell you, even the fact that you’re *wondering* excites me.”

She sucked her lower lip into her mouth and looked in his eyes, showing a glimmer of fear.

He smiled. “It’s so crazy. Not the idea of doing it, but how much excitement I get from the thought of you with another man.”

Her expression scrunched into disbelief. “Are you *serious*?” Her voice was a thin small whisper.

He nodded. “What do you think?”

She put a hand over his, laying on her knee. “I want to hear you ask me.”

“I’ll ask you. I want to hear you ask me, too.”

“You first.”

“I think I might like to give it a try. You know . . . Swing.”

Her eyes widened, her lower lip plopped out. He could see her chest rise and she took another deep breath. She said, “I think I’d like to . . .”

“Sleep with another man.”

Cheyenne gulped, bit her own lips, eyes going even wider. Then a smile brought her lips back to normal. She whispered, “Sleep with another man.”

He swept his hand up her thigh. “Why does that turn me on?”

“I don’t know,” she said, cuddling closer to him. She touched his lower lip. “I have to be honest, Byron: I absolutely *hate* the idea of you with another woman.”

“You don’t want me to?”

“Byron, the only way I would do it is if it was fair.”

“It doesn’t have to be fair. I really am excited.”

“No,” she said. “I don’t want it like that. I would feel . . .”

“Guilty?”

“Totally.”

“Wouldn’t you just feel special?”

She laughed. “I already feel special.”

“You are special,” he said, brought his hand up to cup her neck and thumbed her jawline. She kissed the heel of his hand. This bit of unexpected

honesty was doing something strange to them. Any of that awkwardness and chagrin they held toward each other when they arrived on Friday night was melting. He was accepting her as an individual again. Not as her function as his partner, but a human being, a real live woman he was in love with. And seeing her this way was making him appreciate her. A whole new facet of his wife's shining diamond reflecting light back at him. He brought her in for a kiss. She touched his neck when their lips came together. "This is so crazy," she said before they kissed.

"I want to do it."

"I want to do it too," she said. "I can't believe I want to do it. I can't believe you're not mad."

"I'm excited."

She bit her lower lip. "When?"

"Honest? As soon as possible. Before we come to our senses."

"It's not a good idea if you think we might change our minds."

"I still think we should do it soon. Like, I mean—"

"Tonight?"

"Oh boy," he said, laughing, putting a fist to his chest. "Tonight?"

"Is that too soon?"

"No. I'm the one who said it should be soon. Look at my hands." He held out his hands for her to show they trembled.

She gathered his wrists and brought his hands so she could kiss the backs of both of his knuckles.

She said, "You're right. Soon. Like tonight."

“And you’re not going to be mad at *me*?”

“I’m not *excited*. I’m not excited like you’re excited for me. But I do feel kind of a weird curiosity.” She turned up her nose, made a funny face, shrugged her shoulders up high. “Is that okay?”

“Tell me it’s okay. I have to hear you say it.”

“It’s okay,” she said, some of the glee gone from her now, taking this more seriously, running four fingertips on his chest and watching her hand. “Just don’t like it too much, or anything.”

“I don’t want you to be jealous, Chey.”

“I’m a big girl,” she said. Now she looked up at him, and he kissed her forehead. He ran his hand through his hair, drawing in a deep breath. “What are we supposed to tell Cody?”

“What do you mean?”

He said, “I guess Carla will tell him.”

Cheyenne was still frowning. “Tell him what?”

“That I’m going to . . . you know . . . with Carla.”

Cheyenne frowned at him, shaking her head, lifting a hand up in a *What the fuck are you talking about?* gesture.

He said, “Well, you know. We’re going to . . . What if he doesn’t—”

“He’s going to be with me, Byron. I don’t get what you’re talking about.”

He shook his head. “Cody?”

“What are we talking about here?”

“You and Cody?” He said it as if it just occurred to him.

“What on earth are you talking about? Of course *Cody*. We’re talking about swinging.”

“Ah,” he said, palming his forehead, then running his palm down his nose and over his mouth. Embarrassed.

“What the hell, Byron? Did you want a threesome with Carla, you and me?”

“No,” he said, “no, that’s *not* what I was thinking.”

“What were you thinking?”

“I thought you and . . . Philippe. No?”

Cheyenne laughed and shook her head as she tried to comprehend him. “Philippe’s not a swinger.”

“We’re not either. And he’s single. Plus, I thought, you know, you guys were down in the bathroom for all that time.”

Cheyenne rested a palm on her forehead and chuckled to herself for a good while. Then she said, “You’re so stupid.”

“I *am* so stupid. I was thinking of you and Philippe.”

“Oh,” she said, then he saw her features shrink with disappointment. Her lower lip pooched out. Chey was worried he would call it off now.

“Hey, no, it’s okay,” he said, laughing and circling an arm around her waist and rubbing her back. “I was just mixed up.”

“I don’t want that thing Philippe has anywhere near this area,” she said, circling a hand around her pelvis. “So it’s okay? Me and Cody?”

“I don’t know, yeah,” he said. “Probably even better than you and Philippe.” He was kind of glad Chey was frightened of Philippe’s penis.

“So you thought about me and Philippe?”

“I don’t know why my head was there. It’s just . . . I thought you were attracted to him.”

“This isn’t about attraction.”

“No, I know, you’re right.”

“Are you attracted to Carla?”

“No. That’s not it. Like you said, I’m just—”

“Curious.”

“Yeah, curious. Yeah, you and Cody. That’s even easier to take.”

“Why?” she said and chuckled, slinking against him, purring practically, rubbing his shoulder.

“Like you said—Philippe’s, you know . . . *big* down there.”

“Okay,” she said. “I thought you were worried I was attracted to him.”

“Worried you were attracted to that dong he had.”

“Don’t be gross,” she said, and kissed him again.

And with her body against his, things were happening. He kissed her fully and deeply, wanting her tongue, sucking on her lips and hugging her tight. She began to stroke her knee up and down his thigh, and he grew incredibly hard. While they kissed, he stroked down her arm, took her wrist and guided her hand between his legs. She palmed his aching erection and laughed into his mouth. “This is so for real.”

“This is very, very real, Chey. And it has nothing to do with me and Carla. I’m only thinking about you.”

“You’re bad,” she said, stroking her palm up and down the underside of his erection, and handling his balls.

“Are you bad, too?”

“I guess I am,” she said, and kissed him again. He rolled on top of her, and she hugged him. But when he kneed open one of her thighs, she resisted.

“You don’t want to?”

“I’m *dying* to. I’m really dying to. I want to save it.” She cupped her hands to his cheeks and drummed fingers on his cheekbones.

“I’m so in love with you,” he said and kissed her forehead again.

“And I love you,” she said and kissed his chin.

“But I want rules,” he said.

“Of course,” she said, that loving expression gone as she renewed her serious face. “We should have rules.”

“So what are our rules?” he said, rolling off and laying side-by-side with her. He grimaced and adjusted his pants. She patted his erection, smiling at him.

“Condoms,” he said.

“Of course condoms.”

“How about you? Anything for me to know. Anything off the table?”

She thought about it, her mouth working around.

He said, “What about mouths?”

She raised her eyebrows. “Yeah. I don’t know.” Her brow lowered. “Mouths.”

“What do you think?” he said, his thoughts entirely on whether Carla would go down on him. He hoped the answer was yes.

Cheyenne said, “If you let me, I want to.”

“You *want* to?”

“Use my mouth.”

“On Cody?”

She said, “I’m having trouble—are you understanding what we’re talking about here?”

“Yes, of course, I know. I just . . . It surprises me to hear that. You *want* to go down on Cody?”

“If you’re okay with it.”

He shook his head again, still uncomprehending. “You want to suck Cody’s cock?”

“Can I?”

His features constrained, and his body stiffened. Chey asked him if he was okay. He made a low grumbling sound and rolled over on top of her. She laughed, put her hands on his waist and he humped his erection between her legs. “What the hell, Chey? Why does that turn me on so much?”

“I don’t know,” she said. “I thought we were just coming up with rules.”

“You just hit me over the head with that. You want to suck another man’s cock? You want to suck Cody’s cock?”

“We’re swinging, aren’t we?” she said, smiling.

He stayed still, the belly of his cock mashed into the soft space between her legs. The expression of joy on Cheyenne's face did weird things to his heart. Renewed his love for her in the strangest way. Returned jealousy into the relationship. There were times when they were dating that were so intense because he worried he wouldn't be good enough. Worried she would run off with some other suitor. But he'd won her. Won her and somehow they'd become comfortable and complacent. But now he was rock hard and his heart beat strongly against this strange vice that clamped it. "This is doing *crazy* things to my heart."

"Mine too."

"I love you so much."

She said, "How can this be so right?"

"I have no idea. But it is. Isn't it?"

"I feel, like, so tingly all over."

"Me too," he said. "My heart is absolutely pounding. You better not chicken out," he said and bit her neck.

"You better not either," she said, rubbing hands on his back.

CHAPTER 11

In the lounge on the boat's second deck, an outdoor kitchen area opened to the elements. He found Carla at the barbecue. Philippe and Cody worked in preparing salad, and Lily chopped a cucumber. Carla was bent over the kitchen island where the barbecue was, talking close to Lily, elbows on the granite, hugging her arms. She'd been swimming later in the day, and her hair was still a damp tangle, and now she wore a thick flannel shirt in black-watch plaid. It hung down over her rump, but showing her bare legs, feet tucked into pool slides. She kicked her foot while she talked.

Byron came up behind her, scanning the burgers on the grill, nodding to Cody and Philippe. He flipped the burgers over, and it got Carla's attention, Carla turning now, saying, "Don't touch my burgers."

"They need to be flipped," he said.

"I decide when they need to be flipped."

"So you're the grill master?"

"Get away from my grill," she said, stepping up to him.

In a low voice, he said, "Can we go talk somewhere?"

Carla's eyes darted aside, and with the spatula, she nudged the patties so they were a little straighter, Carla always in control. She said to Lily, "Keep an eye on these so they don't smoke. I'm just going to be a second."

Now she led the way and he followed. They walked to the door that led to the bigger cabins on the second floor, the home theater, the lounge. They congregated in the hall, and she turned, leaned her back and folded her arms. "What's up?"

He said, "I didn't talk to Cheyenne yet, about, you know, *what happened* . . ."

"I didn't talk to her either."

"No," he said, "but get this . . ." Now he paused, building the nerve, running his hands through his hair.

"Just say it."

"What you told me you guys do . . ."

"What we do?"

"You and Cody. How you guys every once in a while . . . you seek certain things outside the marriage . . ."

"Right . . ."

"Well . . . Cheyenne—before I talk to her about, well, you know—she says she knows you guys do that . . . And I think she's . . ."

Carla's pretty face jutted forward, chin first, eyebrows high. "No *way*. You think she's into it?"

"I think she is." He tingled with excitement.

“Cheyenne is? Wow, I didn’t see this coming,” she said. “Hold on, let me get Cody.”

He stayed where he was, crossing his own arms now, walking around in circles waiting as Carla went back out to the kitchen area. Less than a minute later, she returned with Cody, a concerned look on his face, drying his hands in a tea towel. “What’s going on?”

Carla said, “Tell him.”

“You tell him.”

One hand on a hip, Carla regarded her interested husband. “Cheyenne might be into the lifestyle.”

“No shit. Hot damn.” Cody looked stoked.

Carla said, “So what do you think?”

Cody asked, “Does she know who with?”

He said, “You guys.”

Cody’s face brightened, and he looked to Carla. “What do you say?”

Carla just smiled.

“Hey champ,” Cody said, excited, putting his hand out for a shake. Byron didn’t know the protocol, but he shook Cody’s hand. Cody said, “And you’re into it?”

“I think I am.”

“We got to get Cheyenne—where’s Cheyenne?” Cody had that same glee that Cheyenne had when they’d first agreed to this. Was this what the lifestyle was like? Every time it was about to happen you were practically electrified?

Carla said, “Where is she?”

“I think she’s upstairs,” he said.

“Let me get Lily on full-time grill duty. Meet us up in the main kitchen.”

* * *

Cheyenne was already in the main kitchen, pouring herself a glass of wine. Byron came in hot, saying quickly, “They’re coming up to talk to us!”

Cheyenne bobbled her pour, set the bottle down, and steadied her glass. “*Who’s* coming?”

He looked behind him, whispering now, “Carla and Cody.”

Cheyenne patted spilled wine with a folded over paper towel. “What for?”

“I told Carla we might be . . .” He shrugged sheepishly, smiling.

“Oh my God,” Cheyenne said, palming her forehead. “This is for real.”

“It’s for real—you’re not backing out, are you? . . . I told you—”

“I’m not backing out,” she said and began tidying her hair. It was a very natural act, something that shouldn’t bother him, but it did. Preening herself for the arrival of the man she would sleep with tonight.

Coming up the steps now, they heard Carla and Cody talking low. When they got to the main floor, they looked around to make sure they were alone, Cody saying, “Hey, Cheyenne, what’s up?”

“Nothing,” she said, blushing. “What’s up with you?”

“You tell me,” Cody said, all smiles, strutting with his wife until they came together in the space between the island and the counter.

Carla said, “Byron says you might be into this.”

“Yeah,” Cheyenne said. “We kind of talked about it.”

Cody said, “I’m stoked. *So* stoked.”

Chey looked to Cody bashfully. This was a new angle on their friendship. Cheyenne never looked at Cody that way before, but now knowing that she was going to sleep with him, it changed their dynamic. Now she was bashful and timid, and Cody was cocky and confident. Byron was getting aroused. His eyes were glued to their faces, eyes darting back and forth, picking up every minute communication between them. Carla nudged his arm. “How do you want to do it?”

“Fast,” Cheyenne said.

“Not *too* fast,” Cody said and she giggled.

“Soon—she means *soon*,” Byron said.

Cheyenne agreed. “I mean soon.”

“Yeah, soon is good. Tonight.”

Cheyenne gasped, “Tonight?”

Cody was eager. “Totally tonight,” he said, eyeballing her.

Cheyenne said, “Okay.”

Carla said to Byron, “What do you think?”

He said, “The sooner the better. Tonight. How?”

“We can’t let any of these other people know,” Carla said. “Like not even Scarlet and Sullivan. Especially not Arlo and Lily.”

“So how do you want to play it?”

Cody had the answer. “We had a late night last night, everybody’s tired. After dinner we hit the home theater, we start to knock off. Me and Byron,” he said, flicking his fingers to Byron’s chest, “we swap out at midnight. All right? The witching hour.” He made little devil horns with his fingers at his temples.

Cheyenne liked it. “Yeah, the witching hour.”

“At midnight. All right, I’m expecting you in my room, Byron, and Cheyenne, Cody’s coming to see you,” Carla said, pointing at Cheyenne and making sure the instructions were clear. “But we’re not sleeping over. Once we’re done, the guys come back, we wake up tomorrow and pretend nothing happened.”

“Deal?” Cody said, leering at Cheyenne and holding up his manly hand with a pinky finger hooked out.

“Deal,” Cheyenne said, curling her skinny little pinky around his. They shook.

Seeing his wife’s pinky locked with Cody’s, knowing the enormous implication of that simple intertwining, had Byron mesmerized. For the first time he thought it would be best to not do this. To call it off right here on the spot. His heart thudded.

Carla nudged him and he looked her way. She said, “See you at midnight, Tiger,” and eyed him slyly.

Now he was back in again.

CHAPTER 12

The tightness in his stomach made it impossible to eat dinner. Byron picked through the hamburger Carla had grilled, but left half of it on his plate. He picked at the coleslaw, picked at the salad. Mostly just pushed things around his plate. Carla had a good time asking him why he wasn't hungry. *What, you don't like my burger?* She knew why he wasn't hungry. She just liked tormenting him. Every time she asked him, it reminded him the reason why. *Oh, Carla, my stomach feels a little funny because your husband is going to sleep with my wife tonight. And for some reason, I want that to happen. And as much as I want to sleep with you tonight, now that it's going to happen, I have to be honest, I'm feeling a little intimidated.* His bowels had gone squirrely. Even making funny sounds at the table. He was relieved to note, however, that his wife also seemed to suffer the same ailment. Cheyenne was barely able to make it through her dinner, picking and poking at her food. Carla didn't bother Chey the way she went after him.

He wondered how nervous Cheyenne was. Now that they decided to do this thing, did Cheyenne have second thoughts like he did? They *were* going to go through with it; he was pretty sure, but he would like to get a measurement on Cheyenne's anxiety.

After dinner, they congregated on the back deck. Cheyenne said she was going to go in and get cleaned up. He sat out back with Arlo and Sullivan talking about fishing. He passed on the beer because it was too filling, but didn't say no to a bourbon. That was nice and calming, and sitting with those guys took his mind off it. But after half an hour, it was perplexing that Cheyenne hadn't returned.

It got him doing a headcount. An adrenaline spike of worry ripping through him that his wife just couldn't wait to get it done and had slunk off with Cody. It wouldn't be breaking the rules, and yet it *would* be. If Cheyenne were to do that, she would have to let him know ahead of time. Weird how you could have rules in a scenario where there were technically no rules. That was another thing of worry. Somehow, in all the excitement of arranging tonight's activities, he'd let the honesty about what had transpired midday go untold. He was supposed to tell Cheyenne what happened—that he'd touched Carla's naked body, and that Carla had done something he hated to remember.

He excused himself, and moved away from the lounge area at the back of the boat, into the covered section where Carla was sitting with Cody and Scarlet. Carla eyed him the whole way, and he was worried she was thinking that this was some signal from him that they should go do it now. As he walked past them, her head oscillated and before he got out of sight, she said, "Where are you going, tiger?"

"Just up to my room."

"Cheyenne up there?"

He nodded.

"Okay," she said, and smiled slyly.

He made his way to the alley of bedrooms, then could hear the whine of Cheyenne's hairdryer from inside the room. When he opened the door, she was standing bent over, head upside down, brushing out her mane of hair and wafting her blow dryer. The room was warm with the heat of it.

He said, "You're really getting dolled up."

She didn't hear him, still blasting away with the hairdryer. He rubbed the small of her back as he walked past and climbed up to sit on the bed and watch his wife. Watched her pretty body. Missed it. Although it was his, and nothing had changed.

But maybe during the last year, he'd come to take Cheyenne's gifts for granted. Cheyenne was an amazing woman. And Cody was going to find out tonight. Cody was going to find out everything there was to know about Cheyenne's body.

Shit. Just that weird thought had him starting to get hard. He looked at her the way she was, in a pair of cotton sleeping shorts and a tank top. The small of her back was bare, the knobs of her spine raised against her supple skin. He could picture Cody now, coming up behind her this way, putting his dick inside her and fucking her from behind.

Well, that was not making the boner dissipate. He adjusted it in his pants.

Cheyenne shut off the blow dryer, hung it by its loop on a hook on the wall over top of his pajamas. She smiled at him, but there was a mild measure of worry in her eyes. She began scooping her hair back, a hair tie plugged in the corner of her smile. She gathered it all back, then tied it in a tail.

He said again, "You're getting dolled up."

Cheyenne flashed a brief grimace, then rolled her eyes around. "I just want to be clean."

“I get it,” he said. “I’m going to shower, too. I’ll wait until a little later.”

Cheyenne showed a timid pose. “How do I look?”

“Like my wife,” he said.

“I always look like your wife,” she said and smiled. “But really? Do I look okay?”

“Of course you do. Come here.”

Cheyenne came in between his open knees, cupped his face, and kissed him. He held her, ran his hand under the tank top that had fallen around her hips again, and stroked the small of her warm back. Then he cupped her buttocks. Another man was going to hold these tonight. There was no turning back now, because the closer they got, the more excited he grew. The only way it wasn’t going to happen was if Chey chickened out. There was that chance.

Between his legs, his cock had come to life. He let Cheyenne know, taking her wrist, guiding her hand between his legs. He said, “I just want you to know I’m still into this.”

She caressed the hump of his bulge. “I’m into it too.”

“You nervous?”

A booming rap hit their door and both of them jumped like they’d been electrocuted. They broke up laughing. Yes, they were both nervous. From outside in the hall, Arlo said, “Movie time. We’re meeting in the theater.”

“We’ll be out in a minute,” he said, grabbed Cheyenne’s wrist and pulled her back to him. He said, “This is crazy, but I love you, and we can do this.”

She kissed him again, and he held her in his arms.

* * *

The yacht's home theater was a rectangular room with a tremendous LCD screen at one end. The walls were painted black, and purple neon lighting glowed within a recessed valence that ran the edges of the room's ceiling. The space had seating for eight, but there were nine of them now, interspersed and crammed into all the low and very cushy sofa benches. Byron and Cheyenne got a spot on a comfy bench at the side, propped up on pillows. Cheyenne leaned on him while they watched a horror movie. It had been almost impossible to settle on a movie with so many conflicting tastes. So they settled on a drama. But Scarlet realized she'd already seen it. So while a horror movie played out on the screen, he held Cheyenne next to him, not thinking of the movie at all, only thinking of what would happen later. Tonight, he would sneak into Carla's bedroom. He was going to have sex with Carla. Cheyenne was going to let him. It was crazy.

Cheyenne's chin was moving, dragging on his chest.

He followed Cheyenne's line of sight and saw Cody in the back corner mouthing to her. Cody had Carla on his arm, Carla snuggled right up to her husband. Carla was intent on what was happening on the screen, but Cody and Cheyenne were sharing secret communications.

And now he was getting hard again.

He shifted uncomfortably, and that made Cheyenne's chin ride up and down on his chest. She straightened, patted his stomach, sat back and adjusted her hair, smiling Cody's way. Cody was also all smiles, sitting there watching a movie, grinning wide enough to show his teeth. That guy would have his hands all over Cheyenne tonight. Cheyenne *wanted* that guy's hands on her.

"Hey," he whispered to Cheyenne. "I'm going to go jump in the shower now."

“The movie’s not over,” she whispered in return.

“I’ve seen it,” he lied.

The real problem was a growing erection. He didn’t want to sit here being tortured this way amongst all his friends, with his cock poking out the fly of his shorts.

“I’m just going to be fifteen minutes,” he said, squeezing out from next to her, Cheyenne falling into the place where he’d been sitting.

He hunched over, hiding his bulge, and tried walking below the screen. But the screen was low, and his friends were assholes, all yelling at him. Someone was throwing popcorn. He hissed, “I gotta go to the bathroom.”

Then he was out, sliding the glass door behind him. Arlo threw a piece of popcorn that bounced off the glass. He gave Arlo the finger, standing in the door frame in a way that would block any bulge someone might see. Then he was pivoting, heading down the hall. He went up to the bedroom, got his shower kit together, then went into the bathroom. Under the water spray, he stared at his dick, standing upright, its lone eye looking up at him—wondering what the hell he was getting it into. “I don’t know,” he said, “but get ready for a wild night.”

The erection was aching. His stomach was twisted up like a metal pretzel. Never in his life had he thought he would be a swinger. Or into “the lifestyle,” as Carla would say. But holy shit, he couldn’t deny that he’d never been more sexually thrilled in his life. This felt like being a virgin in high school and you were going out with a girl you thought might put her hand in your pants later on. That level of puberty-driven hormones. He was surfing on sex-blinding hyper-focus. All he could think about was his hands on Carla. What her breasts would feel like. What would it would feel like to put it inside her. And conversely, and maybe even more powerful, was the

idea of Cheyenne with another man. A man that she *wanted* to have sex with. And that was the most twisted part. Cheyenne's sexuality was shown to him in an unexpected way.

He lay with his back against the shower stall wall, shower spray hitting him square in the chest. The water hitting him and rolling down his stomach and between his legs was only felt in one place. That throbbing hard-on he had. Just the feel of the water on it was going to set him off.

He levered the shower off, got out and dried, changed into the clothes he would wear tonight to sneak into Carla's bedroom. A good-looking pair of shorts, a plain old black T-shirt. Sensible, attractive, and easily removable.

Once he returned his items and towel to the bedroom, he headed back down to the home theater, figuring the movie would just be about over. Then it would be the time everybody wandered off to bed.

Byron stopped short at the sliding glass door, and his heart thudded. Cheyenne wasn't sitting where he'd left her. Instead, the pale flashing light from the LCD screen lit his wife up now, as she sat in the back row, right up against Philippe.

His breath caught in his throat for a long moment and his temples throbbed. Good Lord.

He slid open the door, tried sneaking in again, closing the door behind him amidst a flurry of popcorn kernels, then darted past the screen, and threw himself back on the bench at the side. He looked to Cheyenne. He gave her a *What are you doing over there?* face.

She rolled her eyes and pushed herself out of the spot next to Philippe. Philippe guided her to stand, his big carpenter's hand on the small of her back.

And shit, that semi-erection that had faded to half-slumber in his underwear surged hard again. He held his hand out, pulled Cheyenne to sit with him. “I can’t take this anymore,” he whispered.

She snuggled against him. “It’s almost time,” she whispered.

CHAPTER 13

Up at the bedroom, Cheyenne went in ahead of him, and he closed the door behind them and leaned his back against it. Cheyenne moved to her purse and rummaged through it. His heart rate was through the roof. The beginnings of a headache worked in his temples. His neck and shoulders had gone tight. He rested his hand in the center of his rib cage, feeling the rapid thump of his beating heart. Cheyenne brought out a makeup clamshell and a tube of lipstick.

The prospect of watching his wife put on makeup so she was attractive to another man put his heart rate up to a higher gear. *Holy shit.*

He checked his watch. “God,” he said. “It’s only eleven-thirty.”

Cheyenne checked out her reflection in the small square mirror above the dresser. She checked the left side, the right side, said to him, “That’s good. Gives everybody a chance to get settled and get into their cabins.”

He muttered, “Then it’s the witching hour.”

He moved behind her, climbed up to put his butt on the bed. Now he lay there on his back, propped up on elbows, knees bent at the bed’s edge. Cheyenne stood and tidied herself in front of the small mirror, oblivious to her husband sitting and watching. All her mental acuity focused on her *date*

tonight. Her date with another man. A date where she knew she was going to be putting out. *Jesus, the whole point of the date was to put out.*

He said, "Can you get up here, please?"

"I'm getting ready."

"It's *killing* me watching you get ready."

"Then don't watch," she said and laughed.

"You look fucking beautiful."

"You think he'll like me?"

"Very funny. We already know he likes you."

"It feels like a date."

"It does feel like a date," he said.

Cheyenne mashed her lips together, wound down her lipstick, threw all her makeup back in her purse. Now she turned and put a hand on her hip and looked at him. She frowned. "That's what you're wearing?"

He looked down at his shirt. "Sorry, my suit's all the way at home. What do you mean, *is this what I'm wearing?*" He plucked at his own shirt. "Is this not good?"

"It's fine," she said.

"We can't all look as good as you do right now."

Cheyenne climbed up on the bed. She'd touched her mouth with a little gloss. Just a dab of color hidden in it, but her lips shone. And the makeup she wore only colored her cheeks. He could see she was already rosy underneath.

“I can’t believe I’m letting another man do this with you.”

“I can’t believe I’m going to let you sleep with crazy Carla.”

“Is it strange that I’m scared?”

“You should be scared. I’d be scared of Carla.”

“You’re not scared of Cody?”

She shook her head no and snuggled closer to him. He moved to kiss her, and she stopped him. “Don’t muss my lips.”

“Cody is going to muss them.”

“If you kiss me, I’ll have to reapply.”

“It makes me hard that I can’t kiss you because you’re saving your lips for another man.”

They both looked at each other with hesitant smiles, pupils darting over one another’s. He slipped a hand up her shirt, felt her warm stomach. Cody would feel her warm stomach tonight. He scooped his hand under the waist of her shorts, and she stopped him. “That’s also for Cody,” she said, soft and timid. Testing him.

“You’re so fucking hot, Chey. This is so crazy—I’m more in love with you now. I feel it so strong. It feels like we just started dating.”

“I like it too,” she said. “Just hold me, okay. We have like twenty minutes.”

That was fine. And Cheyenne snuggled tighter to him and he held her in his arms. Everything was on track. This was going to happen.

And then a thought lurched up at him. Like a hand burst from a grave at the end of a horror movie. Something he’d forgotten.

“Hey, Chey, can you sit up a second?”

He helped her to sit up, and they both faced each other, sitting and leaning back on one hand. Cheyenne looked worried. Worried he was going to cancel.

He said, “I want to tell you something that’s going to sound like a big deal, but it’s not. And though it’s not a big deal, I have to tell you before we . . .”

Her brow furrowed, one eyebrow staying high. She chewed the inside of her lower lip.

“It’s not bad,” he said. “But I have to tell you.”

“Well just tell me already.”

“It’s not a big deal, I swear.”

“The more you say that, Byron . . .” Her voice had gotten thin and tight and now he regretted bringing this up. Should’ve just told her tomorrow. *Why would you do this now?*—Because it would be wrong not to.

He said, “When I woke up today around lunch?”

“Yeah?”

“You were gone. You went swimming. Carla was next to me, sunbathing.”

“I remember.”

“I rubbed—I put lotion on her back.”

“That’s not great.”

“It wasn’t anything. It really wasn’t.”

“That’s it?”

“No. I went to watch you for a bit, and Carla told me that you went naked. I saw you out there with those guys, swimming around. You weren’t wearing anything.”

“We were just having fun.”

“I know— And Carla told me that *everybody* was going naked, so I got naked.”

“Where are you going with this?”

“I told you it’s not bad. Please don’t fret.”

“I’m not fretting.”

Cheyenne *was* fretting. “While I was rubbing lotion on Carla—”

“And she was naked too?”

“It was no big deal.”

“It’s kind of— It’s kind of a big deal.”

“Look, she . . . She may have put her hand on me.”

“Where? On your penis?”

“Right. But it wasn’t—”

“Why would she do that?”

“It wasn’t like that. It wasn’t sensual. She was being controlling, Chey.”

Cheyenne thought about it for a moment. Pictured it. She took a deep breath, let it out slowly. “And that’s all that happened?”

He said, “That’s all that she wanted to happen.”

“What does that mean?”

“Carla was just being sly. You know, putting me in my place. I didn’t want her to do it, and I was going to stop her . . .”

“But you didn’t.”

“I was about to. And then . . .” He rubbed a knuckle against an eyebrow, wincing. Embarrassed now. This was truthful, but it wasn’t exactly a proud and virile moment. “I accidentally . . .”

“What are you saying?”

“She touched me once, I swear, and then . . . I accidentally . . .”

Cheyenne scowled. “Put it in her?”

“What?” he said, incredulous. “Put it in her? No. I wouldn’t do that.”

“Then what are you saying?”

“Jesus, this is embarrassing. I may have, you know . . .” He pointed a finger up in the air, indicating . . .

Cheyenne hesitated. “Ejaculated?”

He looked away.

What he hoped for was maybe a little chuckle. Laughter. *Oh Byron. Good old Byron.*

But when he looked back, Cheyenne was palming her forehead, eyes lowered in deep thought.

He said, “Are you mad?—I hope you’re not thinking that this is why I wanted to do this. I mean, I did kind of want to. You know, after that, but . . .”

“I was the one who asked,” she murmured.

“Yeah. And I’m *so* glad you did,” he said.

“It’s okay,” she said, and put her hand over his.

She said, “I should tell you something, too.”

Now he stiffened. He hadn’t seen this coming.

She said, “While we were out in the water, when we were swimming . . .”

“You and Philippe and Cody. Naked.”

“Yeah. We were kind of horsing around.”

“And what happened?”

“I grabbed his . . .”

“Why? Why— wait, who?”

“Cody. And . . .”

He couldn’t believe what he was hearing. “What?”

“It was under the water and I didn’t realize . . .”

“What?”

“He was hard.”

“Wow,” he said and clutched his heart—grabbed a bunch of the fabric over his chest.

Cheyenne said, “I mean, I shouldn’t have grabbed it at all, Byron, I know. But we were just horsing around in the water, you know, like playing . . . And he wouldn’t let me go, so I was trying to . . . grab his”—now she whispered—“balls. And I got—”

“You got a shock.”

Cheyenne smiled. “Boy, did I.”

That response got him frowning. Aroused again, too. *What was shocking? That he was hard? That he was big?* He’d actually never seen Cody’s penis. He’d imagined it wasn’t small. At least Cheyenne had said she didn’t want Philippe’s enormous package near her privates.

He said, “Why was it shocking?”

“Because it was erect.”

“That’s all?”

“I didn’t . . . I could’ve let go sooner.”

He gave her the response he would like to have heard from her. He chuckled.

She said, “You’re not mad?”

He touched her cheek, then held her chin with a thumb and finger. “You are so cute.”

Cheyenne rolled her eyes, the natural blush of her cheek overpowering her makeup. “It wasn’t a big moment or anything, but our eyes met . . .”

“I don’t really like that. His dick was in your hand.”

“It’s better than what happened with you and . . .”

“I guess.”

“And then later, Cody told me . . .”

“Told you what?”

“About how they do . . . *this* . . .” She wagged a finger back and forth from them toward where Carla and Cody’s room was. *Swapping*.

“So Cody told you and Carla told me?”

She said, “I think we’re prey.”

“I think you might be right.”

Cheyenne’s phone dinged. She sighed, scooted to sit at the bed’s edge, leaned to the counter top and got her phone. Read the text.

“They’re ready.”

He nodded, said, “Are we?”

* * *

With the cabin door cracked open, Byron spied down the hall toward Carla and Cody’s room. It was 11:58. Cheyenne was cozied right up next to him, the two of them crammed in the narrow space in their cabin’s foyer.

“Is he coming?”

“Not yet,” he said.

Then there was movement. Light reflecting on Carla’s cabin door as it was levered from inside and pulled slightly inward.

“Okay,” Byron said, their door opening as well.

He turned, looked into his wife’s eyes. His hands were trembling. He held her waist, stroked up her ribs, said, “You’re going to be okay?”

Cheyenne nodded. Her lips were slightly parted, and she breathed deeply, eyes wide. She said, “You’re going to be okay?”

He said, “I only worry about you,” and pressed her cheek to his shoulder. “You be good,” he said, caressed her hair, and held her neck. “I have to kiss

you.”

“Careful,” she said, and jutted her chin toward him.

He delicately placed his lips on hers, then pulled them back. “You’re beautiful. You’re beautiful and I love you.”

“I love you, too.”

“Okay? It’s go time. You have fun—not *too* much fun—and I’ll see you in an hour.”

“You have fun, too,” she said, her hands touching his waist, then spanking his bottom. “Okay, go.”

“I’m going,” he said. “I love you.”

He stepped into the open door’s space and poked his head out. He looked up and down the hall. Cody stuck his head out. Cody all smiles still. Couldn’t wait to get his hands on Cheyenne.

Then both of them were slipping out, closing the doors behind, but not latching them. Cheyenne held the door levered open on the other side. They both now strolled casually, Cody putting on an act. They came nearer, and Cody put up a fist.

They fist bumped.

Cody said, “Keys are in the ignition. Full tank of gas, put her pedal to the metal and ride that bitch all the way to Mexico,” and kept walking.

With the feel of Cody’s big manly knuckles still pinging against his own smaller hand, he continued on to the door, looking over his shoulder. Cody strutted. Athletic, lean, good looking, wealthy. Cheyenne wanted to sleep with him. And she was going to.

A sudden shade cast across him. Feeling tricked. Like he'd just been manipulated into allowing his wife to cheat on him.

Only that wasn't true. They were in this together.

It was just jealousy twisting at him.

Cody wore a snug fitting T-shirt that hugged the muscles of his shoulders and arms, then grew baggy at his waist. A pair of black cargo shorts that came to his knee. Bare calves showing. Tanned, hairy. Blonde hair. Cheyenne was going to find out what it was like to sleep with a guy with blonde hair and muscles. Blonde hair on his calves.

That urge came again to call this off.

It was pretty cool that they'd come this far.

Maybe he could just say, "Hey wait up, Cody. It's all good. I know I can do it now. But I think what I'm going to do is, you know, sit it out."

But his cabin door opened up. Cheyenne swinging wide to allow her visitor, her booty call, Cody making a sly chuckling sound before slipping into the cabin. The door closed behind him. Cody was in there with Cheyenne.

Now Byron smoothed hands over his chest, stroking down multiple times, preparing himself, staring at the closed door to Carla's cabin. Carla on the other side, waiting for him.

He prepared himself . . .

The door creaked, swung inward. Carla looked out, cross. "Did you get lost?—get the fuck in here. What part don't you understand about being sneaky?"

CHAPTER 14

Being closed alone with Carla in the small space of her cabin was intimidating. Though vivacious, Carla was short and petite—but her confidence took up a lot of space. She looked up at him—no shame, no worry, saying, “Good to see you, Byron.”

“Good to see you, too,” he said, suddenly aware now his testicles had climbed a little high. Things felt a little snug down there. That raging erection he’d had sitting in the cabin with his wife next to him and anticipating a man coming in to take his place and spend some time to get to know Cheyenne carnally had waned. That was fear of Carla. Thoughts of Cheyenne drifted away, and he was mesmerized looking into Carla’s big, expressive eyes. She said, “Come on in and take your coat off, pour a drink, and we’ll sit by the fire for a little while.”

“What fire?” he said as she left him in the foyer and walked the short space toward the bed. She turned and leaned on it.

“What fire, Byron? Good question. The fire in my belly. Come sit next to it.”

“Oh yeah. Did you want a drink?”

“That was a joke, Byron. Meant to make fun of the fact that there should be no formalities this evening. Get those shorts off. Let’s hop into bed.”

“Don’t you want to get to know me first?” he said, kicking off his flip-flops, putting his hands in his pockets, strolling to the center of the room, and leaning on the wall an arm’s distance from Carla.

“I know you, Byron. I know you, and I like you. That’s why you’re here. We can talk if you want. Seriously, tell me what you want.”

“I don’t know what I want,” he said, then sighed. He looked around the room, noted the black space of the windows abutting the bed. That was all water out there. Any boat passing by could look in the windows and maybe get a good view of what was transpiring here. But the windows were tinted, weren’t they? Surely this awful scene wouldn’t be visible to anyone unsuspecting. He crinkled some wrappers in his shorts pocket, tugged them out, and showed Carla. “Look at this,” he said. “Two condoms.”

“Wow, two. Pretty presumptuous.”

“What do you mean?”

“You only get one shot.”

“Oh.”

“I’m kidding. I would’ve figured you’d bring more.”

“I can’t believe I *have* two. Chey and I don’t use them.”

“Chey’s on the pill?”

“Of course. You?”

“Of course.”

“Cheyenne wants me to use condoms.”

“That’s a shame. But I don’t object. If you want to use them.”

“Not me.”

“If Cheyenne wants you to wear them, I think you should wear them.”

“And Cody has condoms?”

“Probably.”

He rubbed the back of his neck. “Well, what if he . . .?” He looked nervously toward the door.

“He has condoms, Byron. We’re not stupid.”

He rolled his eyes, getting jerked around by savvy Carla.

She smiled and patted the bed. “Come sit next to me.”

But he didn’t want to sit. Sitting and talking wasn’t going to make him less nervous. He said, “You stand up.”

Now she smirked and raised her eyebrows. “You going to tell me what to do?” She stood erect, shook her hair out, then brushed it back over her shoulders, stuck her chin out and looked up at him. “Tell me what to do.”

He came closer and tossed the two condoms up onto the bed behind her. His eyes moved from hers down to her chest. She’d worn a tank top and shorts. The tank top hugged her generous bosom. Her breasts were large and teardrop-shaped, and he couldn’t wait to see them again. Couldn’t wait to put his hands on them and explore them fully.

“You can touch them.”

“I know I can touch them,” he said. “That’s what I’m here for.” Putting on the confident act, though his heart was pounding.

“So go on and touch them.”

“Take that top off and show them to me.”

“Yes sir,” she said, peeled up her tank top and tossed it away. Her arms folded behind her back instantly, undid her bra, and shot that off toward the floor as well. She stood there with her big breasts on display, proud of them. He watched as her nipples slowly rose, the buds condensing before his eyes. Now his heart was really pounding. He got closer, and put his hands on them—not as timid as when she’d offered them up earlier today, laying on her back, wanting oil on them. He hefted them. When she wasn’t on her back, they had weight. He liked their soft weight in his hands. He mashed them together and thumbed her nipples. Her nipples got harder. She was smiling. This was so unlike any sex he’d had before. This was sex for sex’s sake. A real booty call. Something he’d never experienced. All his sex was tied up with emotion. Early on, it was after dates where he’d worried about the prospect. And then later, it was in long-lasting relationships. But this was just about bodies. About pleasure. No entanglement. No emotion.

He said, “I like it.”

She said, “There’s two of them. Did you like one more than the other?”

“Not *them*. Of course, I like *them*. I mean *it*. *This*. What we’re doing, Carla.”

“If you can get over the first hurdle, it can be pretty amazing. With the right partner.”

“Am I the right partner?”

“I told you I liked you. You wouldn’t be in my cabin if I was unsure.”

“And is Cody a good partner for Cheyenne?”

Carla smiled and cocked her head now. “That’s a great question, Byron. I love that you asked that. Cody wouldn’t be in there if I didn’t think he was good for Cheyenne. You can trust Cody. He really likes Cheyenne a lot. I mean, he’s going to take great care of her tonight.”

Now his cock jumped. The thrill was back.

He said, “What’s he going to do to her?”

“She’ll tell you. Come on and kiss me.”

With the throbbing erection returned, he felt very happy, slipping a hand up Carla’s naked chest, over her collar, and holding her slender neck. He lowered his mouth to hers and kissed her. Kissed another woman. One who wasn’t his wife. But he was allowed. *And it was wild*. Carla’s lips weren’t like Cheyenne’s. They were soft like Cheyenne’s, and plump, but he could tell them distinctly apart from the woman he loved. “Your tongue,” he whispered.

Carla breathed against him, ran out her little tongue and he sucked it. Now he humped the bulge in his shorts against her stomach. He undid her shorts. She undid his shorts.

“Yeah,” he said. “This is good.”

“Let’s get naked,” she said, stepping aside, dropping her shorts, drawing her legs out, then shoving her panties down to her ankles as well. She helped him get his pants undone, pushing them down, and as soon as his cock bounced free, she put a grip on it and let him deal with getting the shorts off. “Sit up on the bed,” she told him.

He obliged. Fully naked now, putting his butt up on the edge of her bed. Carla shoved his knees wider, got in between them, and kissed his chest.

He cupped the back of her head while she bit and nibbled and kissed her way down his stomach, her hand snaked around his shaft.

She said, “So far, so good. I’m not getting blasted in the face.”

“It was the unexpected.”

“You going to last longer?” she asked, lowering between his legs and looking up at him.

“I will.”

“You sure? I’m going to suck it.”

“I want you to.”

“If you feel the urge, Byron, I want you to know: you can come in my mouth.”

“I can?”

“I don’t have many rules at all,” she said, smiled, and before he could quip in return, her head lowered and he felt the unreal, cool and damp mouth of another woman slide down his shaft. Her tongue worked the belly of his cock and she swallowed him deep, dropping lower, changing the angle, gliding down to his root. He fell back onto his elbows at the wild feeling of her tongue lapping at his balls, with his cock fully in her mouth. “Oh my God,” he gasped.

Carla stroked her head up and down, sucked, brought her hand in, thumb and first finger circling his base, her other hand putting that same ‘OK’ seal around his testicles, bunching them together so she gripped them in her fist.

The feeling was insane. And his eyes widened. The urge to come tickled his prostate. His legs went to steel, and he tried hard to focus on a spot on the ceiling, warning himself not to come.

Yes, it would feel good, but do not go off again so early.

But holy shit, did Carla know how to suck a cock.

She was a level of magnitude beyond anything he'd felt before with a girl's mouth. Pro level. Porn star. The suction was unreal. The manipulation she did with her tongue was crazy. Swirling the pad of her thumb on the base of his cock, stroking with the movement of her mouth. Choking off his ball sack, pulsing her grip on his testicles.

"Okay," he said. "Okay, take it easy." She had him gasping.

Carla laughed with his cock in her mouth, pulled up fully, wiped at her mouth. "You are *leaking*. You were close already."

"Let's take it slow."

"That *was* slow."

He had nothing to say in return. He looked into her eyes, and he didn't even think she was joking.

Carla bit her lower lip, still cleaning her mouth. His cock stood upright, shining with her saliva. She ran her nails down his thighs, then stood up. Now she turned, unzipped a bag on the dresser, pulled out a device that looked like a ring with a small battery attached to the bottom.

"What's that?"

"Give me your dick."

He thumbed it forward, and she slid the ring of the device down his shaft to the base. The small black compartment, the size of a battery, went down between his balls. She flicked a tiny switch on the side and it began to vibrate. "Whoah, hey, I thought we were going to take it easy."

“Come if you want,” she said, leaned close, grabbed his neck and kissed his mouth.

He kissed her in return, then handled her breasts again. She whispered, “You ready to fuck?”

CHAPTER 15

At five minutes to one, Carla was face down on the mattress, elbows out, resting her cheek against the backs of her intertwined hands. They were both naked, and he was straddled across her butt cheeks, his deflated penis nestled in the crack. Carla's laptop was open, and she had Netflix on. She'd been binge-watching *Friends*, and was taking the opportunity while he rubbed her back to squeeze in another episode.

It was the one where they were up all night. Carla's back shook under his stroking hands while Ross and Joey used each other as human ladders to climb up the fire escape. Even he was laughing, despite the wild and unruly thing that had just transpired between him and Carla.

In the trashcan by the bedside, he'd tossed in two filled and tied-off condoms. He'd only brought two. But even if he'd brought three, Carla had emptied him pretty good. There was an odd feeling of contentment now. The deed was done. The deed was done, and it had been fun. Carla had intimidated him the whole time, but he survived. And in the end, he found himself in this strange position with Carla: some sort of carnal camaraderie. They'd been intimate together, and were now back to being friends. But they couldn't go back to being friends the way they were before, because

this thing had transpired between them. So, in fact, while they were not currently having sex—the sex part, the swinging, was completed—here he found himself naked and kind of *comfortable* with her, rubbing her back with an almond-scented massage oil Carla had in her bag of goodies. And it was nice, with the *Friends* episode playing in the background, and him getting to explore her body like this. It was just her back, but they were sharing something. He was delivering pleasure to her with his thumbs, rubbing circles between her shoulder blades and up and down her spine, and around her neck. Being good to her.

At a scene break, he said to her, “It’s almost one o’clock.”

“Yeah,” Carla said, not pausing the show.

He said, “Cody should be back soon.”

“Let them take their time.”

He continued rubbing her back, thinking now of Cheyenne more clearly. Was Chey getting a rubdown from Cody right now? What were *they* doing? How many condoms had they gone through? Was she happy, scared? Where was her head at? The whole while when they’d set this up, giving it the ignition point at midnight, calling it the witching hour, led him to believe this would be a one-hour session. Twelve to one, and it’s done. But now it was one o’clock. It was one o’clock and Carla had said just let them enjoy themselves. But they couldn’t sleep over. He wouldn’t be sleeping in this bed with Carla. And Cody wouldn’t be sleeping in bed with Cheyenne. How long was this supposed to go on?

Now he was smoothing circles on Carla’s back, done with the thumb digging and the muscle kneading, easing into the cool-down phase. Cheyenne loved her Byron back rubs, and he loved to give them. It was another strange aspect of being with someone who wasn’t your wife. He

was so familiar with Cheyenne's back. Now he was familiar with Carla's back. And it seemed more intimate than the fact that he'd been inside her vagina tonight. That had been pure fun. That was the point of this thing, swinging—it was to have *sex*. But he kind of enjoyed this part, too. Getting to explore Carla and please her, and watch how a different woman's skin went supple under his oiled fingertips.

He climbed off her, went to a hanging towel, and dried his hands. Carla said thanks through mushed lips, her head turned away from him toward the laptop, still watching her *Friends* episode. He returned, climbing up on the bed, spending some time on her ass cheeks now. While she watched her show, he lightly drummed on them, watched the flesh ripple, prodded with thumbs and separated her cheeks—which she didn't like, throwing a hand back to swat at his hands. He laughed, and lay down next to her. They watched to the end of the episode. When it was done, she was ready to watch another, but he stopped her. "Shut it off," he said.

"You want to go again?" She got up on her elbows, her big breasts mashed between her arms.

He touched her hair, pushed it back from her face. "I want to get back to Cheyenne. I'm dying to see her."

"Aww, you guys are so cute together."

"It's like one-fifteen. Shouldn't he be done already? What's taking so long?"

"Just let them have fun. They won't be much longer."

Now she shifted her weight to rest on one elbow, reached over and rested a hand on his knee. The hand then slowly slid up and cupped his balls. He opened his legs, and she smiled.

Her petite fingers mushed his cock, squeezing, kneading, resorting to pulling and tugging. She gripped and stroked, but it flopped around.

She said, “I think we killed it.” With his balls in her hand now, her thumb rubbing over their shapes, she said, “Too bad we ran out of condoms.”

“You don’t have any here?”

“We don’t use condoms, either. We’re in the same boat as you. And Cody took all the ones we did have.”

That got his chest tight. Thinking of Cody with a whole roll of condoms in his pocket, eager to use every single one of them.

“Shit,” Carla chuckled, and he looked down to see that his penis was hardening. She was still playing with his balls. She said, “I think this swinging thing suits you.”

He watched as his cock went to steel. He said, “We’ll see what Cheyenne thinks.”

“I don’t know what she *wouldn’t* like. Once you decide to do it, there’s not really much wrong after that. It’s that first hurdle, getting someone to break the barrier. Put down their guard and let it happen. After that . . . It’s all fun and games once you get past the hard part.”

“I guess,” he said. Then: “Can you text him?”

“I don’t know if he brought his phone.”

“I didn’t bring mine. So text him and see if he’s got it with him.”

She cocked an eyebrow. “You want me to bug them?”

“It’s not *bugging* them.”

“Don’t be a nerd.”

“Would you do it, please?”

She let go of his balls, raised both eyebrows and said, “All right, get me my phone.”

Then he was off the bed again, iron-hard boner bobbing, going through her stuff. He found her phone, returned to the bed with it, and handed it to her. She rolled over onto her back, elbowed closed the lid of her laptop. She crossed her legs, one knee upright, her ankle resting on top of it. Wagging her foot, she texted. Then waited.

Byron sat up, looking out the black of the window, seeing if he could discern any waves out there. Minutes went by and there was no response. He leaned forward and kissed Carla’s knee. She lowered her ankle so he could get to it better. Her phone dinged. She read the text, then said to him, “They’re still at it.”

“They *are*?”

Another text came in. Carla said, “Hm. Cheyenne’s sucking his cock right now.”

He went lightheaded and his eyes closed. He leaned his weight against Carla’s knee, pressing his cheekbone against her kneecap. “Oh my God,” he moaned.

Her phone dinged again, and Carla read it. She said, “Cody wants to know if you want a picture of her sucking it.”

Byron jolted upright. His pulse raced as he thought about it. Right now, his wife was sucking Cody’s cock. His heart began thudding in his chest. He said, “I— I don’t know . . . No, I do. I mean, I do know: I— I think I definitely don’t want that.”

Mid-sentence, her phone dinged again. Carla chuckled, set her phone down on her chest. “You don’t have to worry. Cheyenne said no fucking way he was taking a picture.” She laughed, stretched her arms overhead, then cupped her hands behind her neck, smiling at him. Totally naked and carefree, her big beautiful breasts on full display. She nudged his face with her foot. “You could suck my toes if you want.”

He scooted a little closer and kissed the sole of her foot. Carla flexed back her toes and made a purring sound. He kissed the center, between the pads of her toes, then took her big toe in his mouth. It was petite, well-formed, and still smelled like soap. He smiled around the toe plugged in his mouth, watching Carla squirm with pleasure. It was distracting him from what he’d just learned. That’s why he was doing it. But he couldn’t escape it: Cheyenne was sucking Cody’s cock.

Now his heart was beating stronger. He could feel a tightening under his ball sack. He humped the mattress, squashing his cock hard. He sucked her toe, pulled back, and kissed it. He stared at Carla until she asked him what.

“Cheyenne *told* me she wanted to suck Cody’s cock.”

Carla nodded. “Cody’s got a beautiful cock. It’s like a work of art.”

“God,” he moaned at the startling and exquisite hurt that brought him.

Carla said, “Every girl wants to suck Cody’s cock.”

“Oh my God,” he moaned again.

Carla laughed. His hips had turned and his cock stuck out like a throbbing pole. It leaked silvery semen. “Fuck,” she chuckled. “That really makes you hard.” The sight of his arousal brightened Carla, and her eyes shone as she stared at his erection.

CHAPTER 16

The thought of how Cheyenne had seen Cody's cock today when he was jumping up and down on the trampoline obsessed him. *Cody's cock was a work of art that all girls wanted to suck.*

His wife had watched another man's genitalia slap around, and it had riled within her an urge to suck it. Cheyenne *told* him she wanted to do that. He'd given her permission. He'd been aroused by the idea of her wanting to do it. But now he was reading deeper into his wife's thought process. Realizing that she'd seen Cody's penis today, and as Carla said, it was a beautiful one. Could a penis be so beautiful your wife would desire having it in her mouth?

The idea made him rock hard, cock throbbing and pointing upright between his legs.

Carla regarded it, and her hand drifted up his thigh, her nails scratching at his scrotum. She said, "I think this swinging thing's the right thing for you."

"I want to run in there and stop her," he croaked.

"Don't do that."

“No, I wouldn’t. What I mean is, I have this strong urge, and it gets me so crazy inside.”

She whispered, “You know what we should do some time?”

“What’s that?” he asked as Carla circled two fingers and a thumb around his cock. “We ought to let you sit and watch Cody fuck her.”

“Oh shit,” he gasped, flexing his cock in her hand. “No way. I don’t think I could do that. My heart would explode.”

She smiled. “I wouldn’t suggest we do it tonight.”

“Do you think I’ll do this again?”

She began to stroke him a little. “That’s up to you. If Cheyenne has a good time, wants to go again, you know we’re always a phone call away.”

“Wow, I never saw myself like this.”

“No pressure, Byron. Think about it. Think about what she’s doing right now and you’re sitting there watching it happen.”

His stomach sizzled and his eyes closed. His head fell back, and he went into a dreamy space—a black space that he didn’t quite like but didn’t want to leave. Sitting in the room right now, watching Cheyenne suck Cody’s beautiful cock.

Carla was moving, sitting upright, changing positions. She got over him now, breasts hanging down, a smile on her pretty face, urging him to lie back. She kissed his stomach, and he lay a forearm over his brow, feeling heavy and leaden and so incredibly aroused. All of his body tingled, everything focused on one thing. His erection. And his mind was elsewhere. Peripherally aware that it seemed like Carla was going to put it in her

mouth, but 99% of its focus on what was happening with his wife across the hall.

Carla kissed his balls, and he groaned, shifted on the bed, scooted toward the center so she could get comfortable. She lay between his open legs, took his balls in her mouth and sucked them.

Between his legs, Carla said, “You’re thinking about Chey sucking Cody’s cock, aren’t you?”

“I can’t *stop* thinking about it.”

“She’s probably going to town on it right now.” Carla pried his erection upright, ran out her tongue, and licked the belly, drawing her tongue to a point at the very tip, then putting it in her mouth and sinking down. He groaned and cupped her head. Carla was so good at this. Did she know it already? Or did Cody teach her? And if Cody taught her, was Cody teaching Cheyenne right now how to do it so good?

He laughed. The thought was so horrible, so terrible, and yet he loved it. He wanted to be with Cheyenne right now, wanted to know what she was thinking, what she was doing. He cupped hands over his face, kept chuckling as Carla’s head bobbed up and down, his cock fully ensconced in her slippery mouth. She worked him good, that masterful tongue prodding at his testicles, giving good suction, pulling off with a pop. A very wet blow job. Sometimes she would stop, lick the head, and smile at him. And every time he did, he tried to picture Cheyenne’s face as her face, and his cock was Cody’s cock.

It didn’t take long. A few minutes ago, he’d thought he was done. Carla said they’d killed it. But it *wasn’t* over. Carla’s skill was good. All he had to do was sprinkle a little thought of his beloved wife with another man right now and he was ejaculating into Carla’s mouth. And Carla didn’t shy away. She

chuckled and snorted laughter through her nose while he spewed whatever he had left in his testicles down her throat. She played with his balls, squeezed them, held him in her mouth, and swallowed. Kept him there until it was all over and he was left panting, and his cock began to deflate against her tongue. Then she let it slip from her mouth, very happy with herself, patting his belly. “You were thinking about Cheyenne. I totally know you were.”

“Were you thinking of Cody?” he said from behind an arm laid across his face

“No. I was thinking about you and how you are thinking about Cheyenne.”

“I was totally thinking about Cheyenne.”

“Did you tell Cheyenne she could do that?”

“Suck his cock? She asked if she could. I said she could.”

“No. Come in her mouth.”

His legs drew up, and Carla laughed. She rolled out of the way as he pulled his knees up protectively to his cramping stomach. *Would Cody come in his wife's mouth?* He said, “Would you text them again?”

“Leave them alone.” Carla laughed and slapped his thigh.

She studied him for a long moment. “Cody will be back soon. Why don't you rub my back again? You're real good at it.”

“Yeah, all right,” he said. “Roll over.”

Carla rolled onto her tummy again and flipped open her laptop. He slipped off the bed, used a towel again to clean himself, returned, and put a few drops of the almond oil on her bare back. He straddled her, began rubbing. They watched *Friends* together, but his mind was a warm, wet stone.

Fifteen minutes later, Carla's phone dinged again.

He jumped. "Back rub over," he said and lay by her side, watching Friends over her shoulder, refraining from screaming at her to check her phone.

Carla reached for it slowly, waited for the scene to end, then checked her phone.

Byron rubbed his face. "What's going on now?"

"They're done. Cody's coming back," she said, tossing away her phone, closing her laptop, sitting up and spinning to hang her legs off the edge of the bed.

Byron scrambled around her and stood. He began pushing his legs through his shorts, getting his clothing back on. He tidied his hair in the mirror, saying, "So I guess that's it."

"You were a lot of fun, Byron. We should do this again."

"It *was* a lot of fun. Next time . . ."

"I liked *everything* you did."

"I'd like to try some other things. Maybe. You know? . . . Yeah, this was good."

It was uncomfortable. He was unsure how to express what he meant. He'd enjoyed spending time with Carla as an intimate partner. They would go back to being friends now—as best they could—and he didn't know how to express to her without sounding corny what the session with her had meant.

The door clicked behind him, and he skipped aside from Carla as Cody backed into the room, wearing a white terrycloth robe. He closed the door quietly behind him, turned around, and saw Byron. "Hey man, how's it

going? How you guys doing?” He waved to Carla, smoothing her hair back over her shoulders, beautiful breasts gently swaying from side to side.

Carla said, “Hey baby.”

Cody said to Byron, “You good, man?”

“Yeah, how’s Cheyenne?”

Cody performed a silent chef’s kiss, then untied the robe. Byron recognized it as his own robe from his room. Cody shrugged out of it, naked underneath, saying, “Sorry man, had to use your robe. Didn’t want to turn on the light, disturb Chey while I was trying to find my clothes.”

“She’s sleeping?” Cody handed the robe over and Byron held it to his chest, trying not to look down to see naked Cody.

“Not sleeping, just you know . . . Feeling *good*.” He clapped his hands, then patted Byron on the arm. “How’s *my* girl?”

Then he didn’t even wait for an answer, trotting to Carla, who waited for him with her arms open, still seated on the bed. Byron was left in the redolent reek of Cody’s smell. Some kind of soap or cologne that wasn’t familiar to him. And a sex smell. A sweaty smell. And he’d radiated heat. His cheeks had been flushed and his eyes lively. Even as he approached Carla, he was smoothing his hair back from his face and it stayed in place. His hair was sweat-damp. They’d had a real session. This guy just had sex with Cheyenne for almost two hours. Byron’s stomach squirmed, and he watched Carla and Cody kiss.

He said, “I gotta go. I’m going to go get back to my room.”

“Yeah,” they gasped, their kisses breaking for a second. Carla waved and said, “Night Byron—say hey to Chey.”

“Night, Byron,” Cody said, too, still holding Carla’s neck and looking into her eyes.

Byron let his eyes sink down and he got a good look at what Carla had described as a *beautiful* penis. It was. Big and beautiful. It wasn’t even really hard, but just hanging down a few inches below his dangling balls. Smooth and flawless skin, well-proportioned, a large and well-shaped helmet. And as he watched Cody’s cock—took in another man’s genitalia, a manhood his wife was now very familiar with—Cody sat on the bedside as Carla scooted off the bed and dropped between his knees.

She looked up at her husband, saying, “You knocked boots?”

Cody put his hands on the bed behind him, stomach muscles flexing. He said, “We knocked boots, baby. Cheyenne can *knock*.”

Carla kissed inside his thighs, and then she moaned, gasping, “Oh, I can smell her on you, baby.”

She hefted his bulky and half-aroused cock and pushed it into her mouth. Her head bobbed and then she pulled back with a wet pop.

“Mm, I can taste her on you. She’s so sweet. I can taste her on your balls.”

“I got guts deep in her, baby. Mm, she took me all the way.”

Carla moaned like she was in ecstasy. “She’s delicious.” She resumed sucking with vigor.

Byron’s stomach turned over and his heart tightened in his chest. But it must still be working, because now his temples drummed with a galloping, runaway heartbeat. He turned with his robe clutched to his chest, levered open the door and backed out. As he closed it behind him, Carla was still sucking Cody’s big, beautiful cock.

CHAPTER 17

Sullivan drained the main vein, shook it off, flushed, washed his hands, and checked his reflection in the mirror. Light switched off, he was headed back into the dim hallway when he saw across the way Byron's cabin door open. He swung back the door but didn't close it completely. With the light off in the bathroom, he peeped through the crack, waiting to see who was coming.

For over two hours, Byron and Cheyenne had been having *all* kinds of sex. Practically nonstop. Cheyenne was vocal. V-O-C-A-L. It'd kept him and Scarlet awake. He'd thumped on the wall once, and it'd encouraged Cheyenne and Byron to keep it down for a while, but before too long Cheyenne was really shouting again. So Byron's punishment was for him to hide in the dark bathroom like a trapdoor spider and when Byron opened the door, he would jump out and scare the living shit out of his friend. But he had to make sure . . . If it was Cheyenne coming, and not Byron, he'd feel terrible scaring her like that (even though she was the most egregious noisemaker). So he hid and waited.

Byron's door opened, a figure emerged, closed the door behind it very quietly. A figure in a robe. A male figure. Definitely not Cheyenne. He smiled in anticipation. Practically tingling with excitement, unable to

contain himself in the face of this glorious moment, a gleeful thought racing through his mind: he could actually get Byron to pee his pants. Coming out of the bedroom, needing to pee, someone jumps out of the shadows . . . It would serve Byron right.

The figure crossed toward the bathroom door, headed right his way, and as it got closer, he realized that it wasn't Byron. And the figure wasn't headed to the bathroom. Moonlight reflected from the hallway wall onto the face of . . . Cody?

His mouth closed and his eyes widened. Cody returned to his bedroom, opened the door, and closed himself in there.

Sullivan stood for a long moment, his scalp tingling. That was Cody in Byron and Cheyenne's cabin. Was that Cheyenne making that noise? Had they swapped bedrooms, Cody and Carla in next to him and Scarlet, and nobody told him? But then why would Cody return to the other bedroom? His own bedroom.

Sully shook his head, smiled a moment, then the smile faded. Still contemplating.

As he pushed open the bathroom door, Carla's bedroom door opened again. He swung his door closed again and further spied.

Now a figure was backing out of Carla's bedroom. Standing there with a robe in its arms (the robe Cody'd worn?). Looking around, a little bewildered. It was Byron. Byron had been in that bedroom with Carla, he supposed. And Cody had been in the bedroom with Cheyenne?

He watched.

Byron tiptoed across the hall, down two doors, stood for a moment with his hand on the bedroom door lever, took a deep breath, opened it and entered.

The door closed behind him.

Well, holy fucking shit.

He palmed his forehead, contemplating. Chuckled, then wondered if it was funny at all.

What the fuck?

He waited another minute and when he figured the coast was clear, slipped out of the bathroom, tiptoed across and returned to his bedroom on the other side of the hall. Opened the door, closed it behind him. Stood in the dark.

Scarlett's shape humped out the bedding. He tiptoed, went to the wall sconce light, and pulled the dangling cord that turned it on. It was shaded, so not too bright, but still Scarlet complained. "What the hell are you doing? Turn the light off."

He stayed stone quiet, crossing to the bed now, and sitting on it. He sat there waiting for her to turn, his weight on one hand. She looked over her shoulder, agitated. "Am I not going to get *any* fucking sleep tonight?"

"I don't think you are," he said.

She rolled a little further until their eyes met. "What do you mean?"

He palmed his forehead again, and then the chuckles returned.

"What's so funny?"

Now he laughed harder, falling until his head rested on his wife's hip.

Scarlet rolled, sat up. "What's going on?" She was already engaged in some of the glee, smiling, excited to hear what the news might be.

"Oh my God, Scarlet," he said.

“Would you stop it—just tell me what you’re laughing at. Why am I not going to sleep? What is it?”

“I was just in the bathroom,” he said, pointing in the general area of the bathroom with his thumb, “and Byron’s door opens. Byron’s coming out, so I hide in the dark like I’m going to jump out at him . . .”

“Yeah,” she said, thinking the story was ending like how he intended: him scaring the absolute shit out of Byron as punishment for keeping them up with sex noises for two hours, and Byron had pissed his pants.

He said, “Only it *wasn’t* Byron.” He looked into her eyes.

Her mouth fell open. “Did you scare Cheyenne by accident?”

“You’re not following me, Scarlet,” he said.

“What am I not following?”

He was pointing at her, tapping her knee now. “I think you’re right. No—I *know* you’re right.”

She liked that, smiling. “About what?”

“Cody and Carla . . . being . . .” He whispered: “Swingers.”

She gasped, “No way . . .”

He nodded rapidly. “It was Cody coming out of there . . . *Cody* coming out of Cheyenne’s bedroom. That was Cody and Cheyenne having sex for two fucking hours.”

Scarlet’s mouth circled into the shape of a howl and then she covered her face with both hands, eyes widening.

“Can you fucking believe that? And get this—Cody goes back to his bedroom, and a minute later Byron comes out of there. So Byron was in

there with Carla.”

Scarlet threw herself back on the pillows with her hands still on her face.

“You were fucking right,” he said, grabbing her wrists, “and I called you an idiot.”

“You’re the one that’s the idiot, you couldn’t see it,” she said, her hands pulled away now, lips peeled back in laughter.

“They just swung with Cheyenne and Byron. *Byron*—can you believe it?”

“It’s *Cheyenne* I can’t believe.” Her face scrunched up, picturing it.

“Cheyenne with Cody . . .?”

“Cody’s hot,” he said.

“Yeah, he’s *super* hot, but . . .”

She fell for his trap. He pointed at her. “Really? *Super* hot? And you can’t believe Cheyenne would sleep with him . . . Like you’re jealous? Now I’m thinking it’s *you* I gotta keep my eye on.”

Scarlet laughed, shook her head, color coming to her cheeks. “No way,” she said and laughed. “No way.”

His heart thudded. The laughter, the faraway look in her eyes . . . though she was saying “No way,” she was right now considering it, putting herself in Cheyenne’s position with hunky Cody. Only in her mind, but still . . .

The taunt that he had to keep an eye on her was a joke. But there was something in the way Scarlet thought it was so cute and funny to say “No way” over and over again (after just having said Cody was *super* hot) that bothered him.

Scarlet saw the worry in his face and she leaned close and cupped his cheeks. “You’re the only man for me,” she said, and kissed his lips.

He held her neck and kissed her eagerly in return. An erection had grown quite hard in his underwear and he couldn’t wait to show it to her. Maybe they would keep Byron and Cheyenne up for the next little while.

* * *

Scarlet *knew* it. Cody and Cheyenne. Holy shit.

She’d watched Chey today from her lounge, and from the couch, and peering over the railing, and spying from the kitchen. One woman hanging out with two men. Skinny dipping. Her husband napping.

And Sullivan said she was crazy for thinking it.

“I told you,” she scolded him as he got under the sheets with her and began shimmying down her underwear.

“I can’t believe it,” he said and laughed, the sound muffled as he began kissing around her navel.

Truth was: it was kind of hot watching Cheyenne flirt with Cody and Philippe. Sure, she’d shook her head at Cheyenne in secret admonishment, but she’d continued watching, always seeking out new angles, doing it in hiding in hopes of catching something *really* dirty.

And as much as she spied on Cheyenne, she was also getting unshielded looks at the naked bodies of the two hottest guys on the yacht. Cody with his strong and lean body, his tanned skin and blond hair. And what a good-looking dick the guy had. Philippe with his bulk and his big manly hands. God, *his* penis was unreal. A gnarly looking monster that would frighten a

woman. No wonder Cheyenne came back to the card table with those red cheeks after toilet-tubing him.

Sullivan loomed above her with the bedsheet over his shoulders and got her attention. He pushed down his underwear and his erection popped up and bounced. She laughed and squeezed her thighs on him. Then they rolled around on the bed while Sullivan got his underpants off and they were both naked, side by side and face to face, her back against the wall under the window that showed the view of the black lake, the horizon, and the starry night beyond. Sully kissed her and their bodies mashed together. He felt good pressed against her and the sudden flux of wet horniness between her legs shocked her. The sheer *taboo* of what Chey and Byron had done tonight was wildly intoxicating. Definitely not for her and Sully—she'd never let him anywhere near Carla—but the erotic charge she got just from thinking of it was overwhelming. It was her writhing against Sully, tilting her hips to him and dipping her pelvis and seeking his hardness inside her.

“You’re so fucking wet,” he growled and pushed inside her. She grunted and moaned, pulled her hubby to get on top of her. She liked him on top and her knees against his sides. But she closed her eyes a little and thought of Chey. Thought how she must have felt tonight when Cody got on top of her. Those noises Cody conjured out of her were crazy. And he did it to her for two hours.

As Sully thrust his hardness in and out, she raked her nails on his back and let her mind wander. Thought of what it would be like to have Cody on her, and wondered what his penis would be like hard. What would it feel like inside her? It was really big. How big would it get when he was hard? And, oh fuck, *Philippe*. Cody on top of her and Philippe’s muscular hand stroking his monstrous cock while he waited his turn to get in on sweet little Scarlet once Cody had ejaculated deep inside her—

She jolted and gasped, and Sully huffed as she squeezed his ribs with her thighs.

He whispered, “Did you just come already?”

A wet heat raced from her core, razing across her arms and cheeks and neck.

“No,” she lied, and licked her lips.

CHAPTER 18

B yron padded across the hall and down two doors, pausing with his hand on the lever to his room. Cheyenne was on the other side. And while he couldn't wait to see her, there was a hesitation, and a certain amount of jealousy and resentment. Residue left over after seeing Cody naked. His good body. His beautiful dick. Mad a little now that Cheyenne had seen it and wanted it. Had coerced him. But he had to stop that: she *hadn't* coerced him. He was on track to coerce *her*. They'd done this together.

He inhaled, held it, levered open the door.

When he slipped in to his dark room he could feel the difference in humidity and temperature from the hall. And it smelled like sex.

He closed the door quietly, but Cheyenne didn't greet him. At the dresser's side, he could see his wife laying face down on the white bedding. The sheets were tangled around her and twisted between her legs and draped over one arm. She faced outward to the black window that looked out onto the lake. Her hair was a tangled mess on the pillow. He stepped on something slick, lifted his foot, and hopped back on the other one. His hand felt around for the light switch, found it, and flicked the lights on.

Cheyenne groaned, cursed his name in a sound of complaint. Her voice was hoarse. She kicked one foot up, and it flopped back down heavily onto the bed.

“Sorry,” he said. “I stepped on something.”

A condom.

A condom that hadn’t been tied off. Laying on the floor. Another one. And there was another one. Three condoms on the floor. None tied off.

But they didn’t look filled.

He stooped, pinched each of the three by the rolled down ring, careful not to touch anything *male*, and flung their wriggling shapes into the trash can.

And saw there was at least one more condom in the trashcan.

Littered around the room, there were other things, too. Torn open condom packets. Gold foil. Magnums. Magnums for Cody’s big, beautiful cock. Cody’s underwear. A bottle of lube laying on its side. At least the lid was closed. Cody’s shorts, Cody’s shirt. Cody had slipped out of here not wanting to disturb Cheyenne, bypassed his clothes and snatched the robe hanging on the wall.

“By-ron,” Cheyenne complained again, burrowing her face in the pillow, hating the bright light. But in the light he could see her naked, laying in the afterglow of sex with another man. His stomach rolled over, but his heart beat fast with love for her. Her white butt cheeks, her long legs. The tangled mess of her hair. He was watching that beautiful form as he reached back and flicked the light off. Then he was tiptoeing over the cleared floor, disrobing as he went, jumping on the bed naked next to her and slinking his body against hers. “You okay?”

“Mm-yeah,” she mumbled.

“Hey.”

Chey groaned, and he pulled at her shoulder to get her to roll over. She was heavy and enervated, slow to respond to his touch. But she did, her shoulder coming up, rolling over onto her back next to him. He put a hand around her waist.

He said, “Your skin is so hot, it feels like you have a fever. You’re burning up.”

“Yeah,” she sighed, her hand coming up like it weighed two-hundred pounds, resting on her forehead and smoothing her hair away from her face.

“You sure you’re okay?”

“Oh yeah,” she said, chuckling. “Yeah, I’m pretty good.”

“What?—so it was good?”

“Oh yeah, I’ll say.” Chey sounded breathless. And while he felt jealous, he was also inspired to hug her. He snugged her closer, kissed her shoulder and kissed her neck. She chuckled, groaned, fought back with him lifelessly.

“Don’t,” she moaned. “I’m overheating.”

“You’re all sweaty.”

“I know,” she said.

He touched her forehead, could feel the dampness there, then raked fingers through her hair. “Your hair is soaking.”

“Is it?” She touched it again, grabbed her locks and held them in a loose fist. She closed her eyes.

“Don’t go to sleep on me.”

“I’m not,” she said, mouth moving, eyes closed.

He slapped her lightly on the cheek. “Stay with me.”

Another chuckle. “I’m awake.”

“Are you doing this on purpose to make me feel jealous?”

Her brow crinkled. “What do you mean?”

“You’re acting like you just had the best sex of your life.”

“It was good,” she said, eyes still closed.

Now he bit his lower lip, watched her closed off but peaceful face. Lips lightly parted, eyes closed, breathing deeply. Her chest rose and fell with her breath. He brushed a palm over a nipple. It wasn’t bolt upright, but it was still aroused. Down over her ribs, his hands explored all that Cody would have felt tonight. Felt and enjoyed. And would seem had delivered enormous pleasure to as well.

“Cody was good to you?”

Cheyenne nodded. “Did you have fun with Carla?”

“We had fun,” he said and his hand went over the knob of her hipbone. But Chey raised her leg, rolled her hips over, and faced him. Her eyes fluttered open, and she palmed his cheek.

“I’m so sorry.”

His heart thudded. A confession was coming.

I’m in love with Cody now, Byron.

But she said, “I broke a rule.”

He stared at her, saw trouble in her face. “What happened?”

She was worried about telling him, her mouth moving around but not saying anything.

“Tell me,” he said, holding her wrist.

“We got carried away.”

“And what happened?”

“He . . . We ran out of condoms.” Her eyes drifted away.

He nodded, heart, mouth and soul twisting up. “Okay?”

“I broke a *rule*,” she said, pointing out to him what was really wrong.

His heart rate was drumming up quicker. *What was she saying?* He ran his hand up and down her waist, from ribs to hip, feeling the womanly swell of her. Then down the front of her thigh, between her legs.

“No, don’t,” she whispered, going for his wrist.

“He fucked you without a condom?”

“It was so in the moment, I swear. . . . Byron, don’t be mad.”

“I’m not even mad,” he said, thinking how he *wasn’t*. Not mad that she did that at all. He was aroused. *Thunderously* aroused. His cock returned to full and complete hardness. “Let me . . . Let me feel you.”

“I’m really sorry. It was so in the moment and we just got so carried away. I know better, I do. It was a big mistake.”

“I swear I’m not mad,” he said. “Let me feel you.”

Her grip released, and he stuck his hand between her legs, his wife’s nails dragging on his forearm. Her eyebrows raised, but her eyes stayed closed.

Her parted lips parted wider as she felt his fingers nuzzle through her membranes.

“Careful,” she whispered—meaning her sex had been abused tonight. Pounded hard by a big, beautiful cock.

His heart throbbed in his chest.

He watched her face as his fingers stroked through her membranes. Her labia were still full and swollen and sticky. The semen and Chey’s sex-wet made a tacky coating on her skin. But when he parted her labia, he could feel her interior blazing hot and so slippery. He sunk a finger in her shallow depth, watching Chey’s mouth fall open wider. There was the sound of slickness at his touch. Little bubbles bursting against his intrusion. Was that Cody’s semen? *Was he sticking his finger through another man’s load put inside his wife?*

“I can’t take it. . . . I’m sorry,” he said, pulling his finger out, and Cheyenne’s eyes darted open—worried that she was in trouble. But that wasn’t what he meant at all.

He was scrambling over top of her, holding her hands up above her head, pinning her wrists in the pillows, kneeing open her legs, and lowering his ramrod straight cock. It was hard as it could be. He didn’t have to guide it in. Its angle and rigidity found soft woman flesh and parted it easily. He sunk inside her, going slow and careful because she’d been with another man. Another man with a bigger penis.

Byron was tender and caring, but he needed her reclaimed. He took her mouth, she folded her arms around him. Her legs closed on his hips, then her knees slunk up his rib cage and buried in his armpits. Accepting her husband.

“Come inside me,” she whispered, and though he’d already gone off three times in the last two hours, within fifty strokes, he was fully unleashing inside his wife. Stabbing and stabbing, grunting and roaring in her ear, eyes squeezed shut so tight tears streamed.

But there was no sadness, only excitement.

There had never been anything more thrilling sexually in his life than reclaiming his woman. A woman he’d allowed to have pleasure with another man—and she had. Boy, had she *ever*. Now this was putting things straight again. This was making his wife his own.

He thrust again and again, each time more semen spurting from him. The orgasm wracked his body, and he groaned sounds of pure pleasure in Chey’s ear. And Chey gasped with each buck of his hips. Loving him, feeling him, putting her nails through his hair and caressing his scalp.

And that was how he fell asleep.

CHAPTER 19

Cheyenne bit hard on her husband's earlobe to wake him out of his deep and snoring slumber. Then acted like it wasn't her who'd woken him.

She said, "Oh, you up now, baby?"

Byron rubbed his ear and looked around the room, befuddled. His hair stuck up in spiky clumps and his lips pursed in a blubbery line. His squinted eyes roamed the room, like he wondered where the fuck he was. He asked, "What time is it?"

"It's past eight," she told him, but when he nodded and thumped his head back down on the pillow, she pulled on his shoulder to turn him to face her.

He squinted at her, saying, "Huh?"

She patted his cheek. "It's time to get up."

"We're on vacation," he said.

She instructed Byron to sit up. He rolled his head around, stretching his neck, sitting up in lumbering heaves. She said, "You never told me how it was with— You know."

“Carla?” He blinked and sighed, looking around their room. “Nowhere near what it was like for you and Cody, apparently.”

She grimaced. “Well, what did you guys do?”

“We had sex,” he said, “then we watched *Friends* and waited for you to let Cody out of here.”

“What does that mean—‘*Let Cody out of here?*’”

“I don’t know, Chey. It was supposed to be like an hour and you had him in here for two.”

“We were doing what we were supposed to be doing,” she said in a hushed tone, like no one should overhear them even though they were the only two in the room.

“Great. I’m glad. I really am,” he said, and yawned. “Carla and I had sex.”

She chewed the inside of her cheek, studying her husband for signs of deception. “Was it good?”

“Sure it was. I was nervous, though.”

“I was nervous, too.”

“You got over it pretty fast,” he said.

“Why are you attacking me?” This was supposed to be *his* interrogation, not hers. She’d been too out of it last night to get into this, but since she woke up—like two hours ago—it was all she could think of. Her sweet husband had slept with that practical porn star Carla. The things Cody had done to *her* last night were learned in Carla’s bed, Cheyenne was sure, and she hated thinking of Byron engaged in crazy and dirty sex that way.

“I’m not attacking you, baby,” he said and smiled warmly. He touched her arm, held it. “You think I’m not stinging, coming back into our room to find you went through a *barrel* of condoms and went one more time without one? You had sex with Cody for two hours, Chey. When I came in here, you could barely string two words together. I’m not attacking you. I’m trying to recover from what we did last night. *Both* of us.”

“Tell me what *you* did last night,” she said.

“Now *you’re* attacking *me*,” he said, his smile shrinking.

She chewed her cheek again, looking down at the bedsheet space between them. “Sorry,” she muttered. “I just want to know.”

His hand returned to her arm, stroking up and down now. He was smiling again.

She said, “I guess I sound jealous, don’t I?”

“I’m glad you do.”

“You are?”

“I think it might hurt more if you woke up this morning thinking of Cody. The fact you’re jealous and asking me questions means you’re thinking of me.”

She shook her head and looked away from him, feeling embarrassed. Not by what she’d done last night—well, perhaps a little—but because this morning’s provocative line of questioning was coming from that place Byron identified: jealousy. It was shallow and selfish and not what she’d anticipated. Leading up to swapping last night, all she’d considered was whether Byron would go for it. Now it was over, all she considered was should they have done it in the first place. But that was the kind of thing that was more important to consider *before* engaging in a wanton act, rather

than after. “You’ll be happy to hear then that I am very jealous,” she admitted in a timid voice. “Like, almost to the point of blind rage. I’ve got a lid on it because I know it’s not right.”

Byron didn’t answer for a long time and when she regarded him, she saw his expression at the edge of bursting—like he had his *own* lid to contend with. Only, it didn’t seem like rage that filled Byron to the point of bursting. Judging by his wriggling mouth, it seemed to be glee her husband struggled to contain. She said, “What’s so funny?”

His lips blubbered with an exhaled raspberry. He said, “You.”

She smirked. “What’s so funny about me?”

Byron rubbed his forehead, and now her husband showed a dopy grin. She loved to see it. She rolled her eyes. He was happy she was jealous.

Byron said, “I’m your mate.”

She scoffed. “Whatever.”

“Are you my lioness?”

“I’m not a lioness,” she said, getting mad.

“Are you going to fight with Carla?”

“You’d like that, wouldn’t you?”

He shook his head no, and the glee on his face relaxed to show more compassion. He pulled her into his arms and held her, and she rested her cheek against his collar. It felt good to be back with her husband. After the strangeness—no matter how exciting it was—of sex with another man last night, it felt even better than ever before to have Byron hold her. She couldn’t even remember the last time they’d sat together like this, being quiet, breathing, feeling each other’s embrace. Her arms went around him

and hugged their embrace tighter. “Let’s be honest with each other,” she whispered.

“Deal,” he said.

“Would you please tell me what you did with Carla.”

“I guess I go first, huh?”

“I already *told* you, Byron. I was honest with you. Right away, I was honest with you.”

“I know, I’m kidding,” he said. “I want to tell you how it went with Carla because it was just . . . fine.”

“I don’t really believe that, though.”

“Why not?”

“Because it was *Carla*.”

Byron chuckled and squeezed her. “What do you think happened?”

“Tell me.”

“It was fine. I went in, she wanted to get right to it—”

She couldn’t help bristling with anger.

“She’s intimidating. You *know* she is.”

“Yeah. So then?”

Byron’s eyebrows raised. He shrugged, and his reluctance bothered her.

She said, “I know you liked her tits. You played with them, right?”

“I mean, yeah,” he said, sheepishly, and rubbed the back of his neck.

Fucking Carla. “Did you kiss her?”

He nodded and her stomach turned over, picturing it.

He said, “Are you mad at me?”

“No,” she said, hugging him again. “I’m not mad. We wanted to do this thing, and we did it. I have to figure out how I feel, and I know I can’t be a jerk to you about it. I’m not like you: I’m not turned on by thinking of you with Carla.”

“Is it weird that I get crazy about thinking of you with Cody?”

“Or Philippe,” she said and chuckled. Byron flinched, and when he tried to pull away, she hugged him closer. “It’s not weird. It’s not weird at all. Nothing’s weird about us. We were just curious. That’s all.”

Byron breathed heavily, and his weight settled against her like in surrender. He said, “Carla and I had sex twice. But not for a long time.”

She smiled and rubbed his back. Cody didn’t have crazy stamina or anything, but he recovered quickly. She said, “I guess . . . I mean, she probably used her mouth, too?”

“Yeah,” he said, and this time his answer didn’t hurt as bad.

“That’s fine,” she said.

“You wanted to do it with Cody—”

“I know.”

“So, like, did you enjoy it?”

She shrugged now. Answering his questions last night had been easier when she was woozy and sex-drunk. “It was, you know . . . hot.”

“I guess.”

“I did it a couple of times.”

“Like, did it to *finish*?”

She nodded, her chin digging in his collar, anticipating him flying into a rage or something. Byron accepted her answer.

“That’s great, then,” Byron said. “Well, now we know what it’s like to swap.”

“We were targeted, right?”

“Definitely,” he said.

“I wonder how long they wanted to have sex with us.”

“I’m sure Cody wanted to bang you the first time he met you. Carla had to get to know me for a few years first.”

She laughed, feeling so close and together with this lovely man she married—despite the contrary behavior of the previous night. But Carla had worked Byron into a frenzy, and Cody had done the same to her yesterday. He’d got her so horny, and now, a day later, she felt tricked somehow. Even though she got what she wanted, it all seemed to be for the enjoyment of their predatory friends. Cody and Carla both knew their way around a bedroom. They’d swapped before and were good at it. Cody was pro-level. He’d done crazy things to her. Her butt, too. And used his tongue, and all different positions. And he got deep. She and Byron were like cat toys for a couple of sex tigers.

No wonder she’d crossed a line last night.

She brought her head back and looked in Byron’s eyes, thumbing his ear lobes. He said, “What?”

She hugged him again, avoiding his eyes and saying, “Am I any good in bed? Honestly.”

“According to Cody, you are.”

“Really?” she said—with a little too much joy—and darted back to see if Byron was kidding. “What did he say?”

Her husband showed an expression of disdain that she would be excited by that. “He said that you can *knock boots*.”

She cocked her head. “What do you think that means?”

Byron was still bothered, but played along. “Cody put great emphasis on ‘knock.’ He said to Carla, ‘She can *knock*.’”

She grimaced with the discomfort and the not-knowing of what last night’s sex-partner thought of her. “I guess that’s good.”

Byron said, “I’d take it as a compliment. And yes, I agree with Cody: you can *knock boots*.”

She laughed. “Would Carla say *you* were good at knocking boots?”

“She’d say I was good at foot rubs.”

“Ew, you rubbed her feet?”

He frowned. “What?”

“By-ron,” she said, showing him a look of pure disgust.

He broke out laughing and grabbed her wrists. “You gotta be kidding me, Chey.”

She pulled away, but he held her tight and laid her out on her back, straddling her.

“That’s so *personal*,” she lamented, looking away from his eyes like she was bothered.

He said, “That’s something you thought about, whether you were good in bed?”

She nodded. “Of course.”

“You’re the best. The best in bed. The best in everything.”

“Ah, get out of here,” she said, squirming under him.

“I mean it. Cody only got a fraction of how I know you.”

“Oh please. You’re such a sweet talker.”

“You think this is sweet talk?”

“You’re laying it on real thick, Byron.”

“Excuse me for getting mushy about the woman I love.”

This time, she could see a definite sheen to his eyes. They were wet with emotion. Enough emotion she knew not to jibe him this time, to accept his compliments. Because he meant them.

It worsened her guilt.

“Fine,” she whispered. Then petulantly added: “Don’t expect *me* to get mushy.”

“I wouldn’t dream of it,” he said. “Not my ice princess.”

She gave him a dramatic expression of offense. “I’m mushy for you,” she said, meaning it.

“Mushy, huh? Guess what.”

She already saw where his playing was headed. Her right hand traveled from his back and palmed the crotch of his boxers. His cock was hard as stone. She smiled, but broke the bad news: “No, Byron. It’s enough already. I can’t take it anymore.”

CHAPTER 20

As they got nearer the kitchen and could hear everyone's voices, she lost her nerve and fell behind Byron. Byron turned to say something to her, then had to turn around to find her. "Get up here," he mouthed. They stopped in the hall, facing each other. She'd tucked her hands under her armpits and her stomach screwed up tight and uneasy. Everyone was already up and they were all laughing and having a good time. She smelled toast and bacon and ketchup and coffee. She was hungry as hell—no kidding: sex with Cody burned a lot of calories—but she could hear amongst the throng of voices those of Carla and Cody, and she didn't know what would happen when she was face to face with them. And why did they both sound so happy and carefree?

She presented that fact to Byron. Byron held her shoulders, saying, "Of course those two are fine this morning. They do this all the time." Then he rolled his eyes around and said, "Well, not *all* the time. A couple times a year, Carla said. But I bet when they started, they went at it like crazy."

She smiled and traced hair behind her ear, then looked toward the kitchen at the end of the hall where the voices were coming from. "Yes," she said, "they've done it all before."

“Don’t lose your nerve,” Byron said, and for the first time since they woke, she saw some unsureness in her husband’s eyes. His expression grew more serious, and he said, “Don’t freak out. Don’t have a panic attack or something, you hear? Don’t give it away. I don’t want anyone to know what we did.”

“You think *I* do? How about you— How about *you* don’t have a freaking panic attack.”

“I’ve never had a panic attack.”

She said, “That’s not fair, Byron.”

A voice from the kitchen barreled down the hall to them: “Good mor-ning, sleepyheads.”

And like that, she and Byron got into character. Put to the test, they both recovered and stretched happy, innocent faces. “Morning,” she shouted to Sullivan, who stood with a cup of coffee, wearing a T-shirt and swim trunks. Sullivan nodded in return and continued to stare at them. There was a certain smugness she didn’t like. Like Sully knew what they did.

And as if Byron could read her mind, he whispered, “We’re the last ones up. He called us sleepyheads. Don’t lose your cool.”

“I *won’t*,” she hissed, and walked away from his grip on her shoulders.

Now out in front of her husband, and marching toward the kitchen, she poked Sullivan in the stomach as she passed, making him flinch. “So what if we slept in?”

Sullivan’s voice trailed from behind her: “You were up all night. I’m sure you needed your beauty sleep.”

She wheeled like she was ready to fight. But Byron had joined them in the kitchen, coming up and squeezing Sullivan's collar, making him flinch and spill coffee over the edge of his cup. Byron said, "Oh, did we keep you awake?" sucked his finger, then poked it in Sullivan's ear. The two of them engaged in horseplay for a second, Sully setting down his coffee cup on the kitchen island. She turned and went to the sink to pour herself a glass of water. Eyes were on her. *So what?* So Sullivan—and therefore Scarlet, probably—heard her having sex last night. They would think it was with Byron, and Byron confirmed that. They had sex last night. That's what married couples do. Get a grip.

She pulled out a glass from the cupboard and half-filled it from a jug on the counter, still ignoring everyone at the table, pulling down her multivitamins and popping one, knocking it back with a big chug of water. When she turned, no one faced her. Everyone at the table, Sullivan now with Byron in a headlock, wailing soft fluttering punches to Byron's exposed kidneys. Byron brought his hand up between Sullivan's leg like an ax and chopped Sullivan's package. Sullivan howled and jumped, letting the headlock go. Everyone at the table laughed as Sullivan walked it off, hunched over and grimacing. "Barely got me," he wheezed.

"I'm a street fighter, Sully. No rules on the streets," Byron said. "I *collect* family jewels."

Carla laughed out brightly at that, and a jealous flare shot through Cheyenne. Like Carla shouldn't be allowed to laugh at her husband's jokes. So she laughed even louder. Everyone at the table looked at her.

She said, "Scarlet, come get your man an ice pack."

Scarlet stared at her with a shrunken expression but eyes big and wide.

Cheyenne frowned. "What?"

Scarlet shrugged, pulled over a piece of toast and buttered it.

Cheyenne asked the table how fresh the coffee was. Cody scooted back his chair and came over. “Pretty fresh, Chey. I’ll pour you a cup while you fix yourself a plate. There’s bacon still in the pan.”

Sullivan came around the island, cheeks reddened by the fake wrestling and the blow to his testicles. He said, “Byron fights dirty, Chey. Did you know your husband has no honor?”

She said, “He *has* honor—” then shut her mouth. Sully was just joking around. They did this shit all the time. No need to defend Byron against claims of disrepute. “You just need to keep your guard up.”

Cody said, “Or down,” and laughed. He set a coffee mug on the counter and slid it her way. “How you take it, Chey? Tell me how you like it.”

It froze her, and her eyes flitted nervously to Cody. Smug. Doing it on purpose. Rattling her or riling her. Working her. Like he’d worked her last night. He wore a loose-fitting tank top and board shorts. Bare feet. His muscular arms showed, one elbow on the counter as he leaned on it, giving her sleepy and *very* sexy eyes that dazzled in the sunlight coming through the yacht’s kitchen windows. Her cheeks heated, and she glanced at the table. Arlo and Lily and Scarlet were eating. Byron had taken a seat as well—on the same side as Carla, so he wouldn’t have to face her. Byron watched her with Cody. No one else looked her way but Carla. Carla seemed to enjoy watching Cody make her anxious.

Since she hadn’t answered, Cody said in a low and lusty voice, “If you don’t tell me how you want it, I’m just going to guess and see how you react.”

“Yeah, you’re a good guesser,” she said, and regretted it. Just squirting fuel on this fire she wanted contained.

Cody's handsome smile spread wider. He said, "I can try anything I want?"

Her eyes flitted to the table, and though no one was watching, she said loudly, "Well, I don't want ketchup or anything like that."

Cody's smile stayed confident. He said, "I bet you'd like a little bit of coconut oil. Makes it nice and smooth."

The heat blazed hotter from her cheeks now, and across the back of her neck. And though it was the worst thing possible, her body betrayed her. Her nipples hardened, and she looked down to see if they were visible. They were visible.

She sneered at Cody, who'd also noted the rapid hardening of her nipples, and leaned both elbows on the counter, pretending to look out at the brilliant lake view instead of concealing the buds pushing out her shirt.

Cody said, "Do you like it sweet? Maybe with a little *cream*?"

Holy Jesus. She mushed her lips together, tried not to burst out in nervous giggles. She said, "Double-double."

"Toil and trouble," Cody said, rose from the counter and snatched a cream pitcher. He poured a generous line into her black coffee and then two spoonfuls of sugar. He said, "Don't forget to grab yourself some bacon."

She met his eyes and said, "I don't like meat in the morning." A lame and flopping attempt at coy double entendre like Cody. But she had no confidence, had no game—not the way Cody did. She watched his face go through a series of amused poses. Raising an eyebrow, smile going one way, then the other. Like he was going to say something, but out of compassion decided to leave her alone. "That's up to you," he said. "Plenty on the pan. There's toast on the table and I'll scramble you up some eggs if you want. We got some left over, but they'll be cold already."

“I just think I’d like some coffee and some fresh air.”

Cody paused halfway to the table, turned, and opened the door that led up the short series of steps to the deck. “After you,” he said.

Byron and Carla watched as she passed the table, walking underneath Cody’s arm as he held open the door for her. Also watching her from over top of her coffee mug was Scarlet. A definite look of appraisal. Something changed, and she hoped Scarlet was mad that she thought Byron and she had kept them up having noisy sex. Maybe that’s all it was. Maybe Scarlet saw her and Byron in a new light, not knowing that Cheyenne and Byron could be such dirty, long-lasting dogs in the bedroom. Of course, it wasn’t her and Byron. It was her and Carla’s husband—the man following her up the stairs, his eyes level with her bottom. Though she was self-conscious, what was the point? Cody had seen it naked last night. He’d grabbed it and slapped it. Had used his tongue back there, had put that beautiful cock back there. She folded her arms again overtop of her hardened nipples. Could feel their swollen buds on the inside of her arms.

Out in the fresh air at last, she breathed deep, leaned on the handrail as if she’d just run up a flight of a hundred stairs. Cody laughed, coming up to join her. “How you doing this morning?”

She peeped over her shoulder at him, standing there with the breeze tossing his thick golden locks as he squinted into the sun. His face was handsome and chiseled, the tendons standing out in his neck. She’d kissed that spot right there, midway between the corner of his jaw and his collarbone. She’d bit and suckled, and Cody had laughed and pulled her off, saying Carla doesn’t like if you put a mark on him. She hadn’t put a mark on him. At least not there. But right now she could see her teeth marks on the inside of his right forearm. She’d been flat out on the bed, and he’d mounted her from behind. Not in her back hole, but right where it was supposed to go.

Right where she *begged* him to put it. And he'd hooked an arm around her neck and throat, and fucked her so hard and so good she'd sunk her teeth into his muscle when she came. She said, "Good. How are you doing this morning?"

"Never better," he said and tossed down next to her, imitating her pose with forearms draped over the handrail. His longish blond hair framed the sides of his face and he pushed back one side with a masculine and tanned hand.

She said, "That was some risky talk back there."

"Just wanted to know how you take your coffee."

She snorted and covered her mouth. "Yeah, right," she said. "How I take my . . . coffee."

"I know just about everything else about you. I don't know why you're being so miserly with how you take your brew."

"You're a devil," she said, then laughed and sipped her coffee.

"How's Byron this morning?"

She thought about it a moment, watching the waves. She said, "He's really good, actually." She said it how she meant it: she *was* surprised it had gone so well.

"Hot damn," Cody said, flexed his shoulders and biceps, hunched up his shoulders and smiled, looking straight down at the water below. "That is good news."

"We definitely got away with it."

Cody said, "He say anything about Carla?"

"Not much."

Cody showed her a sly smile. “He have a good time?”

“I think he did. He seems more interested in what I did with you.”

“Hot damn again,” he muttered.

She peeked over at him, enjoyed seeing him so pleased. He was definitely a fun guy. Super good-looking, really confident. A man, but with a boyish charm and sense of adventure. Last night in bed, everything he did to her—even the dirtiest things—were about having fun.

She smiled and waited for him to see it.

He said, “I’m ready for more,” smile widening, then getting serious again, giving her a sultry stare, dipping his wide chin down and shooting those icy blue eyes at her from under his brow. “I’m up for it if you are, Chey.”

CHAPTER 21

It drove him crazy that Cody and Chey were outside together and he had to sit at the table and act normal. Though his appetite was dashed when the two of them walked out together, he poked his fork through the cold scrambled eggs and nibbled at his toast. Scarlet side-eyed him. Lily and Arlo laughed together and made small talk and plans for the day. Sullivan lurked in the kitchen by the island. It was clear that Scarlet and Sullivan overheard them last night—thinking it was Byron and Chey going at it for two hours. He pushed his plate away, then folded his hands together in the attitude of prayer, knees and feet dancing up and down under the table. It took great effort for him not to bustle away from the table, go up to the deck and see what Chey and Cody were up to. His stomach twisted in a tidy knot of fear, angst, and lust. And none of it could show.

He pulled over Arlo and Lily's plates and stacked them on top of his, but as his butt lifted off the chair to head into the kitchen to get his hands busy doing some chores, Carla scooted over two seats to sit at his side. She shoved the plates away saying, "Hey Lily, can you throw these in the sink. Byron and I will do them in a couple of minutes."

Arlo said, "Sure thing," nudging in front of his wife and dutifully taking the dirty plates into the kitchen.

When they were alone, Carla rested her palm on the bare skin of his thigh below the hem of his shorts. It got him jolting. He put his hand down and slid hers off. She squeezed his knee before putting her elbows on the table, linking her fingers together and resting her cheek on her intertwined hands. She smiled at him, and he smiled in return, though much more timidly. She said, “How are you this morning, tiger?”

“Fine,” he said. “How about you?”

“We had a lot of fun last night.”

His eyes flitted to the kitchen, but everyone was out of earshot. He said, “I guess we did.”

“You guess?”

“I had fun,” he said, and smiled sheepishly, playing with his napkin.

Carla said, “How are you and Chey? Everything good?”

He regarded his friends again, goofing around in the kitchen, laughing about something, Arlo putting dishes in the sink. He said, “Chey’s good. We’re both good.”

“Unscathed?”

“I think we’re both happy,” he said.

“Cody had a blast, he says. Cheyenne was a *great* partner.”

It made him fidget uncomfortably. It wasn’t exactly anger or disgust, it was a weird *sexual* feeling that he couldn’t get a bead on. What the heck did he like about this? “What did he say?”

Carla said, “Let’s just say Chey knocked his socks off.”

“Or boots,” he mumbled.

“Boots?”

He batted his index fingers together. “You know—knocking boots.”

“Cody told me she can knock.”

“I heard.”

“You two are a couple of undercover pros, is that it? You’ve been keeping your secrets.”

“Well, now they’re out,” he said.

“I’m glad,” Carla said, and poked his wrist bone with a finger. He met her eyes, and she smiled warmly at him. “I’d like to give you another try, mister. Find out what you can really do.”

He smirked, bounced his eyebrows, and looked around the room. This talk was stiffening his member. But he leaned closer to her and said, “I bet Cody’s giving Chey the same sales pitch right now.”

Carla was undeterred. “I think he probably is,” she said.

“So what are Cheyenne and I? Just a couple of field mouse morsels for you two feathered raptors?”

“Ornithological references, Byron? Good, I like smart guys. And I’m a bit of a horny-thologist myself.”

He laughed loud and snorted, then covered his mouth. The kitchen door opened and Cody strode in, paying Carla and him no mind, turning to the kitchen island saying, “Don’t throw out that bacon. Think I’m going to make myself a sandwich.”

Byron said to Carla, “Cody’s got an appetite.”

Carla put her hand on his thigh again, and this time he didn't push it away. She whispered, "Don't we all?"

* * *

For twenty minutes Chey stood alone at the hand-railing, admiring the view, sipping coffee and chewing the inside of her cheek until it hurt. Go again? What more was there to do? Was there something else Cody wanted to try? It seemed obvious after their finale last night—yet it was her who'd taken it too far.

She palmed her forehead, squeezed the bridge of her nose, then ran nails over her scalp. Shit, just doing it all over again the same way would be kind of fun. Minus the finale. Or maybe with the finale.

What if she wasn't nervous this time?

They definitely *shouldn't* do it. She also had the distinct feeling Byron wouldn't say no. But did she want Carla to get another shot at her husband? No.

That was clearly unfair, though.

Still, the thoughts of those dirty things Cody had done to her last night, and how freaking good it felt, twisted at her insides, the desire to do it all over again squeezing through her muscles and firing off her synapses, twisting her thoughts to obey their demands.

You already did it. What does it matter if you do it again?

Well, because one time, it was curiosity. Two times, you were officially a swinger.

But was that truly terrible? What made it terrible if Byron and she were willing? The puritans denigrated Voltaire, claiming he'd engaged in buggery, and when his male friend asked if they should try it again, Voltaire had said if he did it one time, he was a philosopher, if he did it twice, he was a—

A hand on her shoulder made her jump, and she bobbled the empty coffee cup, almost snagging it, but her clumsy left hand batting it away before she hooked a finger through its ring handle. “Shit!” she hissed, leaning over the railing and watching it plunge into the water below.

“You sure are jumpy,” Scarlet said.

“They’re going to take that out of the security deposit. Why did you sneak up on me?”

“I said your name.”

“I didn’t hear you,” she said, touching fingers over her breastbone, feeling the racing gallop of her heartbeat.

“I guess you were lost in thought,” Scarlet said.

There was no amusement or camaraderie in her eyes. It was that same look she’d shown at the breakfast table. A studious sort of bewilderment or disbelief. Maybe even forlorn. “What’s wrong?”

Scarlet leaned on the railing next to her, where Cody had leaned twenty minutes ago. “I didn’t get much sleep last night.”

Chey chewed her cheek again, but had to leave it alone. It was almost raw now. This was going to be the confrontation. She could feel it.

You’ll have to apologize for noisy sex, for keeping Scarlet and Sullivan awake.

Then she'd have to lie to her good old buddy from college.

Without looking at Scarlet, she said, "Sorry Byron and I were noisy."

Scarlet also didn't look her way, the two of them staring out at the horizon where lake met big blue sky. She said, "That was just for a little while. Still couldn't get to sleep, even afterward."

"Oh?" she said, sensing her worries disappearing in her rearview mirror. There was something else going on. "What's going on? Something bothering you—you're okay?"

"I don't know," Scarlet said, shaking her head. "I'm like, blown away."

"Blown away by what?"

Scarlet's eyes flitted straight up, and she ran the point of her tongue across her upper lip. She said, "So, you guys going skinny-dipping again today?"

"Did that bother you?"

Scarlet shook her head.

"I hope it didn't bother you."

Scarlet said, "Did it bother Byron?"

Cheyenne cocked her head and frowned in contemplation. Some honesty here would make a good defense. She said, "Yeah. He was okay. You know he was up here with Carla?"

"Without clothes?"

"That's what he says. I didn't see them."

"So he was with Carla and you were down there with Cody."

"And Philippe."

“And Philippe,” Scarlet agreed.

“Do you not want us to do that today? You can say so.”

“I don’t mind. I’m just surprised. That’s all.”

“I was surprised, too. It was weird at first, but then it was no big deal.”

“No big deal,” Scarlet repeated, disbelieving. “I think it was a pretty big deal.”

“A big deal how?” Sully had streaked during Truth or Dare. They’d been encouraged to do a Toilet Tube Test.

“I don’t know. I guess . . . It’s weird. No one asked me to go skinny dipping.”

“You could’ve if you wanted to,” she said earnestly. “It’d be great if you had. Not like I want to see you like that or anything, I just mean—”

“Did Cody ask you to?”

She tried to recall. “Yeah. I guess he was first. Right? You were up here, you saw him and Philippe—”

“Yeah, those guys went first. But did he ask you to?”

“I don’t know. I guess they both did.” This was getting a little squirrelly.

“They were having fun. I didn’t want to feel like—”

“An outsider,” Scarlet finished.

“Right. An outsider.”

Scarlet nodded, like something had been confirmed in her mind. “That’s good,” she said.

“So, that’s what was keeping you up?”

“No. I mean yeah. I guess turning it over in my mind was what kept me up. But really, it was what Sullivan told me.”

She chewed at her inner cheek again, then winced and tongued it away. She said, “What did Sullivan tell you?”

“What he saw.”

Chey looked out at the water again, a creepy-crawly feeling of dread working a green and prickly wave across her back and up her neck. “What did he see?”

“When he was out in the bathroom last night.”

“Yeah?” Her stomach turned over.

“He was hiding in the bathroom so he could scare Byron.”

“And?”

“It wasn’t Byron coming out of your room.”

Now Scarlet faced her, but Cheyenne couldn’t look over. Scarlet stared at the side of her face for a long time.

“Chey? You know who was coming out of your room?”

She shook her head no, staring holes into the horizon and chewing her sore cheek.

CHAPTER 22

Cheyenne's cheeks had blossomed two rosy clown spots. Her eyes shone like wet glass. It wasn't what Scarlet had intended.

Cheyenne had abandoned her at the railing and retreated to the rear of the deck, found herself now at a dead-end, standing on the far side of a teak table and two loungers, at a different railing on the opposite side of the yacht. It looked like Chey was contemplating jumping off. Scarlet said, "Hey, hey, what's going on with you? Why are you so crazy?"

Cheyenne's arms were folded, and she leaned against the hand-railing like she wanted as much distance between her and Scarlet—and therefore admitting the truth—as she could. Scarlet stopped and put up both hands. "Tell me what's going on, Chey."

"I don't even know what you're saying," Cheyenne said, her voice trembling.

"Don't freak out on me. What the hell, Chey?"

"You tell me what the hey, Scarlet," Cheyenne said, replacing fear with anger.

“Why are you mad at me? Please, chill out, okay?” She pulsed her open hands in surrender toward Cheyenne, like she was pumping the brakes on a runaway truck. “I’m coming over. Don’t freak out.”

“I’m not freaking out,” Cheyenne said.

“Take some deep breaths.”

“I’m not having a panic attack,” Cheyenne spat, though it definitely looked like she was.

She didn’t embrace Cheyenne, didn’t hug her or touch her, instead got close, imitating the pose they’d held a moment ago on the other side of the yacht. Side-by-side, nonthreatening. Like how you might approach a strange and unsure dog. They were both quiet, and Scarlet could see Cheyenne’s hands trembling.

Scarlet said, “It’s no big deal.”

Cheyenne said, “I know it’s no big deal. I don’t even know what you’re talking about.”

“You can deny it or you can admit it, Chey. But if you want to talk about it, I want to hear. Trust me, I want to hear all about it.”

“Sullivan is seeing things,” Chey said.

Scarlet chanced a glance at Cheyenne. Her longtime college buddy and sorority sister. A shy kind of girl in groups, but very confident in her abilities otherwise. Strict parents. Prone to anxiety. Heart of gold.

She said, “I’m going to guess that Byron knows. What, you trust Byron more than me?” She chanced a small, one-sided smile. Cheyenne chewed her cheek and stared out at the water.

“I watched you guys all day yesterday,” Scarlet said. “You three out there skinny-dipping.”

“I didn’t want to be an outsider.”

“Yeah, I don’t think Cody wanted you to be an outsider. That was the point.”

Cheyenne finally glanced her way and their eyes met. Cheyenne said, “What did you see?”

“I’m not judging, first of all. I’m really not, Chey. I watched all day because I thought it was a lot of fun. You know, I don’t think that any of this was a bad thing, I just mean . . .” She shrugged, didn’t know what to say. Then went for the truth. “I told Sully that Cody and Carla were the kind of couple that would do that.”

Chey said, “Swing?”

“Or swap or whatever. I said it like a year ago. Sully calls me an idiot. But then I see this whole thing playing out in front of me yesterday and I was pretty sure I was right.”

“So, what do you think?”

“I don’t think anything about it. I’m just glad I got to rub my victory in Sullivan’s face.”

“What did Sullivan tell you he saw?”

“You know what he saw. He saw Cody coming out of your room. Cody goes into his room and a minute later, Byron comes out. Byron goes back to be with you.”

Cheyenne slumped forward and covered her face with both hands. It sank Scarlet’s stomach. This was not the intended result. She took both of

Cheyenne's wrists and guided her hands to fan outward so she could look at her. Cheyenne's lips practically blubbered. Her eyes were pink, her brow furrowed.

Scarlet said, "How about this: I'm kind of . . . Not jealous . . ." She rolled her eyes around, searching for the right word. Cheyenne studied her and waited. Scarlet said, "Insulted? Maybe that's it. Insulted."

"What do you mean?" Cheyenne's voice was thick, her throat closed off.

Scarlet showed her a smile. "I mean, like, what's wrong with *me*? I'm right here. No one's trying to lure me, get me to take my swimsuit off? Nobody was wagging their dick in my face, trying to tempt me?"

Chey still studied her, looking to see if this was taunting or honesty. Scarlet said, "Don't you think that's funny?"

Cheyenne shrugged. "I guess it's kind of funny."

"I'm not even joking, Chey. Like, I'm the savvy one who picks up on the fact they're swingers—what am I, chopped liver? You and I look the same, practically. We could be sisters. What's wrong with me?"

Cheyenne's brow crinkled. "Did you want them to—"

"No," she said emphatically, "no way," and then realized that sounded like a negative judgment. "No, wait, I don't mean it like that, Chey. You're having fun, those two guys paying all that attention to you. Cody wanted you. You know that, right? You see that?"

"I guess."

"So, I don't know, nobody ever came on to me?"

"Are you still being funny?"

“Yes,” she said and laughed, and finally took her friend into an embrace. Scarlet closed her arms around her and held her. Cheyenne began to relax. Scarlet said, “I’m kind of kidding, kind of not. It’s not that I wanted to swing or anything, I just wouldn’t have minded a wink or something. Maybe ask me to come down and jump on the trampoline with their dick swinging around, you know?”

Cheyenne laughed, then groaned. “Do you think I’m dirty?”

“Oh my God,” she said, and pushed Cheyenne back so they could look at each other. “No way. No way, not at all. Is that what you think? I’m shocked, but amused. I’ll tell you what . . .”

“What?”

“You’re going to tell me every single *freaking* detail.”

It took a long hesitating moment in which Scarlet worried Chey would retreat, run away, head into the yacht and close herself in her room. But slowly, Chey’s expression relaxed and she began yesterday’s story of how it all came to be.

* * *

Cody swam to the edge of the trampoline, hoisted himself up, then clambered to get out of the water. His muscles bulged under his tanned skin. Sunlight painted white slippery lines on his wet body. His shoulders bulged, his lats flexed. Chey caught a glimpse of those ridged muscles at his sides. And then he was up, perfect ass pale in the bright daylight next to his tanned and gorgeous back. He laughed at his clumsiness, and wicked the hair back from his face, turning now and lightly bouncing on his toes. His penis slapped his leg, bounced and swung.

Chey pointed her toes and slipped below the lake surface again. She groaned and blurted bubbles under the water, then began a breaststroke that brought her to the edge of the trampoline. Cody was up there above her, yelling to Philippe. She broke the surface, smoothed wet hair from her face. Cody was laughing, bouncing with his arms over his head, showing off the hard edges of his muscular stomach. Philippe bobbed off to her left, a bright orange Nerf football cocked back. He hurled it in a spiral, and Cody caught it, tucked it to his side and fell onto his shoulder. His penis made a wicked wet slap against his leg, then he was launched up again, standing upright and bobbing. He hoisted the ball back, his body like a perfect lean athlete. He rifled the ball to Philippe, who fumbled it. The Nerf ball spiraled up in the air a few dozen feet behind Philippe in an orange blur. Cody laughed, and Philippe growled, then burst into a breaststroke to retrieve the ball.

“How about you, Chey?”

Her elbows were across the trampoline’s edge, her feet flutter-kicking to keep her afloat. She looked up, saw Cody smiling, no longer bouncing. Hands on knees and hunched over, earnest to hear what she wanted. She avoided that good-looking thing hanging between his legs, squinted up at him, meeting his eyes. “How about me what?”

“You want to play catch?”

“I’m not much of a ball thrower.”

“More of a ball catcher?”

She looked at him for a double entendre, but he thumbed over a shoulder, standing upright now, sunlight highlighting his hard and broad chest and his lean midsection. “Come on up here, Chey. See if we can get them past you.”

“Wouldn’t we need a basketball net or something?”

“Nope, we make these games up as we go along. You play with the guys, you got to do it the way guys do it.”

“I don’t want anyone to fart on me or put me in a headlock.”

“That’s what you think guys do?”

“I have brothers,” she said.

Cody put up his hands, then crossed his heart. “I swear to God, Chey. I’m not going to put you in a headlock. I will not blow wind in your face. Noogies, however, are not out of the question. But only if you deserve it.”

She said, “You’re going to make me take my clothes off, aren’t you?”

“I would never,” he said and smiled. “You’re welcome to if you want.”

“I don’t think I want,” she said.

“That’s up to you. You don’t want to be free?” He waggled his hips and made his dick dance.

“God,” she groaned, and blocked her view.

Cody quickly corrected himself and laughed, grabbed his junk and held it against his thigh. “Just joking Chey. Am I freaking you out? We’re just having fun down here.”

“I don’t mind,” she said.

“That’s good, Chey. You do whatever makes you comfortable. I swear, though, if you go down to the skin, you’ll never catch me looking at you.”

“That’s because you’ll be looking at me when I’ve got my back turned.”

“I said you’re not going to catch me, didn’t say I wasn’t going to look.” He laughed again, saying, “Chey, I’m joking. You’re cool, right? Lily and Arlo

are upstairs. It's just the cool kids down here." He extended a hand to her. "Come on, you come up here, I'll get in the water, you can bounce on the trampoline. We'll throw the ball to you,"

Then she was up, Cody taking her hand and hoisting her to join him, standing beside this hot naked guy. Philippe swam to the edge, tossed the football over to their feet, squeezed his nose, and brushed his hair back. "What are we doing now?"

"Chey's going to catch. How you want to do it? How do we get points?"

Philippe thought about it, angling his face up and watching her. "Okay, we got to lob them so she can catch them. Every one she catches is a point. It's you against me." Then to her: "Chey, I need you to only catch *my* balls."

Cody stepped in front of her abruptly and shouted, "Hey! No way, Philippe. We're *not* going to do that. We're not gonna say dirty things around Chey. She's a nice girl, you hear me?"

Philippe stared at him for a second with a blank face. Then he laughed and said, "Fuck off," and kicked himself away from the trampoline, back paddling and laughing.

"You see, Chey?" Cody said. "I watch out for you. I got your honor in mind."

"So chivalrous," she said, and Cody laughed, passed the ball to her, then jumped off the trampoline, doing a flip before crashing into the water.

Philippe called out to her, "You throw the ball, Chey. We got to race to get it."

She laughed, said, "You got it," and clutched the squishy Nerf ball. She bounced on her toes, Philippe and Cody bobbing out in the water with their

arms overhead, waiting to see where she would throw it. Their eyes were on her. And she liked it. Shit, she *loved* it.

She bounced higher, feeling good. She'd been on a tighter diet for the last four months. Almost no carbs. Made it to the gym three days a week. Jogged three miles almost every morning. She jumped higher, let her breasts bounce in her bikini top, wanting them to see.

CHAPTER 23

Ten minutes later, she found the nerve to take off her bikini—but she wanted to be asked to do it. She would throw the ball as best she could between Philippe and Cody and then watch them haul ass through the water to get to it first. Then they'd sometimes wrestle for the ball, but not too earnestly because they were both naked. The one with the ball would get close to the floating trampoline and she would go to the edge and hold out her hands. The other one would try to block while the thrower would lob the squishy orange football high in a gentle arc, so it would be easy for her to catch. She knew they would watch her bounce around in her bikini when her eyes turned up to track the ball. Worse: she found it arousing knowing they did.

Now she *didn't* throw the ball, instead tucking it under an arm and approaching the edge, her feet curling over the trampoline's inflated lip. Cody and Philippe swam close, and she said, "Let's switch. One of you has to catch now."

Cody nodded his head for Philippe to mount the trampoline, and then said to Cheyenne, "Hope you don't think I'm going to go easy on you."

Philippe climbed up and stood next to her, water sloughing off his bulk, a steady stream twirling to the trampoline mat from the oversized bulb-end of

his monster penis. She handed him the ball and said to Cody, “And I hope you know I play dirty.” She dove headfirst into the water, then shot straight up, bursting up at the side of the trampoline. Cody bobbed nearby behind her, and Philippe loomed naked above her. Neither of them asked her to go naked, so she folded her arms behind her back while her legs kicked to keep her afloat. She untied the bikini top’s knot, then took the top off. Cody wolf-whistled and Philippe clapped with the ball squeezed against his ribs underneath an elbow.

“Atta girl! Somebody’s getting into the spirit,” Cody cheered.

She said, “If you get rough with me trying to get the ball, I don’t want to lose my top to the sea bottom if it comes off.” With a quick flutter kick, she bobbed higher and tossed the soaking bra onto the trampoline. Philippe saw her breasts.

Cody said, “At least you’re halfway there now. And who says I’d be rough with you?”

She said, “Who said I was only halfway there?”

Now, with her eyes locked on Cody, she began the less-than-graceful act of treading water while scooting off her bikini bottoms. The fresh cold water chilled her hottest place—and she knew the heat flared from an odd sexual arousal from the exhibitionism in front of these two male friends. Both of them were handsome, both of them with hot and masculine bodies, both of them supremely hung. They were unafraid to disrobe and let the world see what they’d been blessed with. And it thrilled her to witness what they had.

Cody had about the most picture-perfect penis she’d ever seen. The guy could pose in Playgirl. The body, the hair, the face, the equipment. Penises were rarely attractive—like, look at that gnarly, uncircumcised flesh-yam between Philippe’s legs—but Cody’s had a before-unseen balance and

proportion. Not too long, not too thick, a sheath of unblemished cock skin, and a large and handsomely flared glans.

Now she produced from under the water her bikini bottoms, twirling them on an index finger and showing Cody an unwavering self-assuredness. *You didn't think I had the nerve, huh?* She tossed the bottoms onto the inflatable beside her tangled top, then swam past Cody like she didn't even notice him. Behind her, Philippe laughed and Cody joined in.

About twenty feet out from the inflatable, she stopped and paddled to face it. Cody swam her way and Philippe walked along the edge of the trampoline, tossing the ball up in the air and catching it while he waited for them to get ready. The sun gleamed on his wet body, his bulky muscle and flat stomach. His penis was a red-brown brick of flesh below the black scrabble of his pubic hair. She'd burst out laughing when he'd showed it to her in the small confine of the bathroom, her standing there like a rube, holding a toilet paper tube dwarfed by his flaccid penis. She'd held it near, and covered her mouth, laughing, her cheeks blazing. He'd said, "What do you think? Will it fit?" She'd said, "It looks like your dick could eat the tube for dinner." Then Philippe had laughed, took the tube from her and snuggled it inside his foreskin. He rolled his penis's generous flesh sleeve halfway down the tube, then he let it go, his penis dangling between his legs, the toilet tube gripped in place by his foreskin till it finally fell free to the floor. That was it, though. They both cackled drunkenly, then Philippe pulled up his shorts, and they talked awhile.

Eyes up on the yacht's top level, Chey scanned for any sign of Byron waking and searching for her. This was just a bit of fun, but Byron could get jealous sometimes. So far, no sign of him. She hoped he was having a good nap because she didn't want this to end just yet.

Cody joined her, swimming to her side, saying, “You ready for some rough play?”

“You said you’d be gentle,” she said.

“I never said anything like it. It was you saying I was going to be rough.”

“Oh, so I was right? Fine by me.” She made clawed hands and showed him her nails. Cody regarded her in comical underwhelm.

Her eyes watched Philippe who prepared to throw the ball, arm craned back, muscular body stretched and glistening in the sun, penis swinging. Then he launched the ball. It arced high, and in her periphery she saw Cody begin to swim backward.

Cheyenne spun and side-stroked hard, going out ten yards before flipping to her back. The ball splatted the water very near her face and she howled at the close call. Cody scrambled her way, and she launched after the pink ball bobbing on the waves a quick arm’s length away. Before he came near, she had the ball, grabbing it and hugging it to her naked chest. Cody’s hand gripped her ankle, and she yelped and swallowed water. Her head went under and Cody’s other hand grabbed the same leg just above the knee. The feel of his strong grip above her knee (basically under her skirt if she were dressed) got her hauling in another snootful of water. Her knees clamped closed with the sudden automatic protection of her sex. A swirling and sickly knot slithered below her stomach. Cody pulled his body over hers, hugging arms around her. She clamped both her thighs around his thigh now, making them both sink. His penis squashed on her leg, Cody tickled fingertips on her ribs and she squawked out a torrent of bubbles. The ball shot out of her clutch, between her breasts and making a beeline to the surface. Cody pushed her under the water and swam over her, his genitals dragging over her face.

When she surfaced and cleared her eyes, Philippe jumped on the trampoline to catch the ball. Cody swirled to face her. “One-nothing,” he said.

She said, “Don’t *ever* push your dick into my face again.”

Cody’s bright smile faded, and he looked frightened that she was serious.

She hand-shoveled a fan of water into his face, laughing, then saying, “You do it again and I’ll bite it off.”

Cody laughed too, bobbing away. His eyes were still on hers and he showed a certain measure of concern. “You’re cool, right?”

“Cool as a cucumber, hombre,” she answered.

Cody smiled, and she liked the relief in his eyes. “I’m not going to go easy on you just because you’re a girl and you’re naked.”

“Deal. I won’t go too hard on you just ‘cause you’re a dumb boy and you’re naked.”

“We’re going to take it up a notch?”

She smiled. “Watch your back, handsome.”

Philippe shouted to them: “I need some space between you two or one of you is getting a wet Nerf off the forehead.”

They’d drifted closer without her realizing. She splashed water at him again and launched rearward, letting Cody see her exposed full-frontal nudity come close to the surface. Ten yards apart, she faced Philippe again, raising her hands and waving them, encouraging him to throw it closer to her. This time Philippe threw the ball short and both she and Cody had to haul ass to greet it. The ball smacked the surface and this time it was Cody getting to it first. She swam right on top of him as he clutched the ball. She swung a forearm around his neck and hooked her legs around his front, her heels

sliding in between his legs. It sunk them. Cody writhed in her grip and she almost burst out laughing. The ball let go and batted her in the face on its way to the surface. She released Cody and scrambled after it. Before she could put her hands on it, Cody had his hands on her, grabbing her leg, then hugging her waist. His chin pushed between her butt cheeks and she bawled laughter out to the blue sky, trying not to take in water. Then he pushed her away and grabbed the ball. But as he tried to throw it to Philippe, she wrapped both arms around his, pulling him and the ball backward. The ball fell from his hand and she grabbed it. Cody scrambled onto her back and she spun. Now they were face to face and one thing was certain: Cody had an erection. It poked between her thighs, the tip coming close to where it shouldn't be, and she squirmed. Now his hardness pressed into her belly. She rolled away. Now his cock was in her ass, its cold, turgid belly pressing between her cheeks the way his chin had done. This time, she didn't laugh. The humor had been crushed by some brand new feeling she recognized and didn't like. Cody turned her on. Cody aroused her. She wanted to fuck Cody.

Never in her life had she ever cheated or even come close to cheating on a boyfriend.

“Whoah, woah, woah,” she said. “Time out, time out.”

Cody let her go, and she faced him, both of them bobbing in the waves and looking at each other, chins under the surface. Cody looked like he knew he was in trouble.

Then she swam back a few yards, turned and threw the ball to Philippe, who caught it.

Cody laughed now, seeing her smile return. “I thought you were mad at me. Turns out you're just a cheater.”

“I’m a cheater. Me?”

“You played me.”

“You played yourself, son,” she said, then shouted to Philippe: “Hey ref, I need a call.” Philippe asked her what it was.

“What are the rules on brandishing a weapon?”

Philippe frowned, cupped his hands to his mouth, and hollered, “Who has the weapon?”

Cheyenne chuckled and back paddled away from Cody. “One-one, cowboy.”

Cody smiled at her, and the look in his eyes drove her wild. Now he knew she knew he was hard, and she still wanted to play.

But this wasn’t play anymore, and she wondered how that could be okay.

No, despite that hungry feeling and the fast rate of her pulse, it was still just play. That’s all it was. And she loved it.

CHAPTER 24

“

I can't believe this,” Scarlet said.

“I know, I'm so ashamed,” Cheyenne said, hands going over her face again.

Scarlet pulled them away. “Tell me more. I know there's a lot more.”

“It's so terrible.”

Scarlet chuckled. “You're only human, Chey. Those guys are hot.”

“You know how it ended up,” she said, cocking her head, full of guilt, meeting her friend's eyes.

“I do. Tell me how you got there. I don't think you need to be ashamed. I really don't. Come on, tell me more.”

Chey sighed, still riled and anxious, but so grateful to have her friend's compassionate words. Even though she knew Scarlet wanted only the most salacious and dirty details, it still made her feel better. “You know I love Byron. Don't think I don't.”

“I didn't think it for once.”

She knuckled over her eyebrows hard, pushing away the tension in her forehead. She'd been found out. Discovered. Something secret and perverse was no longer secret. Only perverse. At least it was Scarlet who discovered it. But Sully knew and if Sully knew, it wouldn't be long until everyone on the boat knew, even the crew in the offshore cruiser, standing by if they needed assistance or tried to take off in the eight-figure ship. Probably Sully was radioing them right now, saying, "You guys aren't going to believe this."

"Come on, don't stop," Scarlet said, putting hands on her shoulders. "You're acting way worse than it is."

She shook her head and met Scarlet's eyes. "What do you mean? Have *you* done this before?"

"Oh my God, no," Scarlet said. "Not that it's terrible, I just . . . it never came up. I never wanted to, but, yeah, I want to hear the juicy details. I'm a little worried about why the heck you're acting this way."

Cheyenne took a deep breath. "For a minute, I thought maybe you'd done it before. And then maybe Lily and Arlo had too, and like, Byron and I are the only ones who haven't and you all lured us out to this yacht so you could have your way with us like—"

"Sexual vampires? Cannibals, maybe?" Scarlet snickered and shook Chey's shoulders.

"Yeah, maybe. I feel like I got tricked or something."

"Not tricked. Lured by temptation."

"I love Byron like crazy, you know that."

"I know it, sweetheart. I do. You had a good time last night."

She nodded and Scarlet said, “No offense, but it sure sounded like you did.”

Cheyenne groaned and hid her face again, but at least this time she could laugh about it. “It was crazy, Scarlet.”

“First,” Scarlet said, “tell me how Cody tempted you.”

* * *

The next time Philippe threw the Nerf ball, they both pounded after it and she figured Cody anticipated what would happen as much as she did. Cody beat her to the ball and grabbed it. Right behind him, she wrapped her arms around his waist and let him swim and thrash while she hugged her cheek to the small of his back. Cody rolled to his back, his chest to the surface, and she let him spin in her grip until her cheek was on his stomach. She pushed her face against the firmness of his hard and lean body, enjoying it. His hard cock bumped the back of her arm.

Cody let the ball go, and she went after it. He grabbed her legs as she lamely attempted to get the ball. His hands smoothed her skin, going over her hips and her tummy. She hugged the ball. He hugged her. They came up for a quick blast of air, then rolled again, sinking, Cody’s big hands on her breasts now, his palms going over the swollen buds of her nipples. He held her, the ball squished between them. It felt good in his arms, and yes, absolutely, they were mimicking sex, naked dry humping, rolling around under the surface of the lake while Philippe waited for one of them to retrieve the ball.

The score didn’t matter.

Eventually, she got the ball away from Cody, his hands lingering on her body as she swam away. She threw the ball to Philippe, who caught it. That knot tightened further, a swollen sexual feeling taking space between her

hipbones. That desire to be filled, to have a man inside her, for the man to consume her and ravage her and claim her hard, over and over again, seemed so distant and foreign but the longer it throbbed inside her the more familiar it felt. It was sexual prime. It was mating. Animal sex. A woman taken by a powerful man.

Neither of them said the score. Neither of them taunted the other. All she wanted—and judging by Cody's silence, all he wanted as well—was for Philippe to throw the ball so they could handle each other again.

And when Philippe threw the ball, they both thrashed after it. This time she went straight to Cody's front, clasping the ball between them, face to face. Legs hooked and locked around his thighs, her hands smoothed circles on the bulges and knots of Cody's muscular back. Cody barely wriggled in her grip. His cock pushed into her stomach. Cody was hard as ever, his perfect organ big and ramrod straight, that plump knot at the end swollen round and flared, and she wanted to feel it plunge deep inside her. She grabbed his ass. Two handfuls. Dug her nails in and held. Cody humped his cock against her stomach, the tip pressing the underside of her breast. It was way too much. It was simulated sex.

She shook her head and blurted out air, letting him get away from her so he could throw the ball and end the game. Her stomach hurt so bad all she wanted to do was excuse herself and go up to her room, lock the door so Byron wouldn't accidentally interrupt, and grind an orgasm out with her hand. Or, fuck, her vibrator—but that was all the way back home.

What about Byron, stupid? He could release this tension real fast.

He could, but it wasn't right. Wasn't fair to Byron.

And yet, when Philippe cranked the ball one more time, she went right after it, her eyes on Cody's glistening back muscles as he swam ahead of her, not

watching the ball at all. Only Cody.

And when Cody grabbed the ball, she locked her arms around him again, hugged her cheek to his chest, locked on his body sideways. He pretended to keep the ball from her, pulling it aside, exposing his belly. Her hand swept his muscular midsection, down a thigh, up the inside, and grabbed his balls and held them. The sound of his underwater laugh burst in bubbles above her and the ball shot to the surface as she shocked him enough he let the ball go. Cody didn't go after it. Cody stayed with her, held her in his arms under the water with his balls in her grip.

Her palm smoothed up the belly of his cock. That perfect manhood felt incredible in her clutch. She gripped it mid-shaft, a thick column of beautiful man meat. Her hand stroked upward and squeezed to choke him just below the glans. Cody rolled her over underwater, getting on top of her, his own hand sweeping her tummy. But when his fingertips rustled her pubic hair, she detached with a tidal wave of remorse, heading for the surface, breaking it and gasping for air.

Philippe shouted, "You two trying to drown each other?"

Behind her, Cody muttered, "Something like that."

She spun to face him, treading water. They stared at each other a moment, expressionless, sussing each other out. She said, "I think I need to take a break."

"You okay?"

"I'm okay," she said, and managed a weak smile. The horniness gripped her guts in a demanding iron fist. The lust was squashed now with regret for betraying her marriage and hurting her husband. She'd go up later and roll one out, but this bullshit with Cody had to stop right now.

“I’m pretty worn out,” Cody said. “Let’s just chill for a bit.”

Cody retrieved the ball, and they swam back to the trampoline. He tossed it up, and it bounced around Philippe’s feet. He said to Philippe, “Chill time,” and that sounded great to Philippe who treaded lightly to the far side of the trampoline where a cooler sat in its molded resting spot. Cody rested his arms on the edge of the inflatable and turned his face up to the sun. Cheyenne joined him, assuming a similar pose, her stomach still hurting and her psyche wounded from her infidelity.

Cody said, “What a great day, huh?” His eyes were still closed, handsome profile lit in bright sunlight, his blond hair darker when it was wet, some bright gold still gleaming in the damp tangles.

Her eyes darted to Philippe, wondering if she had an opportunity to say something to Cody about what happened out in the water—to make light of it, to lessen the impact and to establish that nothing happened he needed to tell Carla about. Philippe was down on one knee, lid of the cooler open, that heavy brown sack hanging low enough to see it under his butt. What a weird day. It had started with such normal acceleration. Next thing she knew, Cody’s like, “Hey guys, cool if we go naked?” Now look where she was. Following Cody and Philippe down to the water to hang out with them like this was high school. It was so obvious what she was doing. Though she hadn’t seen it at first, it had to be obvious to anyone else on the boat who wasn’t some horny little sexpot like she was. Sure, Byron was napping on the top deck, but what about the others? Scarlet was a snoop and was also cunning. Sully was no dummy, and he had a big mouth. Lily was a prude and sure wouldn’t think too highly of good old Cheyenne after this. Arlo? Who knew—the guy was hard to read sometimes.

Cody broke the silence first. “I got carried away, Chey. Hope we’re still cool.” He rolled his head around to face her with an expression of hopeful

harmonization.

She smirked to one side, eyes averting for a second, her brain appreciating the solicitous gesture, then looking back at him. A willful admission: “I got carried away, too. No hard feelings?”

Cody paused a second, and in that quiet space, she realized he struggled not to swing at the double entendre—*hard feelings*? And then Cody surprised her, letting her gaffe pass without comment. “Look, Carla and I are cool with that kind of behavior, so I let it happen. It was *fun*. But I forgot you might not be cool. Or Byron might not be cool. I’m sorry about that. I just like you a lot. I’ve always liked you, and I’m comfortable that way.”

“What way?”

“I mean, like I wasn’t coming on to you or trying to get you to do something you didn’t want to do. And I sure as shit am not cheating on Carla or anything. I don’t want you to think that.”

“Okay,” she said, nodding, trying to get a grip on what he was hinting, though it seemed obvious.

“But Carla and I are open.”

And there, it was confirmed. What she thought he was saying was true: Carla and Cody were swingers.

But before she could ask questions, Philippe was returning, bringing three bottles of Miller Hi-Life with the tops popped off. Cody continued: “Don’t tell anyone, though, okay?”

“I won’t,” she said. “I swear I won’t.”

“Hoo-ee,” Cody said, half-pulling himself from the water to reach up and take two beer bottles from Philippe to save the guy from having to reach

down too far and risk ending up in the drink with them. “Beating Chey sure is thirsty work, bartender. Keep my tab open and the suds on a steady carousel.”

She bit her lower lip and side-looked at Cody’s super-cute bottom with the water sloughing off his muscle and the sun shining on the curves of his pale full moon. Then he slid down the inflatable’s curved side again, joining her in the water and extending the bottle to her. They drank together, but her eyes were on Cody, wishing it was just the two of them and Philippe would go have a nap with Byron because she had a million questions for Cody right now.

Instead, she reverted to tomboy camaraderie: “No chance you beat me. We can’t throw a couple rounds and you get the decision. Not my fault you got tired.”

Cody swigged, then laughed and said, “Wasn’t me getting tired that called our game off. It was me getting something else.”

As she smirked and bit her lips, Philippe snapped his fingers—a loud crack with the wet. “Oh shit, I get it—the *weapon*.”

And instead of veering away like a married woman should do, she engaged. As if they were three young dudes at the bar watching football, she said, “Cody tried to stick me up.”

Philippe guffawed loud, throwing his head back. He wiped his mouth, leaned forward, and said, “Good old Cody. Reliable as ever.”

It felt good to hang with them and be free and unrestricted. She laughed and winked, swigged her own beer. “We played some more rounds, I woulda won—but I don’t want to end up pregnant just to prove a point.”

Both Cody and Philippe showed animated shock, lips pursing to O shapes and both of them lowing at the insane implication of her quip. It felt a little weird to say something so provocative, but their welcome reception made it better.

Philippe said, “Wait, you and Byron trying to get pregnant?”

“God, no,” she said, bouncing her eyebrows and taking a drink. “Sometime soon, but we’re still young. We want to have fun for a little while and I can *not* afford maternity leave at work right now. Things are going too well.”

Cody said, “So you’re on the pill?”

“Of course,” she said, and then in the quiet aftermath she realized she’d been somehow enjoined. Was this Cody’s first step in swinging—confirming a woman’s reproductive status? That horny feeling slithered in her guts again, like a fat snake coiling tighter. God, maybe a whole nest of snakes in there right now. How would that go? How would it be to swing? *Byron would never in a million years ever let it happen, but imagine Cody slipping in to bed with you, naked and cool, his hard muscle pressing against you while your arms looped around his muscular sides.*

She drew a deep breath and chuckled, eyes going wide in shock at her own daydream, then drank more beer.

But Philippe groaned suddenly and laughed. He shook his head, eyes pinched closed. “Jesus, Cody,” he sighed.

Cody laughed too. “What, man?”

“Nothing,” Philippe said, still shaking his head like he couldn’t believe what Cody was doing.

“Who cares if I’m on the pill, Philippe? Is that bad?” Then she got it.

She met Cody's eyes and narrowed hers on his. Her brow furrowed, trying to figure him out. Her eyes went to Philippe, then darted back to Cody, a silent question: "*Does Philippe know you swing?*"

Cody smirk-scowled and nodded, a silent response: "*Of course he does.*"

CHAPTER 25

C hey said, “So it was like I was in their club.”

“The cool kids club,” Scarlet said, acknowledging she saw it too.

It was crazy to believe this had all gone down under her nose and that it was Sully who brought the news to *her* instead of the other way around.

“Once I was in their club, like they accepted me into a rarified group, the closer I got to—”

“The concept of swinging.”

“Like, hey, everybody’s doing it.” Cheyenne shrugged and shook her head like she was mad at herself.

“Philippe swings, too?”

Chey threw up her hands. “How the hell would I know, Scarlet?”

“I assumed he told you.”

“We didn’t all *talk* about swinging. We didn’t lounge around naked on the trampoline drinking beers and pondering the virtues of swinging.”

“Philippe didn’t say anything about it?”

Chey looked around at an imaginary audience, like she was garnering support for her belief this was a crazy line of questioning. “I told you: we never discussed swinging.”

“All it took was Cody saying he and Carla did that, and that Philippe *also* knew they did, and, boom, you’re in the game?”

Chey closed her eyes. “That’s not what I’m saying, Scarlet. Sorry. What I’m saying is that Cody didn’t talk me into it, okay? You get it now?” She opened her eyes and met Scarlet’s.

Scarlet said, “You talked yourself into it.”

“I thought about it all day. It was right there: Cody was hot, and he made me so crazy and then backed away, unbothered, because—”

“What you guys did in the water was no big deal to him.”

“I wouldn’t say no big deal. I’d say it was a fine old thing Cody would do, and it had no negative attachment, no marital-existential tripwire. Like, he thought he’d have a great time having sex with me, but it was my values, and maybe Byron’s values, that prevented me from having fun and being, you know”—she made air quotes—“*above* it all.”

Impressionable Cheyenne. Scarlet wouldn’t say it, but now she saw it: no one had presented the offer to *her* because they knew she would see through a game like Cody and Carla ran on Cheyenne a thousand yards off. She’d never fall for it the way her sweetheart friend did. “I get it, Chey. I do. I get it. I— Look, I’m behind you a hundred percent and I swear I won’t say a thing to Arlo or Lily. Or Philippe, for that matter. Does Philippe know?”

“I don’t know,” Chey lamented, running her hand through her hair, staring at the deck.

“If he does, what’s the big deal, right? It’s only Lily and Arlo who don’t know.”

“God,” Chey said, and put her hands over her face. “The whole boat knows.”

Scarlet chuckled, overwhelmed with compassion for Chey, moving closer, saying, “I’m going to give you a hug. Don’t stop me.” And Cheyenne didn’t, fell forward into her chest with hands still over her face. She hugged Chey and shushed her, smoothing her hair like she was a little kid. “It’s okay, baby. It’s all over and it doesn’t matter. You and Byron had a little fun, and it’s over now and no one else is going to know and I think it’s great that you tried it out. No one is going to talk about it, trust me. It’s just you and me talking about it.”

“What about Sully?”

“He’ll keep his mouth shut. Who’s he going to tell, anyway? Trust me, Chey, he won’t tell Arlo and Lily.”

“I don’t want him to talk to anyone about it.”

“I’ll tell him to keep his mouth shut. On one condition.”

Cheyenne pushed back, brows troubled. “What’s that?”

“You tell *me*.”

“I did.”

“No, I mean— You know, what it was *like*.”

Cheyenne’s eyes slipped downward to the deck, her mouth condensing to a glum pout. “Oh.”

“Please?”

She scratched her cheek. “Yeah. No, okay. Yeah, well . . .”

* * *

Alone in the room while Byron crossed the hall, everything wrong about the whole situation bloomed like bacteria in a petri dish. What the hell were they doing? In mere seconds, Cody would come through their room door and she would be intimate with him. This was the last chance to come to her senses and do the right thing. She was almost thirty. She and Byron were building their Westchester dream home. They’d raise their children in it. One boy and two girls.

But then . . . wasn’t that exactly the reason to go through with it? Wasn’t that the point? Do it now before it’s all too late.

It’s not like she and Byron were the only people in the world to do this. People did this. She’d heard about it. And, shit, their friends Cody and Carla did it—the whole reason she stood now trembling by the door. And Cody and Carla were a solid couple. Surely she and Byron would—

The knob turned and a presence on the other side of the door gently pushed it inward. She stepped back, all that worry extinguished by that heavy, sopping ripe fruit sagging between her legs. As Cody entered the room, in a quick finger-snap, all that chest-tightening horniness he’d conjured from her out on the water today returned.

He put his back to the door and walked it closed, resting against it and smiling. “Hey,” he whispered, smiling wide and white, eyes showing excitement.

And it hit her now, a sudden pillow-fight wallop: this was fun and dirty and sneaky. She smiled too, her lips pulling back wide, the tendons sticking out

in her neck as she strained not to burst out giggling. She whispered back, “Hey.”

Now he said in a quiet but still masculine voice, “Byron looked like he’d seen a ghost out there. Your husband’s scared.”

Now she really did want to giggle and had to cover her mouth with a hand.

Cody said, “Looks like my Cheyenne isn’t so scared.” He regarded her warmly for a moment, that smile fading for a second to something more devious and lusty. “I like that look in your eyes. You’re a real tiger and you don’t even know it.”

She bared her fangs and made a cat’s claw at him. He laughed and heaved off the door, taking her wrist and saying, “Come on.” One step down into the room and then he jumped on the bed and bounced once, pivoting so when she landed beside him, they would be face to face.

“I thought midnight was going to take forever,” he said.

“Me too,” she said. “Did Byron really look scared?”

“Like he was about to bungee off a huge cliff.”

“I know how he feels,” she said and smiled to one side. Cody looked incredible in the low light, and his bright blue eyes shone in the dim.

When he touched her shoulder, she held her breath. “I want to know how *you* feel, Chey.”

“Not scared,” she said.

“Excited.”

“Yeah,” she whispered. Then: “But also a little scared, too, I guess.”

“A little fear makes it fun, don’t you think?”

She nodded, feeling good and warm in Cody's steady confidence during this awkward ordeal.

"Of course it does," Cody said. The weight of his hand on her shoulder was strange—he'd touched her before, but now it came imbued with much more dirty promise or expectation. Sudden recursive knowledge of what would soon transpire hardened her nipples. The methods of sex would momentarily be applied to her by another man. He would do *all* the sex things to her. It became impossible to swallow, and her temples throbbed. "Boy, maybe you are scared," he said and smiled, his hand coming low, the tip of his index finger touching the center cushion of her lower lip. He smelled like soap and sandalwood and the feel of his finger on her lip tightened her scalp and raced her heart.

"What's your favorite thing, Chey?" His voice had gone low and sultry, still a touch of that self-assured swagger, but it rode underneath a rumble of masculine desire. "I want to know what makes Cheyenne's toes curl. What gets Cheyenne's long, sexy legs shaking?"

"I don't know," she whispered, pulling her lower lip into her mouth and sucking it, looking into Cody's beautiful blue eyes as he rested his firm hand on her shoulder again.

"Yeah, you do."

She said, "I just like to have sex."

He bowed his eyebrows, giving a sexy and playful look. "Byron doesn't make your legs shake?"

"Sure he does."

Cody got closer, his hand moving from her shoulder to her back, the two of them practically embracing on her bed, lying down on their sides and face

to face. “How does Byron do it?”

“By being Byron. I don’t want to talk about Byron.”

Cody chuckled. “Good girl. Byron who, right? It’s just you and me. Lucky me and this beautiful girl who’s been driving me wild for years.”

“For years?”

“You think this is the first time I’ve ever thought about what it would be like to lay with you this way we are right now?”

“It isn’t?”

“You haven’t thought about it before?”

“Being with you? No. I mean, no, not really.”

He said nothing in return, eyes narrowing, dominating her without having to do much at all. “Tell me what you want right now, Chey.”

She struggled to swallow, her heart felt like it was squished right up against her trachea and the sound of its beat like a whooshing in her ears. “Maybe, um . . . Can you take your shirt off?”

“Sure can.”

Cody was all smiles again, sitting up and right away, pulling his T-shirt off over his head and tossing it to the floor. She chased after him, her palm caressing his hard, warm, tanned back. Cody’s body was lean and masculine, and the humps of muscle on his back felt so sexy under her touch. Cody rose and turned to the bed, standing bedside, the light from the bedside table lamp painting golden shades on his hard stomach and broad chest. She’d wanted to touch him all day today. And now she could.

She scooted closer, coming face to face with his belly button as she sat on the edge of the bed before him. Her lips pressed just below the navel, the slick coating of gloss sticking her lips to his flesh. Now her hands moved on their own, coming up the front of his cotton shorts, over his belt, then exploring his body. She felt the ridged plates of his abdomen, his ribs, higher then to feel how hard his chest was. She looked up to see Cody watching with a smile, his eyes meeting hers.

Her hands came lower, fingers tucking into his waistband and coming together under her chin to disengage his belt. The whole while, their eyes stayed connected. The belt was a simple lever; one tug and she released it. Cody's pants slackened, and she bit her lower lip.

She said, "I'm going to suck your cock."

"Yeah, you are," he said, smile widening.

"I told Byron I wanted to."

"You must really want to suck it, Chey."

She nodded, smiling too, feeling good with him. Now her eyes lowered to watch her hands work. Pants unbuttoned, belt unthreaded, she drew down his zipper. His shorts came down easy. Cody wore no underwear. His big and perfect penis dangled before her. It hung heavy and flaccid but already swelling, the veins rising under the thick unblemished skin. She kissed him mid-shaft, then pressed her cheek against it, squashing his penis and balls into his groin with her face. Its pulse blipped on her cheek and his penis squirmed, blood rushing into it.

She pulled away to tell him: "You have such an amazing cock." Her hands swept up the inside of his thighs and her heart did a series of flutters in the second before she finally took a hold of Cody's manhood. She'd held it

today, of course, out in the water, and Cody was hard. But this was what she wanted. To take her time, to be allowed to do it.

His balls were warm, the skin of his scrotum sticking on her palm. Her other hand gripped his flaccid member near the base, and she guided his cock into her mouth. The plump shape was large and soft and smooth. If Cody wanted to know what curled her toes, it was having his cock in her mouth. She sucked and sucked, pulled more into her mouth, feeling him grow harder, swelling larger.

She let it plop with a wet sound from her mouth and it swung before her. She looked up and told him, "Step back and have a seat, okay? I want to take my time with this."

CHAPTER 26

Maybe it was too much. Scarlet's eyes were wide and shining in the morning sun and a clear spread of rosy blossoms had colored her cheeks. The story was too much for Scarlet to take.

Scarlet stepped away from the railing and moved into the lounge, steadying herself with a hand on the back of the black rattan sofa. "I just need to sit down," Scarlet said.

Chey watched her friend—her confident sorority sister and best long-time confidant—sit down carefully on the sofa with her back to her. Scarlet looked shaky. The blushed cheeks, the wowed expression. It seemed like the retelling of what happened aroused Scarlet. Chey leaned her elbows on the railing and looked out at the choppy blue water. Her cheeks felt hot, and she rested a hand on her forehead. Was the story too much for Scarlet to hear? Was that how bad it was? Better not be, because it was only the beginning.

From behind her: "Chey?"

Cheyenne turned to face the lounge. Scarlet hooked an arm on the back of the couch, waving for Chey to join her. "Come on. You have to tell me more."

“Are you okay?”

Scarlet looked worn out and didn't try to hide it. She ran her hair away from her face for a moment, then nodded. “I'm fine. It's just a lot to hear all at once.”

“Well, what am I supposed to tell you now? Do you want to hear the truth?”

“Hey, come on. Don't be like that.” Scarlet finger-waved again, encouraging Cheyenne. “Sit down and tell me the truth. Okay? Would you do that?”

“You're supposed to make me feel better,” Cheyenne said, crossing her arms but padding over to join her friend.

When she moved to the sofa that sat kitty corner, Scarlet took her wrist and pulled her to the couch where she sat. “Don't be like that. I'm sorry. Your story got me—”

“I get it,” Cheyenne muttered, letting her friend off the hook in admitting how her story of stripping Cody naked and giving him a blow job got her hot.

“Unfold your arms,” Scarlet said, reaching and taking both her wrists and pushing her hands down to her lap. “I needed to sit down because your story got me lightheaded. Okay? Are you happy now?”

“I know. Is it too wild? What I did, I mean, not the retelling.”

“What's done is done, Chey. Nothing's going to change it. You're going to *have* to be okay with it. And hey,” she said, squeezing Cheyenne's knee, “there's nothing for you to fear. Nothing for you to be ashamed about or anything like that at all. Not from me, I swear.”

Cheyenne nodded, chewing her cheek and looking at Scarlet's hand on her knee. A long moment passed and then Scarlet said, "I still don't know how you convinced Byron."

"Carla convinced Byron."

Scarlet patted Cheyenne's knee and then she scooted closer so they were almost touching. She said, "That's what I figured. Did Byron ask you first?"

"He suggested it. He suggested it, and somehow I knew exactly where he was going with it." She shook her head. "Instead of being mad that he wanted to sleep with Carla, Cody had me so worked up all I could think about was myself."

"Did you talk to Byron about what he did?"

"With Carla? Yeah," she said. "We talked a bit last night and more this morning. It makes me sick to think of it. But then: What about me? I *know* what I did."

"And you told Byron?"

She nodded, saying nothing.

"You and Byron are still good?"

"Yes," she said. "Actually, *great*. Maybe jealousy works for me. I want to clip a leash to Byron's collar and not let him get over four feet away from me."

"Now *that's* love," Scarlet said and laughed.

Chey scowled at Scarlet as long as she could and then smiled. "I hate that it couldn't be just about *me*. I'm a selfish bitch."

“I wouldn’t let Sully anywhere *near* Carla’s bedroom.” And then, as if Scarlet realized what that insinuated, she corrected herself. “Not that it’s bad that you did. I just mean . . .”

Cheyenne said, “I think Byron kinda flopped.”

Scarlet loved it, eyes widening and jutting her chin forward. “Serious?”

“I think so.”

“That would be amazing if he couldn’t get it up.”

Cheyenne scowled again. “Don’t say that.”

“I just mean it would work out for you, my selfish little bitch.” She patted Chey’s cheek.

“No, Byron got it up, unfortunately.” Then she made a sickly face. “I just think Carla intimidated him.”

“Then what’s to worry?”

She shrugged.

“Now, would you please tell me the rest.”

“Do you really want to hear?”

“I do,” Scarlet said and fanned herself theatrically. “I’m sitting down now.”

Chey looked around—over her shoulder, and back toward the doorway where anyone joining them would come out. She got close and said, “I was going down on him. But I mean, like, really going for it, you know? Like I never have before. I don’t even know why. It was like my insides were on fire. And his dick, Scarlett, when he’s hard, it’s like”—she held her two hands apart the approximate distance of Cody’s measurement—“I was using two hands and everything.”

Scarlet made an uncomfortable expression, not showing that she didn't like the story—or the intimate details of their friend's husband's most private anatomy—it was that hearing the details sparked something inside her. It could be the same spark that Cheyenne had out in the water. The ignition of her crazy, combustible night.

* * *

Cody's hips began to buck as she sucked him. Two hands swirled, her head bobbed, her tongue lathed; sometimes she would tug on his balls. The bucks became jolts, and Cody's cock twitched in her mouth. Her tongue and pallet flooded with another slick stream of his pre-come. She bobbed faster, swirled her hands quicker—but Cody leaned forward, urgency in his voice, saying, “Whoa, whoa, whoa, Chey, stop, stop, stop.”

Cody guided her face upward with his hands on her jawline, dipping his hips back to pull his penis out of her mouth. He bit on his lower lip and said, “You're going to make me come.”

She bit on her lower lip as well, and said, “I want you to come. I really want you to.”

“Not so fast. I did not know you could suck a cock like that.”

She smiled and rolled her eyes. “Really?”

“Holy shit, Chey. You almost made me come in only three minutes.”

“Isn't that what we're supposed to do?”

“I want to save the first one up. Make it last. You know what I'm saying?”
He stroked her cheekbones with his thumbs. “I mean, I haven't even seen you naked yet.”

“You saw me naked all day,” she said, smirking.

“Not like this, though. Not with no one watching. Just you and me in a nice warm room, table lamp low. I want to put my *hands* on you. I want to put my hands all *over* you,” he said, rising, hands lowering to her shoulders and under her arms to lift her up and helping her to sit on the bed.

Cody leaned close, his face coming near hers, and her heart jumped, knowing what he intended. She dipped her face back. “No kissing.”

He closed his eyes, but nodded. “I guess we didn’t go over any rules. I came in here more eager than I thought.”

“We should have rules, I guess. Condoms. You brought condoms?”

“I brought condoms, Chey.”

She said, “I feel weird kissing.”

“That’s all right. Whatever you want to do or don’t want to do, Chey. No pressure. We’re just going to have fun—whatever way you want it.”

She thought about it, running her canine tooth over her lower lip, reaching out and absently milking his inflated member. “I think that’s all my rules,” she said. “Maybe we can even kiss a little.”

“If you don’t want to, Chey, it’s cool.”

“Kissing is okay, just not on the lips. Mm, I guess that’s obvious,” she said, and squeezed his erection. She just had her mouth and tongue all up and down and over the thing in her hand.

Cody said, “How do you feel about taking your clothes off?”

“I could do that,” she said, let his penis go to dangle and swing again, the thing not sticking upright, but aiming down and outward. With her eyes on

Cody's, she lifted her short t-shirt. No bra underneath, she revealed her bare breasts to him. He'd seen them and touched them already, but he was right: things were different now, the two of them alone in this space.

When his hands rested on her shoulders, she closed her eyes and concentrated on the touch of his skin against hers. His hands slid down, and she arched her back to present herself to him. Cody palmed her breasts; his thumbs caressed her nipples until they ached. He lay her on her back, looming over top of her, naked and erect and looking so gorgeous. The light played on his muscle in bright sweeps. He smoothed over her tummy, getting her writhing like a horny insect on the bed, shimmying her hips and loving the feel of the tight cotton shorts she wore squeezing between her legs and putting delicious pressure against her pussy.

Cody's fingers worked open the button of her shorts, then drew down the zipper. Patience had run out and the butterflies in her stomach thrashed. She thumbed down the shorts, wiggled her butt out of them, wanting to be completely naked with Cody and having fun. Cody read it from her and helped her shorts down to her knees. With the shorts squeezed at her knees, he guided her to turn over on her stomach. She laughed and complied, bending her knees so he could swipe her shorts right off and fling them away. His hand slapped on her bottom and she yelped. The sting of his hand tightened her core and alerted her to the wetness Cody had provoked. She sucked her lips into her mouth and tossed a look over her shoulder at him. "What are you going to do to me?"

He smiled and spanked her again, her legs jolting, her taut flesh shaking. She stuck a knee out so she could flip over and face him, but Cody jammed a hand behind her knee and pinned her in place with her legs parted.

The warmth of his mouth pressed into one of her cheeks, his teeth clenching her flesh, biting but producing no pain, only suckling as if her ass was a

peach. Then he kissed his way to the center and as he got closer, her hands clenched bedsheets in absent, shaking claws.

“Oh my gosh,” she sighed as Cody’s tongue slipped between her cheeks, the tip teasing wet lines up and down the base of her sheath, nudging the taut stretch of space between her pussy and her back hole. The pleasure rolled her eyes up to the ceiling and a groan slipped from her throat. Cody conjured such base and forbidden pleasure. If Byron ever tried this with her, she’d tell him to knock it off and ask him if something was wrong with him. But hot-as-fuck Cody was built to do awful things to her. To fuck her and dominate her and pound that beautiful cock into her over and over.

His tongue caressed her sex-flesh, the tip pushed into her canal and teased her clit. He mouthed her vulva and ran a wet swipe all the way to her anus. It got her legs kicking and her toes curling.

“Oh,” she gasped. “I know what I want, Cody.”

Cody got his knees on the bed between her open thighs and his large hands grasped one cheek each. He kneaded her bottom and spread her open, the cooler air of the room chilling all the wet places between her thighs he’d pleased with his tongue. “Tell me,” he said in a low and sexy voice.

She tossed another look over her shoulder. “I want you to do anything you want to me. Treat me like a sex toy. Treat me like I’m nothing but a dirty fuck.”

CHAPTER 27

Before Sully even got Byron out of earshot of the others, out on the front deck on the third level, Byron had a horrible feeling he knew what it was about. Sully had something to say, and it clearly excited him. Since he couldn't say it in public, it had to be salacious. And, of course, Byron's guilty conscience could think of only one salacious thing that had happened.

While they walked out to the railing and into the sunshine, Byron got into character and acted as an innocent guy lured into a quiet place to hear some juicy gossip. He pushed an eager smile onto his face and assumed a wolfish gaze. "What is it, what's going on?" Even his tone was rushed and fervent.

Sully peered over the railing and down the side of the yacht to the water below—did he think someone clung there, eavesdropping?—then back to the yacht's windows. Satisfied they were alone, Sully bounced his eyebrows and nudged his chin outward. "So what was it like?"

A mask of confusion and misunderstanding came easy to him, but now his heart was racing. How the fuck did Sully know what happened? Fucking Carla, probably. Or maybe Cody bragging about how he'd nailed Cheyenne last night. Guy couldn't help himself.

“Don’t give me that look, Byron. Come on, you and me”—he touched Byron’s chest and then pointed at himself—“we get along, right? We both married Gamma girls, we’re friends, we hang out . . . I vouch for you all the time.”

“Why *wouldn’t* you?”

“I’m just saying, when people ask, I tell them, hey, that Byron’s a great fucking dude.”

“I don’t understand what this is all about.”

“Okay, okay,” Sully said, running a hand through his thick mop of hair. Reassessing, strategizing, establishing altered logistics. He regarded Byron again. “I had a *great* hiding place last night.”

Byron’s heart thudded like a rimshot. Sully hid in Carla and Cody’s room and watched him fuck Carla and then rub her back and her feet and watch *Friends*. With slow caution, he said, “Where were you hiding?”

“You were coming out of your bedroom to pee. You remember that?”

He didn’t know how to respond, but his brow lowered and he said, “Sure.”

“Oh, you do? Because, you see, you and Chey kept me and Scarlet up last night with all your bedroom antics.”

“Oh,” he said, trying to show apology, the whole while his scalp tightening and his sack crawling. “Yeah, I figured by what you said this morning—”

“My plan was to jump out at you when you came into the bathroom. But you didn’t come to the bathroom.”

“No, I didn’t,” he said, swallowing hard.

“And it wasn’t you.”

“Wasn’t me what?”

Sully exploded with exasperation, “Jesus, Byron, I’m giving you a chance to come clean. Why are you making this hard? I saw Cody with”—he pointed two pronged fingers to his eyes—“okay? Twenty-twenty vision. It was Cody coming out of your room, not you. And I saw you come out of Carla’s room, man.”

Byron let out a long blubbering sound through pursed lips and sank against the hand railing. He threw up his hands and rolled his eyes to the sky in surrender to Sully. All right, you caught me.

“Fucking amazing, Byron,” he said with breathy admiration. “You and Carla.”

“Yeah,” he sighed, and repeated, “Me and Carla.”

“Swapping.”

“Yeah, okay, swapping.”

Now Sully showed a look of inspired disbelief and what Byron thought could be admiration. “Wow. Just wow. So, again: what was it like? Or don’t you dare fucking tell me you guys have done this before.”

“With Carla and Cody?”

“Oh, my God. You’ve done it with some other couple, too?”

“What?—No. Definitely no. Last night was the only time.”

Sully tossed a light punch on Byron’s upper arm. “That makes more sense. I can’t believe you guys did that. Carla and Cody, okay, maybe I could see it. Scarlet already said she thought they did that—”

“Oh no, Scarlet knows, too?”

“What, I’m not going to tell her?”

“Of course you’d tell her,” he muttered and palmed his forehead. Fucking great. Poor Chey was going to hear about it from Scarlet. “Is Scarlet mad at Chey?”

Sully thought about it for a second and shook his head. “No. Why would Scarlet be mad?”

“She’s got that big sister thing going on with Chey.”

“Oh, yeah. I guess. But no, she wasn’t mad at Chey. She didn’t say anything to me, at least. She’s just as blown away as I am, though.”

“I’m pretty blown away, too.”

“I bet. Well, hey, look at it this way: you went into Carla’s bedroom and you’re here to tell the tale. That’s got to count for something, right? I’d figure you wouldn’t even be able to walk out of there when Carla was done with you. Oh my God, and Cody— I bet Chey could barely walk after Cody was done with *her*.”

“What do you mean?”

Sully frowned like the answer was obvious. “Cody is the male version of Carla.”

“Yeah, okay.”

“And the guy’s got a pipe on him.”

Byron’s stomach soured at the truth. “Yeah, he does.”

Sully didn’t dwell on that particular copper tang of jealousy, showing renewed excitement. “Byron, man, this is insane. Insane in the best way possible.”

“What are you, jealous?”

“I don’t have the balls to even entertain the idea of something so crazy. I even hinted at something like that, Scarlet would kick me in the nuts.”

From Sully’s excited eyes and his new blushing disposition, Byron had to ask: “Wait a second—would you want to do it?”

He shook his head. “I’m going to live vicariously through you, Byron. Something like this would never even ping on my radar. Tell me how it happened. How the hell did you convince Carla? Or, wow, how did you convince Chey?”

“Carla seduced me—”

“Oh, come on.”

He showed Sully no humor and leveled serious eyes at him. “I’m telling you, she seduced me. But— And this is a big but: Cody seduced Chey.”

“Shit, dude.”

“I can’t even be mad. I was practically messing around with Carla at the same time Cody was putting the moves on Chey. We bump into each other later and we’re both hiding our guilt and trying to figure out how we would ever even approach asking the other one about this idea of, like, swinging, or whatever.”

“Yeah, you guys totally wife-swapped.”

“We did.”

“And this all happened yesterday. You guys don’t have some flirty group chat Scarlet and I aren’t invited to?”

“No, we never talk about sex on our private group chat. And it’s only you who’s not invited.”

“Har, har.” He looked around again and as he craned his neck to look rearward toward the windows on the yacht’s upper cabin, Byron could see Sully’s jaw trembled. The guy was really stoked about what happened. Like Byron was some adventurer bringing back tales from lands unknown to the peasants who could only dream of such riches and glory. Sully looked back and, voice reduced to a whisper, asked, “What was it like with Carla?”

Byron showed a wowed face, eyes roaming around. Sully chuckled with excitement. “What do you think it was like? Carla is wild.”

“Carla is certainly wild, man. Yeah. So you guys had full-on sex? Penis-in-vagina sex?” In case Byron wasn’t following, Sully inserted his index finger into the grip of the other hand and stabbed it in and out.

“Full-on sex, Sully. And pretty much anything else you can imagine.”

Sully chuckled again, talking to himself, saying, “Carla is so hot. She’s, like, built for sex. I can’t believe she let you put your dick in her.”

“Why the hell not?”

“You guys used condoms, right?”

“Of course,” he said. Though only one of them had stuck to the condom rule. He never should have used a condom with Carla if Chey wasn’t going to.

Something crazy just occurred to Sully, and he jolted, eyes wide, a squeak of an inhale muffled in his throat. “Oh, man,” he said, and grabbed Byron’s arm.

“What is it?”

Sully checked over his shoulders again, then got close—probably because he was too ashamed to make eye contact when he whispered, “Did you titty-fuck her?”

He wished he did. But said now, “Of course.”

Sully’s mouth went O-shaped. “She let you do that?”

“Carla’s wild, you know that. She’d let you do anything you wanted to her.”

Why hadn’t he titty-fucked her? Too scared to ask. Or too consumed by thoughts of Cheyenne with Cody across the hall and all the things that other man might be doing to her. Thinking of how his wife might like it, too. Like it and want it the way he’d wanted Carla.

“All right, you’re sparse with details. You’ll tell me.” He crossed his arms and went up on his toes. “In time, you’ll tell me everything. In time, you’ll be mad I’m not showing interest and you’ll come to me.”

“You’re an idiot,” he said, assuming a rather fun superior tone. “What do you want to know? Carla went down on me. Jesus, Sully, I’m in their room two minutes and Carla’s on her knees sucking my dick.”

Sully made a fist and lightly rapped the knuckles on his forehead like he couldn’t take it.

“We had sex in every position. We went through a box of condoms. She just about wore me out. She’s insatiable. I thought I would fade, but I rallied. In the end, I left her pretty satisfied.”

“Huh,” Sully laughed and nodded.

Byron frowned. “Huh, what?”

“Oh, yeah. You should have heard the noises coming from your room.”

“What noises?”

“Chey was crying and wailing for two hours like a cat in heat. I say to Scarlet, ‘What the hell is Byron doing in there?’ And she’s like, ‘I never knew Byron had it in him.’”

“What do you mean, wailing and crying? *Crying* crying?”

“Not boo-hoo crying, Byron. What the hell crying *could* I mean? Sex sounds. Cries of passion or whatever. Do you think Cody told her sad stories for two hours?”

There was a funny flutter in his stomach and a liquid gurgling in his intestines. In his ears he heard phantom sounds of his sweet Cheyenne making those sex noises she made when they were together, but these phantom noises were louder, more desperate, more . . . *pornographic*. “Two hours?”

“You had two hours with Carla. I can imagine the sounds coming from her room: *you* crying and wailing, maybe a paddling or a whip-crack. Or *real* crying. You *crying* crying while Carla uses your junk as a speed bag.”

Byron regarded the side of Sully’s head as Sully stared out now with an amused expression, squinting into the sun and the light breeze, thinking this was funny. He gritted his teeth and muttered, “Carla’s tits are amazing.”

“I can’t believe you got to feel them.”

“I’m a lucky guy,” he said. “Plus, I think Carla has a little crush on me.”

Sully cocked his head, eyes still out at the view of the lake. “Did you do butt stuff?”

The strength to lie had seeped out. Down his legs and over his feet and spreading across the deck like spilled milk. He shook his head. “No. No

butt stuff.”

“What about Chey?”

He squinted and groaned. A dull ache formed behind his eyes and his neck throbbed. “I didn’t ask her if they did any . . . butt stuff.”

Sully exhaled long and loud, shrugging his shoulders. “You are a lucky guy, Byron. I mean, holy shit, Carla Weber. You slept with Carla Weber. Good for you, man. I couldn’t do it. I mean, I’d love to, but I couldn’t handle Scarlet going off alone with fucking blue-eyed Cody and his abs and his giant crank.”

CHAPTER 28

Cody flipped her over onto her back and loomed above her. His expression had gone to cold stone. He surveyed her now like he tried to comprehend her. A measure of displeasure pulled the features around his mouth downward. He didn't approve. She'd only begun her wife-swapping free trial, and she'd already blown it. Broke some rule she didn't know, but that should have been obvious to anyone with common sense. You were supposed to start out nice and easy and silly Cheyenne climbed the ladder thirty-three feet all the way to the Olympic diving board and went off headfirst.

Cody's hand snaked over her shoulder and behind her head. He took a tight grip on a handful of hair and lifted her higher off the bedding. In a growl, he said, "I couldn't keep my eyes off you. And the way you looked at me got my cock so hard I knew there was no way I wouldn't have you in bed tonight."

At first she thought about objecting. She'd never looked at Cody that way, not before today, at least. And it was never something she thought to pursue, and she'd be horrified Cody thought she'd been sending him fuck signals, because she was a faithful wife—as crazy as that sounded, considering her current position. But then she realized the transformation

Cody performed. The sneering judgment, the mean grasp on her hair, the icy stare and firm jaw. She held her breath a moment, then dared to speak.

She said, “What makes you think I was looking at you?”

“Come on,” he chuckled. “You eye-fucked me so hard I got mascara around the base of my cock.”

She fought the smirk, ended up munching her teeth down on the inside of a smile. There was intensity and a devious charm glowing in Cody’s aqua-blue eyes. In a hushed and rushed whisper: “I’m a— I’m a lonely young housewife, I’m a chaperone at a class trip and my kids are all in their rooms and, and”—the dirty thoughts were coming at her like speed limit signs if she had her car pegged at 150 miles an hour—“and I met you in the hotel bar.”

“Sitting by yourself,” Cody said.

“You don’t even know my name.”

Cody smiled. “I think I do, but I’ve got it wrong, and you don’t even correct me because you don’t care if I know your name. You love it how I don’t even know your name.”

The muscles of her jaw loosened and her mouth went slack. Cody’s eyes burned on her with lust and playful domination. Her pussy quivered. “Oh, fuck, Cody, oh, that’s so hot.”

Cody snarled. “Who the fuck’s *Cody*? That your boyfriend?”

She sneered. “I told you I was married, you dumb cowboy.”

Cody bit his lower lip and narrowed his gaze. There was a devilish glee in his bright blue eyes. “You got a smart mouth, lady.”

“You got yourself in my hotel room. You come to chit-chat, or you sly enough to figure out why you ended up here?”

“That wet between your legs tells me why I’m here. Good Lord, Susan, you’re slicker than a slip-and-slide—and, you want to mouth off at me like that, I’ll put you face down in a pillow and fuck your ass hound-dog style. How about that?”

A shiver of excitement she’d never felt before raced through her. This was astounding new sexual territory, and yet somehow she walked through it with confidence. Cody was a strong, completely masculine partner. And she knew his threats, though struck in jest, would be followed through on. If she mouthed off more, he’d flip her over and fuck her ass while she struggled and pretended to fight with him. A space opened below her stomach, a mighty sea monster’s yawn that could swallow whole all her fears and anxieties and simple hangups. “Just like a man,” she said, low and defiant, “full of threats.”

Cody sucked his teeth, then stepped back from the side of the bed. Their activity enlivened his body; his muscles were full and pumped with blood, the veins standing out in his arms like thick cords. As he stooped to snatch up his shorts, he said, “I knew you was trouble the moment I lay eyes on you in the bar. Beautiful woman all by herself, all alone without a man and sitting in that bar—I knew you was fishing. Fishing for a big old trout that might make you smile for an hour or two.” He produced a row of condoms in metallic foil. The big brand. The big brand he’d stretch on his big cock before he fucked her. Her toes clenched and released and clenched again. A kaleidoscope of phantom butterflies fluttered in her tummy, and her thigh muscles flinched in erotic expectation. Cody broke off a condom packet, tore it open with a quick flick, moving in aggressive bursts like Susan’s sass-mouth riled him and he was going to get back at her, show her who was the boss.

His big hands worked the rubber onto the plump glans, then he shuffled it halfway down his cock. She scooted backward on the bed like she wanted distance between them, but Cody grabbed both her ankles and yanked her closer, bringing her butt right to the edge of the bed, her thighs open and on either side of his hips. Her pussy was bared and exposed to him, and he was obviously very ready to penetrate her. The sight of his engorged cock hitched her breath. Cody was a beautiful male specimen, and his cock suited him. Large and erect, with perfect skin and color and shape, a handsome sack below, not loose enough to sag, held up high like a ripe plum. The soles of her feet tucked against his thighs and stroked up to his hipbones. Her big toe tracing one of those muscular ridges that ran from hip to cock.

Cody gripped her ankles again, and now pushed her knees to her chest, exposing her pussy to penetration. She chewed her lips, watching him guide the head of his cock between her thighs. The moment he batted the meaty end against her swollen opening, she squeaked and her eyes rolled up in her head. A high and brittle shiver raced through her.

“Again,” she whispered.

Cody complied, batting his big cock against her pussy in heavy wet splats. She was flooded. The condom crinkled as he eased the head inside her. She drew a long inhale and looked down at the sight of a man not her husband putting his cock inside her. The sheer badness of what they were doing squeezed at her heart.

Cody let his cock go. It held in place with his glans inside her, and he took the back of her neck. The act of bending forward to do it pushed his cock an inch deeper into her. She whimpered.

Cody pulled her closer, their faces only six inches apart. His cock slid even deeper. He was hard and thick, and it felt like no other penetration before.

Uncomfortable yet welcome, the tight stretch hurting, yet in a way that raced her heart and urged for more and more.

Cody said, “That sharp tongue a yours is because you need something. You need something deep and you need it hard. You’re like a wild mustang. You think I ain’t broke a mustang? You give me an hour and I’ll turn your legs to jelly, Susan.” He bit his lower lip and sneered as he stroked his cock deeper. Her mouth fell open and her breaths came in shallow gasps. “We’ll need two of the ladies from housekeeping to help you upright so you can check out in the morning and go back to your husband, who sure don’t reach those deep spots a woman needs tickled sometimes.”

With that, his grip on her neck tightened, and his sneer became a smile. His cock plunged deeper. The stretch felt like tearing, but in its wake a flood of blood-pumping pleasure pooled between her thighs. The pain washed away, and all that was left was the wonderful cotton wadding of lust and pleasure. Cody withdrew, plunged again.

“Oh God, you’re so big,” she gasped. “Oh, it’s good, it’s so good.”

“We’re just getting started,” he said. “We’re going to wear in your tight little glove, then I’m going to pound you into the floor until you come so many times you don’t even know what day it is.”

The excitement was almost too much to bear. His words were like perfect brushstrokes painting a clear sexual image. Cody was going to dominate her, animal fuck her. The words weren’t empty. She was with the most capable lover in her life. Even if just for a night, she knew Cody was going to deliver something she’d only heard about. Leg shaking, blackout sex that lasted an hour.

* * *

Scarlet's cheeks blushed brighter the further she got into this shameful story. They had recounted it close and side by side on the couch, using hushed tones and mouthing euphemisms for the dirtiest words.

But when she paused for too long, Scarlet sat straighter, gathered her shirt in a clutch at her neck and, with her other hand, played with a lock of her hair. She said, "Sometimes you just need that."

Cheyenne nodded. It was true. The desire she'd felt for that kind of rough, submissive sex to a masculine force had consumed her. She brushed her own hair back from her face and took a few deep breaths. Already, some of the burden she'd shouldered lightened by telling Scarlet what happened. She couldn't tell Scarlet everything, though, could she? It had gone so well to now, but she couldn't say the worst—not even to her sorority sister.

Scarlet cleared her throat and said, "That was some dirty talk."

Cheyenne raised her eyebrows. "It came out of nowhere, Scarlet."

"Cowboy, huh? That's how you saw him?"

She shrugged. "It just felt right."

"I can see it, Cody being a cowboy. So, uh, what happened? You guys had sex?"

"Oh yeah," Cheyenne said. "We had sex. Or, Cody had sex with me."

"You guys went for hours."

"He did what he said he would do. Scarlet, I swear, he had me, like, out of my mind—no, out of my body. Like an out-of-body experience, you know? Like I was up in the corner of the room watching him throw me around like a rag doll and do all these crazy things to me."

"Jesus, Chey," Scarlet sighed.

“What?”

Scarlet scoffed, then chuckled. She tossed her head around a little, like she was trying to figure out how to say what she wanted to say. “That’s a— It’s a pretty hot story.” Now she looked over and their eyes met. Chey scrunched her face up in a guilty grimace.

Chey said, “It’s crazy, right? I’m crazy?”

“It’s pretty crazy, but what am I going to say? You guys did this together, you and Byron. If this is something that floats your boats, or your collective marital boat, I should say, then go for it. If you cheated on Byron, I’d have something to say, but”—she shrugged and chuckled again—“Byron’s in on it.”

“We did it together,” she said, but now a gloomy grayness cowed around her. There was a lot more to the story and maybe Scarlet wouldn’t be so supportive if she dared to tell her friend the truth.

Scarlet fidgeted, leaned close again, eyes shifting from side to side as she contemplated a question. She said, “I want to ask something, but I don’t know how to say it.”

Chey said, “What is it?” Worried somehow that Scarlet knew more than she was letting on, that Sully knew a lot more about what she’d done from his time out in the hall. Maybe that sneak had poked his head in their room.

“Like . . . how many times . . .?”

“Did we have sex?”

Scarlet shook her head no.

“Cody used, I don’t remember, maybe five condoms.”

Scarlet scrunched her nose. “Really? He—you know—five times?”

Plus one time without a condom, but Chey just nodded.

“What I wanted to ask was about *you*. How many times did you . . .?”

“Oh. Yeah. Okay.” She shook her head and looked out at the blue sky. “So many, Scarlet. So many.”

Scarlet’s jaw muscles flexed as she stared anxiously. “Well, you going to tell me?”

CHAPTER 29

Cody thrashed her around the bed, folded her into all kinds of awkward contortions, pushed her knees to her ears, on her side with a knee to her chin. He held her ass in his palms while he stood. He took her from behind, doggy style. He took her from behind, standing bedside and holding her ankles like the arms of a wheelbarrow. It was everything she'd fantasized about. Cody's penis size, his strength, his confidence, and, yeah, his skill, took her over the edge so many times she couldn't count. Sometimes the orgasms raced down her back like quicksilver. Sometimes, especially when he did it from behind when she was on her elbow and knees, they were big swollen balloons of bursting liquid pleasure. Those ones brought the whoosh-whoosh in her eardrums. He'd left her breathless and exhausted and worn out. Her hair hung in wet tangles, her skin was hot and slick. Cody's hard body slid against hers with oily ease. Cody said little during their session. No more cowboy talk, no more calling her Susan. The sex was grunting and gasping, and her crying out and wailing. He made her shriek with orgasms. They'd well up inside and get so huge they scared her like she wouldn't be able to contain it and the incredible lusty pleasure would split her seams and push her beyond what was healthy. He bit her neck; he bit her nipples. He went down on her

when she was groggy, revived her until her eyes opened and she'd tell him she was ready again.

After an hour, eyes half-lidded and hazy, she'd crawled into his lap, a fluttering orgasm aftershock still passing through her insides and down her spine like an electric pulse. She made love to his balls with her mouth. Licked them, pulled them in, tugged. Gentle. He lay back in the pillow and it was the first time in the evening where she felt a modicum of control. He folded his arms behind his head, eyes looking down at another man's wife sucking his balls. His cock throbbed, swollen and stiff, laying back on his hard, muscular belly. Her tongue swathed a path up its wide belly until she could lever his cock forward and sink him into her mouth. When she'd first given him head, it had been a shaky enterprise, one fraught with anxiety and self-consciousness. Now rendered sexually stupefied, every muscle in her body relaxed and loose, every sexual fiber zipping with erotic tension, her pussy sopping and swollen and worn out, she gave him the blow job he deserved. She made it last, using the tip of her tongue while he watched, teasing his urethra and the cloven underside of his cock head. From the floor at the side of the bed came an infrequent chime.

When it became a nuisance, she reached down, snagged his shorts between index and middle finger and flung them up to land on Cody's chest. As he removed his phone from a pocket, she lay her cheek on his thigh and put one of his balls in her mouth. Cody opened his phone, read a text, and texted back.

He said, "They want to know how it's going."

She groaned, "Who?"

"Byron," he said.

“Oh,” she muttered, running the flat of her tongue up the underside of his cock again, getting onto her knees so she could bob up and down. Cody’s moan of pleasure was exquisite. But she could hear him texting.

“Hey, baby?”

She regarded Cody, giving him a sly sexual look with the knob end of his hard cock pushing out her cheek.

He smiled and winked. “Hold that pose, baby. God, you’ve never looked more beautiful, Chey. I swear to God. You were already perfect, but fuck, who knew you were so fucking hot in the sack.” She chuckled through her nose, still sucking.

“Look up again,” he said.

Her eyes met his. He said, “Let me take a picture. We’ll send it to Byron, it’ll blow his mind.”

The idea exploded behind her eyes. An ultimate taboo. An absolute depravity. She could picture the photo: Cody’s abs, his long thick cock pushed into her mouth, her sultry eyes staring at her husband. The sheer exhibition, the bald-faced debasement of a good woman, tightened a knot low in her tummy and her thighs trembled. Just the mere suggestion tickled an orgasmic aftershock out of her. But in its wake, cold reality prevailed. She laughed and pulled his cock out of her mouth, put up a hand between him and his phone and her—he hadn’t even pointed the camera her way at all. The threat of being caught on digital image in such a precarious act was overwhelming. Even while laughing and telling Cody, “No fucking way,” there was a daring *what if?* floating around in the darker recesses of her mind. What if Byron watched her? What if she wanted Byron to watch her? The thought of it tightened a new ache in her nipples.

Cody tossed away his phone and scrambled after her, grabbing her upper arms and getting over top of her while she lay on the bed. His eyes told her he was ready to fuck again.

She said, “I want to suck your cock.”

“I know you do.”

“I want you to come.”

He grunted an affirmative sound in his throat, liking her words.

The hungry feeling between her legs still loomed despite the punishment of the last hour. Punishment and satisfaction. She said, “I want you to come in my mouth.”

Cody uttered a low, lusty grumble, humping his cock against her pussy. “Say it again,” he whispered.

“I want your come in my mouth.”

* * *

It was overwhelming, and Scarlet buried her face in both hands and breathed into them. She smelled maple syrup and bacon from breakfast. She was in the here and now, but her mind had transported to Chey’s bedroom last night, a fly on the wall while her friend had swinger sex. *Dirty* swinger sex. “Oh wow,” she sighed.

Cheyenne said, “Too much?”

“You tell me.”

“I told you it was too much.”

“I wanted to hear.”

“You asked me.”

Scarlet uncovered her face and shook her hands out, drawing in a deep breath of fresh sea air. “That’s crazy hot.”

Chey said, “Is it?”

“Yeah,” Scarlet said. “So, wow. You were going down on Cody while he texted with Byron.”

“Yup.”

“That’s so awful. Wow. I don’t mean *you’re* awful, I mean, that it’s *wild*. Yeah, *wild*.”

Cheyenne groaned and rubbed the back of her neck. “You think that’s pretty bad, huh?”

“I said wild, Chey. Not judging.” She rubbed her eyes and blinked against the phosphorous blobs floating in her vision. Now she shifted to face Chey. She patted Chey’s knee. “So that’s what’s hurting you most about last night? You had that connection with Byron while you were with Cody, and it freaked you out?”

Chey shook her head. “That’s not it, no. I just . . . I haven’t said it to Byron—I couldn’t say it to him—but last night was the absolute craziest, best . . . dirtiest sex I’ve ever had in my life. I can’t stop thinking about it, but I don’t want to hurt Byron’s feelings.”

“You want to do it again, don’t you? You want to be with Cody.”

“I wouldn’t say no. But I have to be honest with Byron, don’t you think?”

“Yeah, you do. For sure. Why wouldn’t you be?”

“It might be hard to hear the truth.”

Scarlet chuckled. “Well, you don’t have to frame it that way, Chey, holy shit. Don’t tell him that Cody rocked your world so hard you’ve changed your perspective on what sex is. Don’t frame it in any way that would make Byron feel bad. You can do it without hurting his feelings. Like, aren’t you worried what Carla might teach Byron?”

“You’re damn right I am.”

“Right. You and Byron both slept with other partners. The sex is going to be different. So, the positive side, the positive way to frame it, is that you’re doing this together as a couple.”

“We *did* do it that way.”

“You didn’t if you don’t tell your husband the truth.”

“You just said not to hurt his feelings.”

“Look, Chey, I’m not in the position you are, so maybe I don’t see it the same way, but you never know, maybe I have a better angle on it. Byron is your partner in this. The only way for it to happen is if you’re both okay with what the other does. You jumped in last night after just a day of some heavy duty flirting. How did Carla convince Byron?”

“Got him to rub some suntan lotion on her,” Chey mumbled. “She took her bikini off.”

“And Byron rubbed her naked back?”

“Look what I did with Cody out in the water.”

“No, I know. That would make me mad—if Sully rubbed Carla’s back?”

“Of course it makes me mad, but I can’t even *be* mad because I’m just as guilty as he is.”

“You need to talk to him. Be open with him. What’s a positive spin on sex with Cody?”

Chey rolled her eyes up and muttered, barely moving her lips, “That it wasn’t like I was having sex with Cody.”

“Right, it was fantasy sex.”

“Yeah?”

“Did you tell him you role-played?”

“No.”

“I bet you Byron would love to hear that.”

“But I need to tell him the truth.”

“You really do. Just be truthful in the way that considers him.”

“Yeah, it’s so simple, Scarlet.”

“Hey, I’m offering you great advice.”

“What if he uses the same ploy on me? Tells me how sex with Carla was no big deal, just some messing around. You know he told me they ended up watching Friends?”

“They watched TV after?”

“What if that’s *his* positive spin? Like, he’s saying it wasn’t that exciting or anything. But there’s more to the story. Like, I know he’s going to tell me he doesn’t think that much of Carla’s huge tits.”

“Look at you getting mad,” Scarlet laughed. “You going to tell him Cody’s big dick that you’ve been gushing over is”—finger quoting—“no big deal to you?”

Cheyenne leaned forward and put her elbows on her knees. She stared out over the handrail at the expanse of sea and sky to the rear of their rented yacht. Scarlet watched her narrow back go in and out as she took slow, contemplative breaths. “There’s more truth to tell, though.”

“Oh yeah?”

They weren’t alone anymore. The glass door to the cabin opened behind them and they both looked over their shoulder to see Philippe coming out to the deck, stretching and shielding his eyes from the bright sun.

Chey’s shoulders slumped, and she faced front again. She said, “We’ll talk later.” She rose and straightened her clothing, then rubbed thumb pads underneath her eyes.

“Talk to Byron, Chey,” she said.

“I know,” Chey said, then hung her head, her expression sagging to glumness. She walked to the door, passing by Philippe, who smiled and followed her along, saying, “Good morning,” to her. Cheyenne only said hi then disappeared back inside the cabin. Philippe shrugged and came to join Scarlet, plopping his bulk down in the seat where Chey had been. He said, “What’s with her?”

“Just girl stuff,” Scarlet said.

Philippe raised his eyebrows and nodded like he understood it would be something not worth pursuing. Then he smiled suddenly and faced her. “Nice day today, eh? Hot sun.”

“Sure is,” she said.

His eyes went up and down her for a moment and she asked him, “What?”

Philippe said, “Wondering what it’s going to take to get you out skinny dipping with us today.”

CHAPTER 30

With three minutes still left on the treadmill's countdown, Cheyenne found him in the yacht's gym. Byron felt immediate guilt, like Chey would make fun of him for the obvious: her husband hadn't worked out in a year, and now, one day into wife swapping, here he was trying to tone up and improve his fitness. It was obvious.

But Chey didn't bug him right away, didn't even say anything to him. The machine was set at a high incline and a moderate pace and he was swamped with sweat already. Chey walked past him, between the vacant Soul Cycles, and ducked under the LCD TV mounted at the front of the gym, just above the panoramic view of the level four deck and the sea and sky beyond. Arms crossed, she leaned on the railing below the window and admired the view, looking up and beyond the level five overhang. Bright, cool light spilled in and painted her in happy colors.

Since there was only one other reason she was here and it obviously wasn't a workout that brought her, it meant Cheyenne wanted to talk. His heart was pounding too hard anyway, and there was no point in pushing yourself too far on your first workout if it meant you were injured or sore and hated the

idea of ever doing it again. He set the treadmill's angle down and slowed his pace to a walk as he muted the TV.

Cheyenne waited for him with placid patience, eyes still roaming the view while shaded sunlight played lines on her pretty profile. There was innocence in her figure's poise; the folded arms, the cocked hip, the casual sweep of her neck, and the angle of her features toward the sun. Cheyenne had sex with another man last night. Cody Weber had his hands all over her, had put his beautiful cock inside her—even going one time without a condom—and according to Sully, Cheyenne's cries of ecstasy kept him and Scarlet awake for two hours. If Sully knew he and Cody had swapped places, that meant Scarlet did as well. Scarlet had already talked to Chey most likely, and he worried how she would take that. Given her current calm demeanor, he had hope that Scarlet didn't chastise her or come down on her for such illicit behavior.

Byron joined her, the two of them very close to the angled glass, leaning with their sides to the spectacular view and looking at each other. The charm in his wife's eyes warmed his heart. They'd done a wild thing and they'd come through. Of course, that sleepy-calm on her face could have come from the incredible sex she had with Cody last night. He smiled.

When he did, Chey smiled too, averting her eyes a moment, but then looking back at him. They both lightly chuckled.

Cheyenne said, "Working out again, are you?"

"I knew you were going to say something."

She smiled, this time showing her teeth. "Just an observation."

"I have some bad news," he said. "Though I have a feeling you already know about it." She said nothing but studied him, one eyebrow lower than the other. "We were overheard last night."

No shock, no shriek of terror, just a single nod. “We were.”

“Did you talk to her yet?”

“Scarlet? Yeah. That’s what you meant, right?”

“Sully came up to me, like just bubbling and gushing.”

“Scarlet wasn’t gushing. I think I’m under judgment, but I also think she’s giving the green light.”

“I’m surprised. And happy, too. I’m happy she’s okay with you having . . .”

“And you too.”

He sighed. “I hadn’t even thought of that. There was a chance she could have blamed me. Been mad at me or accused me of luring you into it.”

“I told her how we were lured into it.”

“What did she say?”

“She wasn’t really surprised.”

“And she’s definitely not mad at me?”

“We didn’t talk much about you and, you know, her.”

“Carla. But you told her all about having sex with Cody.”

She shot him a troubled look, bordering on wounded—like he’d accused her of something terrible. She said, “Did you tell Sully about sex with Carla, or did you tell him about me and Cody?”

“Yeah, okay.”

“Somehow I picture you gushing how great it was, while my story might not be as spectacular as yours. Sully says you were gasping and panting for

two hours.”

“He’s exaggerating.”

Byron was quiet a moment, looking out at the water. “I’m supposed to be happy. I should be happy. That would be the honorable thing. That’s why we did it: to have a wild experience, to do something different. To enjoy it. It hurts a little bit to know you enjoyed it that much.”

Chey looked his way. “Do you think you flubbed it with Carla because of me?”

“I don’t know about flubbing it,” he muttered. “But you were the only thing on my mind, Chey.”

“Are you mad because I didn’t think of you?”

“You didn’t think of me?”

Chey touched his arm, gripped his forearm with tender care. “Not like that, Byron. I didn’t forget you existed. I just mean, I was able to be in the moment, and I wasn’t thinking of you and Carla and being jealous. I woke up really fucking jealous, if it makes you feel any better.”

“It does. I noticed.”

She let her fingers trace to his wrist then wove her fingers between his.

“And you liked it?”

“Of course. How would I feel if you were, like, ‘Hey, that was great, let’s do it again.’”

Chey’s lips thinned. She looked away and said, “Is that something you’re thinking about?”

“Jealousy? Yeah.”

Her eyes went back to his, the sun lighting up the lightest shades of blue.
“No. Doing it again.”

“Oh,” he said, surprised. Her fingers scissored against his, like she didn’t want him to reel and pull away. He’d wondered when this was going to come up and he hadn’t expected it so abruptly.

“Like, you could get the chance you feel like you missed?”

With her fingers between his still, he edged back to a treadmill and leaned against it, a sudden weight on his shoulders becoming too much to bear. Chey followed him, a compassionate look on her face, opening her stance so her sneakers were on the outside of his, planted together. “Both of us do it again, you mean.”

She nodded. “I’d consider it, if Cody and Carla were willing.”

“Didn’t sound like you flubbed it, though. You’d want to do it again because the sex was so good.”

“Was it really no good for you?”

Truth was he didn’t know what to make out of his time with Carla. She’d been intimidating and aggressive, and he’d been filled with thoughts of his wife with Carla’s husband. And yet the whole escapade had begun with Carla’s temptation. The putting of his dick in a toilet tube, the flashing of her boobies, then the naked sunbathing. He’d come to Chey wanting to float the idea of swinging. Maybe in a way, despite his desire for it to happen, deep in his brain, he’d known Chey would never go for it. Then Chey went for it, and somehow he’d never expected his time with Carla ever truly becoming a reality. It was easy to see in retrospect how the situation overwhelmed him. “It was good, but I guess I’d say it wasn’t what I expected. Or anticipated.”

Chey thought about it a while. She said, “So what do you think, then?”

“You want Cody again, huh?”

Chey smirked. “It’s not Cody. It’s me. Or, I guess, what Cody brings out of me.”

It took great restraint not to roll his eyes in front of her. “Your inner bad girl?”

“Worse than that,” she said, frowning. “I think my inner bad girl would be intimidated by the girl Cody made me.”

The thought twisted his stomach. “Cody *made* you?”

“No. I made myself. But with Cody. I couldn’t be that girl with you.”

“I’m not sexy enough?”

“Because I’d be embarrassed or something. I wouldn’t want to be like that girl with you. That’s not what you and I have.” She leaned in and lay both her palms on his chest.

“You going to tell me what kind of girl you were with Cody?”

A real struggle waged behind Chey’s beautiful eyes. Mouth firm, brow even, she said, “I will if you want me to.”

The thought of what horror story might pass his wife’s lips raced through him like a crazed ghost released from purgatory. What awful things might she say? “No. I don’t think I’m ready.”

She nodded, relieved, and patted his chest. “I’ll tell you everything when you are ready.”

“So this is it?”

“Is what it?”

“We’re going to do it again?”

Chey looked worried. “If they’re willing, yeah, we should talk about it.”

“What’s there to talk about?”

“Rules, strategies, logistics. We were doing it before we’d got a good chance to think. I know more of what I want.”

The fact his wife had things she wanted, and she knew what they were, suddenly stiffened him. The urge to find out everything she did tugged at him, but he was still too chicken to hear it.

“Okay,” he said and nodded. “I’m not an afterthought. I’m not a non-participant. Just because all I talk about is you, doesn’t mean that this is your experience only.”

“I know. I know it’s your experience, too. I told you I’m jealous, what more do you need from me? I mean it, tell me. I want what we did to be good for us.”

“Talk to me. Talk to me about me. Maybe your time with Cody is prominent in your mind, but talk to me about me. Talk to me about my experience.”

“Even if it makes me uncomfortable?”

“No, I don’t want that. I don’t want you uncomfortable. But you maybe you should face down the discomfort. I sure am facing mine down—I’m going toe-to-toe with it. Just standing behind you when you were looking out the window, all I could think about was Cody’s hands on your body.”

“In a bad way? Can you deal with this or not?”

“In a bad way, sure. But also in”—he sighed and raked fingers through his hair—“I don’t know, I guess in an exciting way, too. It definitely gets my heart racing.”

“My heart doesn’t race thinking of you and what’s-her-name, all I get is a funny feeling in my stomach. And I grit my teeth until my temples hurt.”

“It makes you mad?”

“Yeah. It’s not the end of the world. Like you said, I have to face it down.”

“I hate thinking of you with Cody, but this is crazy—I also *like* to think about it. It hurts my heart, but it does something else to me that’s so fucking wild.”

Cheyenne took that in and considered it. “Really?”

“Yeah,” he admitted. “So. Strategies and logistics?”

“First we have to find out what they want to do. What if they’re done with us?”

“I doubt Cody’s done with you.”

Cheyenne’s mouth tucked to one side like she didn’t like always being attacked. “I’m sure Carla wouldn’t turn down one of your foot rubs.”

He couldn’t help laughing. “You’re jealous of a stupid foot rub?”

“It’s not funny, Byron. That’s, like, personal.”

“Chey,” he said, still chuckling, “you might have this skewed.”

Chey made a small fist and lightly punched his arm, her features twisted in mild anger. She thumped him again and again, so soft he barely felt it. She sniffled and wiggled her nose. “Logistics,” she said, her voice a little thick.

“Strategy first, Chey.”

She shook her head no, not smiling. “Can we go out to the other room? I need to sit down. You need to sit down.”

His fingers tingled, and his scalp tightened. No one ever said you need to sit down if there wasn’t some devastating news. The only thing he could think of is that Cody had ejaculated inside her and now Chey had to admit that she had been skipping pills or something and didn’t feel so guaranteed in her paused fertility. The sudden idea of his wife sitting him down to tell him another man impregnated her made his head muzzy and bleached. He leaned on the treadmill to steady himself.

“Please, Byron.” He looked up to see her a few paces away, heading between the treadmills and cycles to go up the ramp to the inner room where there was a lounge.

He smeared a brave expression on his face and followed her out to the lounge, the whole while his ears ringing. Chey picked the couch for two, and cuddled herself in the corner, pulling a pillow into her lap and hugging it. He joined her, the two of them side by side and quarter-turned to face each other.

Chey sniffled again and wiped her eyes.

“What is it? Is it your pill?”

She looked confused a moment and shook her head no. “No, that’s fine, Byron.”

“So what is it?”

It took her forever to answer, her face in that time a cavalcade of expressions showing doubt and fear and like she wanted any reason not to tell him what she was about to. He put a hand out and took hers.

She said, “Before we decide whether we do this again, I have to be honest.”

“Honest about what?”

Her nails dug into the flesh of his palm. “I got . . . carried away.”

“Okay. More than skipping a condom?”

“Yeah. More than that.”

Whatever it was, it troubled her. His stomach went icy.

Chey licked her lips, her quivering eyes on his. “Cody and I weren’t alone. Philippe joined us.”

CHAPTER 31

There were better ways to phrase it, but in the dire moment of her confession, it was the plainest way she could administer the truth. The look on Byron's face told her right away that she'd made the wrong choice. Why say this to Byron here? Why say this in the middle of the living area, and not sequestered like a jury in some secret location?

"Not like that, Byron," she said, clutching his shirt sleeve and preventing him from leaving. He'd half-turned, disgusted and wounded, looking to get up and abandon her.

Byron was undeterred by her light pinch on his cotton, and rose, anyway. She grabbed his arm and clutched it to her chest, weighing him down. "Stop, Byron, stop," she said, not shrill, not excited, but adamant.

Byron pinched the bridge of his nose, unable to look at her, his posture pulled to one side as she pulled him down to the couch with her bodyweight. "What the fuck, Chey? Seriously, this has got to be a fucking joke. Let go of my arm."

"No, Byron," she said, "let me talk. If you leave, you're going to go off and make up crazy stories in your head."

“You’re putting the stories there, Chey,” he said, voice rising with anger. “You fucked Cody and Philippe. What more is there for me to make up?”

“Stop, I didn’t do *that*. Sit down and let me tell you.”

Byron’s head turned and looked down. “Didn’t what?”

“Not both of them.”

“You didn’t fuck Philippe?”

She shrugged and rolled her eyes around. “Please let me explain, okay?”

Byron tugged away his arm, eyes narrow and fierce, his cute mouth slimmed to a firm line. But at least he dropped to the couch again—but prowling close to her, eyes on hers. “Did you fuck Philippe or not?”

She swallowed hard. “I didn’t.”

Byron’s anger still shone in his eyes. “Did you suck his cock?”

“No. Can I explain? I know you want to storm off right now and punish me. I’d feel the same way, too. It would feel so good, Byron. I agree with you. But if you stay, I will tell you all the truth. All of it. If you’re ready to hear it or not, I need to tell you the truth.”

“You’re going to tell me the truth as a way so we can do this again. There is no fucking way we’re doing this again. If Philippe was there with you, this is over.”

When her jaw trembled, Byron saw a hideous other meaning in his statement and said, “This swinging thing is over. Not you and me. I don’t mean that.”

The silence was thick and unsettling, the weight of Byron’s words left all the emotional ugliness of swinging hanging in the air like a rotten stench.

“I have to tell you the truth, Byron. I hate what happened—and don’t start by saying how I just said we should try again—I hate it, but I never saw it coming.”

“Saw what coming?”

“The way things could escalate. The way my brain would react to doing something so wild and dirty and so . . . taboo.”

“What did you expect, Chey?”

“What did you expect, Byron? Not to challenge you, but, come on, did you think you would go in with Carla and end up watching *Friends*?”

“No. It’s not like that, I—”

“In my head I thought you would swap place with Cody for an hour, and it would be simple: I’d get in bed with Cody and we’d do our thing and then we’d sneak the couples back together the way they were meant to be. But it didn’t turn out like that. I was nervous and—”

“You think I wasn’t nervous?”

“I know you were, baby.” Byron winced and showed disgust that she would use a pet name for him right now when he was hurting and mad, but at least he didn’t say anything. He folded his arms and tightened his mouth again. “Hey, did you ever think maybe Carla failed *you*?”

Without looking, he muttered, “How do you mean?”

“Cody took control. I didn’t have to lead. He asked me what I liked but I couldn’t really answer, and the next thing he’s working with me, and when I didn’t know what I wanted before, with a little provocation, I was able to tell him what I wanted.”

Byron shook his head, narrowed his eyes, and chewed his cheek. “What was it you wanted?”

“I guess detachment.”

He looked her way, frowning—probably expecting a dirtier, lewder answer. “What?”

“I didn’t want to be in the moment. I didn’t want to be having sex with Cody in our room. I wanted something else, and Cody was game enough to play it out with me.”

Byron’s expression was hard to decipher. He was hurt, still mad too, but a wondrous bright had opened his eyes, and there was a brief twinge of lust in there. This game they’d played last night had opened their horizons more than she ever could have anticipated—and despite Byron’s arm-folding ramparts, she knew his heart beat faster with her re-telling of what she’d done with Cody. But she had to explain it right.

She said, “I didn’t want to be with Cody. And I didn’t want to be me. We started pretending to be other people and in just a few seconds, the whole scenario wasn’t me and Cody. It was some horny Midwest housewife away from home, meeting a strange cowboy in her hotel room for a quickie.”

Byron’s eyes stayed steady on hers, blinking and considering, and most importantly, easing the hard, judgmental edge, soothing his brow to somewhere nearer to understanding. She smirked a little, some provocative lightness, trying to lure her wonderful husband’s nicer side to the surface. “I was the housewife, in case you were wondering.” Her posture sagged, and her smirk grew wider. The lines in Byron’s brow eased, and she saw a conciliatory quirk to the corner of his tight mouth. Almost a smile.

Now she eased her feet underneath her, getting comfortable and leaning her side on the couch’s seat back. Her hands smoothed the points of her knees

and Byron watched her, waiting. “That really worked for me, Byron. It worked because I wasn’t Cheyenne Bishop who has a husband she loves. I got to be someone else. It wasn’t me at all. And the guy I was with? It wasn’t Cody.”

“But you wanted to be with Cody. He was your choice.”

“I know. But it wasn’t Cody Weber who is married to Carla and we’ve known for like eight years. He wasn’t that guy. He was, like, a complicated and elaborate sex toy. That’s why Sully says I made so much noise.” She rolled her eyes, rubbed her knees. “It wasn’t Cody doing it, it was me. My brain. Getting this weird fantasy delivered, and I didn’t even know I wanted it. Once it was keyed in, Byron, I swear, I wasn’t even *me*.”

Byron nodded. How could he not like what she’d just told him? What it amounted to was Cody wasn’t the real attraction of the night. It was her own brain. But something still curdled in Byron’s stomach. It was easy to see on his face. And that’s where the story got trickier. Philippe’s arrival was an astounding complication, and one that would be hard to vindicate.

She said, “Remember when you texted us?”

Byron’s brow lowered, and he shook his head.

“You don’t remember?”

He faced her, and she was glad to see the anger gone. Her husband was still bristling, arms still folded, but he was open and listening. “I didn’t text. Carla did.”

“Oh,” she said, puzzled. “I thought it was you and Cody talking.”

“No. It was Carla. I made her text you guys. She didn’t want to, but I was persistent.”

“Oh okay, whew,” she said. “So it *was* you.”

“Yeah. Through Carla. Carla said you were sucking Cody’s cock and did I want to see a picture.”

A heat crossed her cheeks and a topsy-turvy wave of embarrassment passed through her stomach. She patted her cheeks and couldn’t meet Byron’s eyes. Her cheeks had blushed. She could feel the heat on her fingertips. And the more aware she became, the more the heat blazed. She whispered, “Well, that was how it got crazy. I said no way, but I couldn’t stop thinking of the idea. How much I wanted to show you.”

* * *

Cody curled her up in his lap, her ribs draped over one of his folded-up legs. His cock was in her mouth and it felt so good there. The smooth expanse of his swollen glans slipped across her tongue. And when he’d flex his stomach every once in a while as he shifted, he’d pulse pre-cum in her mouth. The slippery feel of her blow job was turning her on. She couldn’t wait for this well-hung cowboy to blow his load into her dirty whore mouth. But as she suckled, laying in his lap, his hand had gained access to her core. He teased her opening, played with her, found the plump stone of her clitoris in her hot, slick pussy flesh and worked it until bright pleasure orbs danced in her vision. He fingered her. One finger for a while, then two. Then three. Curling them, running the pads in stroking circles against her frontmost wall. She was gasping around his thick cock. Laying it on her cheek, eyes closed, mouth hanging open as Cody encouraged a few shivering orgasms from her that way.

While she’d sucked his cock, she’d pretended Byron was in the room. She pretended he was sitting on the two seat couch right by the bedside. She was still the housewife, and Byron was that woman’s husband. Not the

Byron she knew, because she wasn't Cheyenne, she was Susan, or at least some woman this hot cowboy thought was named Susan. She'd performed a lewd, sloppy blowjob, testing it out in her mind what Byron would see. Imagining Byron watching her pink tongue bathe another man's big hard shaft, run the tip around the swell of his coronal ridge, drink up the man's shining lubrication as it pulsed from the tip. The idea turned her on like nothing ever before. Those lusty snakes in her belly came alive. A slimy nest of shining anfractuuous snakes coming to life, writhing and squirming.

The fingering brought her out of that fantasy performance—she didn't think Byron would enjoy watching her get fingered. But Cody had sexual power over her, and she was willing to see where he would take her. So far tonight, everything he'd done had blown her top. She'd said do whatever you want. Treat me like a sex toy. And Cody had. He'd pounded her in all sorts of awkward positions. No man had ever held her in his arms and stood fucking her with her knees draped over his forearms. So when Cody encouraged her onto her back, she let him. She sprawled out again, with his hands between her legs, fucking her slowly with three bunched fingers, the muscles in his shoulder flexing and twitching. He suckled her nipples, and she came again.

But then Cody was up, standing by the bedside, tearing open the last of his condoms. She rolled to her side, vision foggy from the orgasm, a whooshing sound still in her ears. She watched him stretch the condom down his cock, the skin shining from her saliva. He spoke while he did, talking in a detached way the cowboy would talk to Susan. The game was back on and she was ready for a lot more. He said, "I'm going to come in your mouth, Susan. Don't worry about that. I'm gonna empty these big balls on your tongue. But your pussy's too wet for me to ignore. That pussy is begging for cock right now."

She nodded, watched as he picked his phone up from the pillows and typed out a string of words and tossed it back. Now he stood above her, hands on

hips, masculine gaze studying her. “Hey, Susan, work that body around til you can show me that puss.”

She complied, moving her limbs in languid seductive strokes, arranging herself before him, legs open and knees bent over the mattress edge, Cody standing where he could fuck her. He studied her pussy, and she had to close her eyes and hold her breath. The way he looked at her exposed this way excited a renewed gallop in her heartbeat.

“Gimme a good look-see, darling,” he said, low and grumbling, playing up his Texas accent. “Spread those pretty pink petals for me.”

“Oh god,” she gasped, the sheer depravity of this night hadn’t even been reached. She’d already been driven wilder than in her entire life and now Cody just found sixth gear and pressed the accelerator.

Her fingers pinched her delicate flesh and tugged them aside to show Cody her opening. The flesh was slippery, so she had to regain them a few times. Cody’s eyes between her thighs as she exposed herself in this kinky inspection got her hands trembling. Her flesh grew harder to hold and her breaths came quicker. She was going to come just by Cody commanding her to show him her pussy.

Cody eased closer, took his cock in hand and batted her opened pussy. The heaviness of his manhood squashed against her clit in muffled shocks of electric pleasure. He had her moaning, and soon surrendering. Letting go of her petals and stretching her arms overhead, letting him spear her with his perfect cock. He fucked her in shallow strokes, getting her breasts to roll in circles on her chest. Then he fucked her deeper. He made her come.

A soft knocking on the door got her eyes fluttering. Cody smiled. He said, “Now, you can say no, darlin’, but I got another handsome hombre running with me on the rodeo circuit. He’s staying with me in the hotel. This is a

good-looking boy—you're gonna like him. He's just your type. Now this boy's been on a dry spell and I know he's got the hots for you. He ain't gonna touch you, darlin,' I swear it. He just wants to sit and watch it go in and out of you. It'd be real swell of you to let this boy sit and take a look. It'll make his day. What do you say?"

She chuckled and smiled. Byron. When Cody said they should take a picture, she said no way. But then, every second after that, she was thinking how hot it would be. *Thinking what if Byron was watching me do this with my tongue, what if he saw Cody's cock head stick my cheek out?* And it turned her on like crazy.

Still laying on the bed, knees over the edge, legs open, sexual wet smearing her inner thighs, her pussy, all the way to her belly button and the knobs of her hipbones, she waved Cody to come closer. He got over top of her, smiling that confident smile. She put her arms around him, smoothing his hard, muscular body. One hand swooped between his legs, cradled his heavy balls, stroked his shaft, then guided him to enter her. She kissed his mouth, bit his lower lip, then whispered in his ear. "Tell your cowboy friend to get in here."

CHAPTER 32

B yron frowned and groaned and shook his head no. Cheyenne stopped talking. A pressure squeezed on his temples like a strongman trying to crush his skull. He leaned forward and rubbed his eyes. “You can’t expect me to believe that, Chey.”

Instead of clamoring to shore up her ridiculous story, instead of adopting a pleading tone that would attempt to convince him, Chey got angry. She poked him hard in the side, making him jolt and sit upright, blinking and wincing. “What the fuck, Chey?”

“*You* what the fuck, Byron.” She stared holes in him, her pretty face scrunched, nostrils flared, her jaw muscles flexing. But barely holding on, like she could burst into tears at any second. Her cheeks blazed red and her eyes shone like wet glass. “I’m fucking pouring it out to you right now.”

The tremble in her voice told him this was very real and hard for her to recount and that she was trusting him with a lot. If what she said was true, two men had taken her advantage of her. As her husband, he shouldn’t be disbelieving, he should be mad as hell and looking to throw someone off the boat. He stared at her for a long while, letting the badness between them dissolve until Chey felt like she could trust him and continue.

When her features softened, he got right to the point. “Did they take advantage of you? Did Cody trick you?”

She looked down and shook her head no. “It was really a misunderstanding.”

“Are you sure?”

“Of course I’m sure.”

“Chey, if you think in any way that those two did anything—”

“No, Byron,” she said, sighing, rubbing her own temples. “I’m not mad at them.”

“How can you not be?”

She looked up at him, then away, staring off to the other side of the room and contemplating what she would say next. “I told you, it was a misunderstanding. Cody asked first.”

“Yeah, but you thought it was me.”

“He didn’t know that’s what I thought. In retrospect, what he said to introduce Philippe sounded more like Philippe than you. It’s just that I was thinking about the texting, thinking about you seeing me doing what I was doing.”

Byron leaned back in the seat corner, pressing his back into the pillow and running his hands through his hair while staring up at the ceiling. He shot forward. “You said you weren’t thinking of me.”

“Yeah?”

“But you were. You *were* thinking of me.” This excited him like crazy. Not that he’d been particularly mad that Chey had been pretending to be

someone else while she had sex with Cody, but to find out the opposite was true, that she had considered him . . .?

Chey frowned, thinking. “I guess I was.”

“And you’re not mad at them?”

She grimaced and shook her head no. “Not at all, Byron. They don’t even know I thought it was you.”

“You didn’t tell them?”

“No.”

“Oh,” he muttered, realizing something. “You let Philippe stay and watch?”

She nodded.

* * *

While slowly fucking her, Cody said over his shoulder, “Come in.”

The door opened, and Byron entered. The door closed with a quiet click. She and Cody were sideways on the bed. Cody’s feet were on the floor, and her knees were bent over the bed’s edge. This meant Byron’s view right now would be of Cody’s naked back, Cody on top of her as she lay naked on the bed. Byron would see Cody’s balls hanging. Would he see where Cody had impaled her pussy?

And why the fuck was that thought so thrilling?

It was the opposite thing she should be thinking. She should be just doing a quick one-hour session with Cody, then Byron could come back and they would snuggle. How had something that had been such a drastic step for them in the first place escalated to insane levels so fast?

Oh God. Byron just took a seat on the built-in leather sofa at the side of the bed. For sure now, he could see Cody's cock inside her. How could Byron stand it? How could she want Byron to stand it? Shivering sheets of ecstatic pleasure wavered down her spine and through her core in relentless pulses; her skin went to goosebumps and her nipples tightened to painful buds.

Now she challenged herself to do harsher things. Cody stroked his heavenly cock in and out of her while her husband watched the entry point-blank. Maybe just two feet away. She kissed Cody's hard chest. She moaned. She stroked the soles of her feet up and down the backs of Cody's thighs. Still Byron watched.

The longer he stayed, the hornier she got. An immense pressure built inside her. It was pleasurable, but frightening. Too much pleasure to contain. Like she might scream at some point.

She came from fucking right in front of Byron. She was vocal. She cried and moaned and gasped while the orgasm swept through her. Her legs shook and her feet arced, toes pointing, calves cramping. She shrieked in small gasps as Cody began fucking her again. This time deeper. Showing her husband what a slutty, wet wife Cheyenne was. The panting became real. It had started out as theatrical, meant to arouse her husband. *Cosmo* said the sounds of a woman having sex were arousing and enticing and alluring for men. Imagine Byron hearing those sounds from his own wife.

Cody fucked another orgasm from her while Byron watched. She heard her husband shifting on the leather. Was Byron hard as a rock right now? Of course he was. How could he not be? He was finding out his otherwise demure wife was a total sex goddess at the same time as she was.

That was when she was sure she heard Byron masturbating. It sent her over the edge instantly. A wild and surprising orgasm raced through her again and she clutched herself to Cody's chest while he kept thrusting his cock in

and out. She bit Cody's chest again, ran her nails across his back—where Byron could see how wild this other man made her.

It was coming out of that orgasm with the pressure unrelieved and still building that she instructed her hands to launch a suicide mission. This would be where Byron popped. This would be where Byron would ejaculate and then say to stop. This would be the wild thing that Byron would forever remember of their first foray into sexual adventure. Her palms stroked Cody's belly, gathering between their legs, one thumb and forefinger circling his thick base and guiding him to pull out. The other hand lay in wait, and as his cock came free and fell into that hand, she found the condom's edge and began to unroll it. She unsheathed Cody's cock, gave the incredible thing a few strokes, then guided the point into her opening. The touch of his slick and bare cock head into her eager aperture got her gasping and her toes clenching. Though her eyes were closed, they rolled up high with the unbelievable feel of his unprotected cock. Right in front of Byron. And Cody loved it too. His grunts deepened, and he began to tremble and huff. He was close. This got another quick shiver racing through her and blotting her black vision with dancing phosphorescent orbs.

“Oh God,” she began to chant over and over again. Cody thrust deeper and harder and she circled her arms around his strong neck. His blonde hair was damp and heavy, swinging against her cheek as he rutted into her.

Byron watched and did nothing. Byron didn't stop his wife from having unprotected sex. He watched and masturbated.

She came again. A desperate sort of feeling, like how could she finally orgasm and relieve this enormous sexual pressure and tension squeezing her? What would it take to shake this insane horniness?

She whispered to Cody, “I don't want you to come in my mouth.”

“I know,” he grunted.

“You know where I want it?”

“Uh-huh,” he groaned, rocking against her, his thick cock spreading her wide, that swollen knot end scoring deep inside her, up where she’d never felt a man before.

Now for Byron’s benefit: “Yeah, mm, come inside me. Okay? Oh, I want you to come inside me.”

Byron did nothing. Byron watched. Cody’s thrusting became wild and erratic, his breath like a freight train. She cried out in passion in time with his growling pleasure, the two of them making sexual music that must be driving Byron out of his mind. This was it. Another man was going to come inside her. Another man was going to come inside her while her husband watched.

Cody stabbed deep and let out an animal roar. He pulled back and rammed deep again. She hollered from the sheer unleashing of that tyrannical seizure of her sexuality. That looming expansion of her core to the point of discomfort finally gave way, and the biggest orgasm of her life tore through her like a tropical storm. Hot red tidal waves crashed on her shore and blasted away the villages and tenements of her carefully structured life. The release of all that pressure got her hollering and crying as it finally blasted out of her. She came like never before. Came while Cody came inside her. His big cock flexed and pulsed and cabled inside her. His enormous wet made her insides so slick every heartbeat brought a wild sexual tickle to the throbbing plum-point of his enormous cock head deep inside her. They both gasped and huffed and hitched breath. She dug her claws into Cody’s hard back and hugged her face to his chest.

While she thought of Byron, she couldn't escape the fact that she'd just shared a huge connection with Cody. He'd been a tool to get off on, but what they did together was special.

As he pulled out, she whimpered with the quivering orgasm aftershocks his retreat inspired. The flared edge of his cock head brought silvery orgasmic tendrils that zapped from her sex flesh to a point somewhere at the base of her skull.

But at that point, the regret formed, and she feared what she would see at the side of the bed. What if she was wrong and Byron had fled? What if he didn't enjoy it at all? How could he? He would be insane to watch that. Regret and shame swelled within her—room now to grow since the horny tension bubble had finally burst. She covered her eyes with a hand as Cody stepped aside and sat up in the pillows, no longer eclipsing Byron's view.

Byron wasn't gone. She heard that sound she thought was masturbating. Heard the low chest-rumble of a man enjoying pleasure. Her hand moved aside, and she regarded him.

Only it wasn't him. It wasn't Byron.

Philippe sat at the side of the bed on the couch, watching Cody fuck her. Of course, it wasn't Byron. How could she ever have thought that her husband would watch that? It was Philippe. The guy who knew Cody and Carla swapped. Had probably swapped with them before. Had probably shared Paloma with Cody. Had probably done something like this with Carla, with Paloma, or whoever else they wanted to get in their beds.

Though shocked, instead of fright or embarrassment, she felt relief. She'd gone too far for her husband's sake. Wanting to show him how sexy and dirty his amazing wife was—and she'd done something horrible. Horrible enough that in the blink-moment afterward, she felt the shame and regret.

Now it was gone. Byron didn't see what she showed him at all. She got away with it.

Philippe sat on the couch with his legs apart, his robe open. His cock was hard as a rock and the most grotesque manhood one could imagine. Like a monster's cock. His eyes watched between her legs. He was fantasizing about fucking her. Fantasizing Byron's slutty wife would let him get sloppy seconds, put his enormous man meat inside her and use Cody's load as lube and rut into her as she lay writhing in post-orgasmic ecstasy on the bed, filling her up with his own load. His large hand stroked his uncircumcised cock, and it excited her to see the plump end exposed in his downstroke. The thick foreskin would roll away and expose the perfect smoothness of his organ's most sensitive spot.

Her legs writhed and her hips shimmied. Cody's semen leaked from her and Philippe watched it while he masturbated. God, what if it *was* Byron? Imagine Byron seeing this shameful display. "Oh," she gasped and jolted as another slippery orgasm thrilled through her.

She gasped for breath and met Philippe's eyes. Locked eyes with him as he stroked that massive weapon. She nodded and bit her lips and gave him the face she would give if he was fucking her. He came. His jerking hand went faster, then squeezed. She watched swirling ropes of semen launch from his unprotected cock head and splat into his chest hair. He kept coming. More ropes burst from his cock to arc and land on his stomach and chest.

The ghastly sight brought more zipping pleasure through her brain and she went muzzy and gray, wondering how more awful she could possibly be.

CHAPTER 33

The hideous confession from the woman he loved destroyed him. Yet he was still standing. The story she told him should deliver the kind of nuclear devastation that led to the irrevocable termination of a relationship. A kaleidoscope of terrifying images flickered through his mind in dim, sepia-toned low wattage horror, like a snuff film shot on 8mm. Cheyenne getting pounded. Cody's slick blond hair. Cody's cock—he'd seen it in Carla's bedroom as she got on her knees to worship it—reaming in and out of his wife's tenderest space. The pleasure displayed on Chey's face as Cody's out-sized organ touched her in places her husband couldn't. Sweat on her skin. A closeup of her erect nipple. And Philippe watching. Philippe jerking off to Cheyenne Bishop getting fucked deep and hard. His big, weird, uncircumcised cock. Cheyenne showing Philippe her beaten pussy while he ejaculated. How much come was there? He bet it impressed Cheyenne. She orgasmed from it. Globbs of pearly semen on Philippe's hairy chest, tendrils of come sagging between the thick black strands.

Chey sat pushed into the opposite corner, no longer close to him, knowing, he supposed, that such a story told to your husband could send him into violent thrashing. She clutched a protective pillow to her midsection, and eyed him with existential dread, her lips pulled thin and wriggling nervously.

Instead of wanting to hurl—which would be the most natural reaction to such a confession from a trusted love one—his stomach was a solid block of lead. Inert, steady, but heavy and awkward and looming with threat. There was no explosion of rage or horror. The urge was there, but it seemed like that was behavioral conditioning. When you didn't know how to act in a situation, sometimes your brain recalled someone else's similar reaction and adopted that. In countless movies, the reaction he would have expected from himself was a red-faced, vein-blasting, juggernaut's rampage. But Chey's story did the opposite to him. It knocked him out. It devastated him. It deflated the ego and the masculine monster that should lurk within him. All those interior components knew not a thing about how to deal with this confession. Instead, he was left hollow and muffled, unsure of what to think. He could focus on Cody or Philippe and produce some anger, but he didn't want to think about them at all. All he wanted to think about was Cheyenne.

The urge to flee was strong. It would be the easiest thing to do, and it would also have the added benefit of hurting Cheyenne. He could storm off and pack his bags and, oh golly, it would reduce Chey to a shrieking puddle. Scarlet would have to come and console her, and it would cause a devastating scene. It felt good to consider it. It would be easy and it would feel good. And he could hurt Cheyenne in return.

He sat on the edge of the couch seat, feet firmly planted on the floor, elbows on knees, hunched over, staring at his shoes. He regarded Cheyenne again. She waited with sullen expectation, wanting to know his verdict but afraid to prompt him right now in case the verdict was one she didn't want to hear. Cheyenne must be anticipating the end of their marriage. It was a possibility.

He sat back and sighed, puffed out his cheeks and let go a slow exhalatory trail from his pouted lips. His hands rubbed up and down his bare thighs

and played with the hem of his workout shorts.

“That’s . . . That’s a lot of truth,” he said without looking her way, eyes cast to the gym and the window-sliver of blue sky out there.

Cheyenne didn’t answer. He quarter-faced her and saw a tear stream her cheek and run along the edge of her jaw. She wiped it away and tucked her chin down. Another tear came.

Then a sudden flinch of worry: this was truly existential marital discord. A flash of trouble got him blinking like Cheyenne stood in fierce sunlight, angling a mirror his way and blinding him. A fear shone like a fragment of glass in black sand. Cheyenne rode the line of ending it with him by telling him.

“So what does this mean, Chey?” He gathered his hands between his legs and clasped them together, that leaden feeling in his belly beginning to revolve and bob like a toxic molten ball in a poisoned Chinese river.

She shook her head uncomprehendingly and rolled her wet eyes around the room. Her lips pursed to a plump point.

Yeah, he could hurt her. He could end their marriage—or at least pretend he could. But he didn’t want that. And he was afraid to challenge her with the threat of it. She’d dared to tell him an awful truth—an awful thing she’d done. What if she told him that because she was unafraid of the consequences? What if she was fine with ending the marriage? She’d just been with another man last night and from all accounts, the session had been spectacular. What if Cheyenne had a sudden urge to hit the market, swipe right on her own Cody Weber, one she could claim as her own?

Cheyenne was the ultimate prize here. His marriage to her was the unassailable treasure in this adventure. Preservation was of the utmost

importance. He sat staring at her, blinking, breathing, and Chey looked down, fingers playing with the dangling tassel on a pillow corner.

“I’m trying to reconcile something,” he said.

She looked up, head cocked aside, eyes watery and weak, cheeks red, face puffy. “What?”

“Before you told me all this, you arranged that we might possibly do it again.”

She nodded, looked down again.

“When you said that, did you know you were going to tell me the truth?”

“Yeah.”

Now it was him looking around the room. Dead inside. That’s how he felt. Just all over empty, arms heavy, knees weak . . .

“Why?”

She said, “Why what?”

“Why do you think we would ever try it again if this is what happened the first time?” A sudden gorge rose in his throat—that fucking image of semen on Philippe’s chest. It made him think of airport cinnamon rolls. He retched a little and put his fist to his mouth.

Cheyenne said, “We don’t have to, Byron. But I have to be honest with you. I couldn’t keep that from you. And, I really, really . . .”

Her voice went thin and broke with a breathy tremble of crying.

“Really what?”

“Want you to be honest with me about . . .” A tear rolled down her cheek.
“About you and Carla.”

“What about us?”

“I want you to tell me the truth about her.”

“What truth, Chey?”

“What you did with her. You can tell me. Tell me for real.”

“I told you for real, Chey.”

“Okay,” she said, eyes popping up to the ceiling for a second. She wiped her cheeks and sniffled. “We have to be honest with each other. And I didn’t want to keep that from you.”

“No kidding, Chey. Two guys . . .?”

“I didn’t have sex with two guys. Please don’t say that.”

He studied his wife. She was a bubbling mess. Nose runny, eyes teary, a vein pulsing in her temple. She was barely holding it together. It was a good thing.

He groaned and scrubbed his cheeks, his groan turning to a grumbling low roar. “I don’t know what to do about those two fucking *assholes*.” His voice had raised.

“Don’t, please?” Chey said pleadingly, voice thick. “Please don’t say anything to them, Byron.”

“What? Why not?”

Chey looked away, mouth open, not knowing how to explain it. Her eyes returned to his. “They don’t know I thought it was you. They think I was into what they did, and—”

“But Chey, you weren’t.”

“But I was, Byron. I hate it, but it’s true. And if you tell them, then it makes me look . . .”

He waited, but she didn’t continue. “Look what?”

Her shoulders sagged, and she looked like she hated having to admit it to him and why couldn’t he just figure out what she meant. “Stupid, Byron. Stupid.”

“What? How do you look stupid?”

“You weren’t there, Byron. It was working out for us. It was hot.”

“Working out for us?” He winced, one eye squinting.

“You and me,” she said. “We did this thing together, and it was hot and it was fun. Yeah, it was hard, but it was . . .”

“No way, Chey,” he said, voice getting loud again. “You know what the problem is, then? You know what the problem is then if you’re totally okay with Cody inviting a surprise guest?”

She blubbered: “What?”

“That nobody fucking asked me, Chey. Nobody fucking said to me ahead of time, hey, Byron, we’re going to pop Philippe in to give Chey a thrill—you okay with that? Oh, but don’t tell her, don’t wreck the fun.”

Chey held a pouting little girl look—he wasn’t sure, but she could be mad at him right now. And that made him madder.

She said, “You’re my boss?”

“I’m not your boss, Chey. Why would you even say that? It’s about goddamn respect. Respect for my position as your husband—maybe you

want to act like a husband is some historically power position, and the wife is chattel, but that is not the fucking argument, okay? That's bullshit, and if you take that path in the argument, I'm telling you, I'll know it's one-hundred percent because you know I'm fucking right and you hate to lose and you're grasping at straws. You know I've never once in my life acted like I was your boss. Give me a break."

Chey put the pillow up to her face and hid behind it. When she put it down, he could see she was sorry. She looked down. "Could we maybe not have so much space between us?"

But he was on a roll. "My position as your husband isn't about ownership. Not one bit. That's a fucking cheap shot. My position as your husband is fraught with worry. Fraught with concern that I'm holding up my end of the bargain. That I'm keeping you happy. That I'm fulfilling my role. And you know why?—I *want* that role, Chey. I fucking auditioned, I put in the work, I hustled to get you into my life. You're not some flash in the pan, replaceable trophy thing. So yeah, I demand fucking respect."

Chey blubbered more, then knuckled her eye sockets to scrunch away the tears.

He said, "If you want to close the space between us, you know where I am."

Chey tossed the pillow to the floor and got on her knees, pausing to sniffle and wipe her cheeks. When he held his arms open and showed her the compassion he felt in his heart, she scrambled to him. Her cheek and chin crashed into the space between shoulder and chest, and his arms went around her. She curled against him. Her skinny arms snaking around him, between his body and the couch.

It felt so incredible to have her lithe body in his arms. He kissed the top of her head and breathed in her shampoo smell. "I love you, Chey," he

whispered. “I fucking love you.”

She squeezed him tight and he could feel her hot breath on his chest. She sat straighter in his arms, her face close to his. “I’m sorry, Byron. I swear I’m sorry.”

“Nothing to be sorry for, Chey.”

“Yeah, there is. Don’t try to be nice.”

“Are you really worried about me and Carla, or is that some kind of supportive act?”

“Don’t do that, Byron. You know how hard it is to tell the truth?”

“I know it’s hard. That’s the reason you’d want to mitigate it.”

“I’m not mitigating anything. I love you, Byron.” Her hands went to his cheeks, then cupped the sides of his head, slotting his ears at the webbing between her thumb and forefinger. She looked right into his eyes. “I love you so much, Byron.”

He smiled. Then she smiled. Both of them sheepish. Both of them embarrassed. Her mouth came nearer to his, and he met it halfway. They kissed slow and soft. It grew with intensity. And with that intensity came that blossoming feeling his body couldn’t fight: he was going to have sex. His cock was already hard—something he was ashamed of—and now it twitched and struggled in his shorts as his heart began to pound. Chey felt the wild arousal, too. She gasped while they kissed and their hands began to sweep over one another’s bodies and tugged at clothing.

An incredible feeling of lust and fake-betrayal and anger and love swirled through him. It got him sneering and smiling; it got his whole body alive and tingling. He got over top of her and Chey was eager to get on her back. Her nipples pushed against the fabric of her cut-off sweatshirt. He pressed

his palms against them and ground his hard-on between her legs. Chey shot a hand down and squeezed his cock through his shorts. Then while they kissed passionately, her hands shoved down his shorts and freed his cock. She jerked it and squeezed it and he pulsed lubricant into her hand. Her stroke went slippery, and she gasped with excitement. “Fuck me,” she whispered. “Fuck me, Byron.”

CHAPTER 34

B yron plunged into his wife all the way, tip to base. Cheyenne took him with lubricated ease. Their talk had aroused her. He hated that it aroused him and had kept it secret from Chey—had kept it secret from himself. Or at least had let it go unacknowledged. The aching hardness his wife's awful behavior erected was hard to decode. Everything Chey told him—all the dirty details of the last evening's playtime—were disgusting and horrid. And yet, as she'd told him, relating to him in a quiet confessional, along with the disbelief and the resentment and the indignation, something else unfurled: desire.

Of course he hated what happened. How could he suffer it? It was terrible. Ghastly. Insupportable. And yet it happened and couldn't be changed. Somehow in the wake of Chey's horrible confession, he'd rooted out a seeping scent-trail of perversion that worked for him. The idea of a woman so dark and dirty was exciting. The idea it was his wife was scandalous.

And yet, that wasn't Chey. Not the Cheyenne he knew. Not the sweet, humble, talented woman who made him a bento box every day for lunch with cute little notes and bright colorful fruit she'd scooped into animal shapes, using sesame seeds to give them adorable cartoon eyes. No, that wicked woman was Susan. Or at least she allowed randy men to call her

Susan when they fucked the shit out of her and brought their buddies in to watch.

He thrust into her and made her squawk, throwing her head back. He snatched the pillow from the floor and scooted it underneath her head, got face to face with her, humping his electric cock in and out of her. “You’re the fucking worst. You’re the fucking dirtiest little slut I ever met.” Though his words were harsh and insulting, his tone was filled with lust and a distinct measure of awe. Cheyenne had never turned him on like this before. The sexual desire he felt for his own wife rumbled open under his feet and yawned wide to swallow him whole.

Cheyenne wasn’t insulted. “I’m the worst,” she panted. “Oh my God, I’m so bad.” The word ‘bad’ was drawn out the way a whiny little brat would. Cheyenne was in heat. Cheyenne was out of control. His ball sack tightened to a wrinkled pouch and his balls lurched up into his body with a newfound excitement. His eyes stretched wide, taking in Cheyenne like he’d never seen her before. Her pretty face contorted with base pleasure, her eyes open and searching, not closed and hiding. She was testing him. Seeing if her husband could handle the woman who hid behind those big blues. Seeing if Byron could handle a ride on the Susan train.

She fucked him back as hard as he fucked her. Her hips crashed into his and her legs scissored against his sides. Her lean little body bucked against his, humped and ground her pussy into his hard cock. It was his wife unleashed.

He grabbed behind one of her knees and shoved the leg up. “Did you suck his big cock?”

“Oh, I did, baby, I sucked it.”

“You fucking liked it?” A tension ballooned somewhere behind his tightened sack. The mechanisms for ejaculation had been engaged.

“Mm, I loved sucking his cock.”

“Was it everything you wished?”

“I wanted him to come in my mouth,” she said and pouted a surly, childish, down-turned mouth.

“That hot cowboy came in your mouth. He came inside you. He came inside my wife.”

“He came inside me, baby,” she said, scratching her nails on his chest.

“He put his bare cock inside my beautiful wife. She took his condom off.”

“I wanted it bareback, baby. I wanted it for real.”

Now she made eye contact with him and he thought his heart might burst. What the fuck had gotten into her? She made a mewling sound of pleasure—a sound like a cat in heat, he thought. Like she was so close to coming and she just couldn’t reach it yet, but wanted it *desperately*.

“And Philippe watched you. Watched you get fucked.”

“He watched me get fucked, baby. He watched it up close.” Chey’s hands scrabbled from his front to his back. Her nails ran down his back and sank into the globes of his clenched buttocks. She gripped ahold of his ass and held him in place, his cock buried inside her as far as it would go. Chey swirled and humped and rubbed her clit against his pubic bone. Those little squeaks and mewls built in intensity. She was using his cock to get off. He watched her face as she chased down an orgasm.

He growled, “Philippe jerked off to your little pussy.”

Chey frowned and squealed, eyes closing tight. She was going to come.

“Oh, yeah, oh yeah,” she panted.

“He blew his load fantasizing about shoving his enormous cock inside you.”

That did it. Her mouth opened into an O shape and she stiffened and drew in a long whisking inhale. Her pussy clamped on his cock and the tickle that brought triggered his own orgasm.

“He came on his own chest,” he growled.

“He came, oh, he came all over his hairy chest,” she babbled in a long, breathy string as she orgasmed.

“Did he blow a big load?”

“So much, mm, so much come,” she said, voice squeezed shut.

“Fuck,” Byron growled and pulled out, eager to show his wife his own load. He scooted to his knees, and Chey looked around, bewildered. She saw his hand shuffling wildly on his cock and she gasped with dirty surprise. She stuffed her arms down at her sides, tucked her hands under his legs, and grabbed his ass. Her down-stretched arms squashed her breasts together. Never once did he and Chey have dirty sex. They had great sex, but the veneer of respect was never tarnished. Now he straddled her, jerking his cock off onto her pressed together tits, while they replayed the dirtiest parts of her tryst with a friend’s husband—while another man watched.

The blast of his orgasm came like a pressure valve’s destruction. The pressure blew like a thunderclap and wild and slippery pleasure swirled around the end of his cock as he shot stream after stream onto the woman he loved, showing her how dirty he could be. And in a way, it was like popping a champagne cork in celebration of the discovery of his wife’s badness. If anything sanctified Cheyenne’s illicit behavior last night, it was the celebratory release he showered her breasts and face with. And she accepted him, accepted his seed with glee and joy, smiling, averting her

face from the patter of his wet impacts, but soon surrendering to it and letting it paint her perfect features.

* * *

They lay together in the afterglow of magnificent, wonderful, golden sex. Close, intimate and loving. Face to face, naked bodies touching. She ran the pad of her finger along her husband's luscious lower lip. This man could have condemned her. Could have cast her out of their house. Sure, they'd both engaged in the same extra-marital act of experimental swinger sex, but it would be crazy to dismiss how much darker her session with Cody had gone.

Byron had cleaned her face with his workout shirt, then put it down below them. When his cold semen touched the back of her leg, she made a grossed out sound and they both laughed. The messy shirt was escorted to the floor. Cool light from the outside pooled in the quiet of the lounge outside the yacht's gym. It was just the two of them, and although she'd had sex with Cody last night, she'd never felt closer to the man she loved.

"Quit it, it tickles," Byron said at last and pulled his face away, rubbing at his lower lip. She hugged him tight and kissed his chest. He hugged her in return and kissed the top of her head the way she loved.

Byron pulled away so they could look at each other. "You didn't want to kiss Cody?"

She shook her head. "Did you kiss Carla?" Her stomach tightened at the expectation of an answer.

"I did," he admitted.

She ruffled his hair, pretending she was okay with that. “And I bet you played with her tits.”

“I did,” Byron admitted and though it hurt her feelings, what the hell could she complain about?

“Carla’s got some pretty amazing tits,” she said. Byron looked at her blankly. She realized the position it put him in. “You don’t have to say anything, Byron. I know you like her tits. They’re big. They’re perfect.” Somehow saying it out loud in front of Byron made it not so aggravating that her husband had been in bed with a woman with D cups last night. A woman with D cups who intimidated her.

Byron smiled like he enjoyed watching her pretend not to squirm. She said, “Did you titty-fuck her?” She used a husky male voice to remove herself from the question—like she was joking, but she wanted to know.

Byron frowned and cocked his head. “Why would you ask me that?”

She frowned back. “Why wouldn’t I?”

Byron raised his eyebrows. “Oh, I wondered— That was exactly what Sully asked me this morning.”

“Oh great. So you told him.”

“He already knew, Chey. You talked to Scarlet.”

“No, I mean, you told him you put your stupid dick between Carla’s breasts.” Shit, she’d thought she had a handle on this.

“I did tell him that. But I didn’t *do* that.”

“You didn’t?”

The brief moment of relief was dashed, reading Byron's hesitant expression.

She said, "Oh, you didn't, but you still want to?"

Byron smiled at a sheepish slant and looked away.

"Whatever," she said with comical resignation.

Byron said, "Do you think we should? Do this again, I mean."

She ran her fingers through his thick hair, scratching his scalp and looking into his warm eyes. "I want to. You want to. We need to talk beforehand. No going half-cocked—"

"Or double-cocked in your case," he muttered.

She smacked his cheek, four quick beats, and he laughed. She flicked his lip.

Byron said, "Okay. We need to talk. Let's set some rules that we can both abide."

An uneasiness settled low in her stomach. A desire and a fear intermingling. Byron saw her discomfort and called her on it. "What is it?"

She saw herself telling him, then chickened out. "Nothing."

"It's not nothing. Tell me. Come on, we're supposed to do this right, remember?"

She sighed and looked high up. "Oh boy," she whispered. Byron kissed her neck.

"Tell me, Chey."

"You know what might work for us?"

“What?”

“Since we’re doing this together and we’re finding our sea legs?”

“What?”

She took a deep breath, held it. She said, “I want—”

“Oh no.”

“Don’t say oh no, Byron, come on.”

“Oh boy,” Byron groaned and hid his face away in both hands.

She pried the hands open. “You don’t even know what I was going to say.”

“Yes, I do, yes, I do, yes, I do,” he said, putting on an act, being youthful and funny and pretending he was running away from bad news, or a dirty dog trying to outsmart its master when it was bath time. He struggled away, and she hooked arms and one leg around him. He tickled her, and she yelped and let him go. Byron bounced off the couch and jumped, both fists pumped overhead in victory. Then he shouted with surprise and covered up his cock.

He went to his knees and buried his face in the couch cushions.

She said, “What?”

Byron groaned.

She sat up and looked over the back of the couch. Carla sat by herself at the dining room table. She had a tea cup and an orange on a plate. She’d peeled the orange and pulled apart the wedges. She pushed one of the orange wedges past her lips, looked over at Chey, and smiled with a full mouth.

“Fuck,” Chey hissed and hunkered down with Byron again.

Byron was sitting on the floor and pulling his shorts on. “How long has she been sitting there?”

From the other side of the couch, Carla said, “Long enough to know Cheyenne wants you to watch her with Cody.”

CHAPTER 35

As Cheyenne shimmied her bottoms on, hunkered out of view, Byron stood up and said, “You think it’s funny, sitting and listening to us having sex?”

“Irony, really,” she heard Carla say, “considering it’s you who’s supposed to be the audience member.”

Byron scoffed and sat down at the foot of the couch, sitting in just his gym shorts.

Carla said, “You ever think of using your bedroom? I mean, you’re chastising me for sitting in a public space here. I should be the one delivering admonishments, if you ask me.”

“She fucking sat there the whole time,” he muttered to Cheyenne as she got her sweatshirt pulled on. Byron reached and grabbed his T-shirt from the floor, holding it between his knees.

Chey glanced over to see Carla sitting at the table, one cheek puffed out with the last of the orange, wiping her hands on a paper napkin. Her mind raced to think of anything Carla might have overheard and anything disparaging she might have said about her or that Byron might have said about Cody. There wasn’t anything she could recall, but she knew her secret

had been overheard. If Carla knew, then Cody would know. And Philippe probably too. Well, so what? So what if they knew. In fact, maybe if they knew, they'd make it happen, they'd align Byron for her. It was almost assured that Cody would be up for Byron sitting in with them. But wouldn't that mean Carla would be there too? And wouldn't that mean she'd have to see Carla's hands on Byron? The thought angered her.

Byron popped up and spun, then looked surprised not seeing Carla where she had been. Carla had left the dining room and had come beside the couch, heading to the cushioned chair, kitty corner to their couch. Byron said, "You don't make any noise at all, do you?"

Carla chuckled and plopped down on the chair, crossing her legs. "I think you know that's not the case, Mr. Bishop."

"Hey," Cheyenne said, brow dropping down low and feeling possessive of her husband.

Carla flipped up her palms in surrender. "Oh hey, Chey, sorry. Just joking around. My bad."

"Don't say shit like that," Cheyenne said, folded her arms and crossed one leg over the other.

Byron looked from Chey to Carla. "Where's Cody? You hear what he did?"

Carla nodded, eyebrows raised in a look of dismay. "I heard. You mean the thing, right?"

Carla darted a glance to Chey and Chey made an irritated sound in her throat. "Of course I told him."

"Oh great," Byron said. "So you might not tell me? You'd let Cody and Chey keep secrets from me? I don't like the way that works, Carla."

“All right, already, jeez,” Carla complained, looking straight up at the ceiling. “The Philippe thing. All right, Byron? The Philippe thing. And, no, I wouldn’t tell you a thing. That’s up to Cheyenne. But that’s why I’m here. I was all around the ship with tea for two and an orange to split and I couldn’t find her anywhere. I think she and I should have a talk.”

“Yeah, well, I need to talk to Cody.”

“Yes, you should. He deserves to hear it.”

“Oh, you think so,” Byron said defiantly, as though Carla had objected. But Byron was used to Carla’s sarcasm and didn’t hear the answer the way Chey heard it.

“He’s out on the swimming deck. Go tell him off. I did. He broke a rule. I’m on your side, Byron,” Carla said, giving Byron a steady eye. “Yours, too, Chey,” she added, peeping around Byron to look at Cheyenne. Then: “Thank god you were cool with it.”

Chey’s mouth crimped to one side and she looked to Byron, waiting for him to blow up her scene and launch into a tirade how she thought it was him coming in and how Cody tricked her—which wasn’t true. She got something unexpected, but no one took advantage of her.

Byron said, “Look, I don’t need step-by-step permission or anything. I’m not Cheyenne’s boss. You don’t have to check in on every little detail. But bringing in another guy? That sure ain’t a minor detail. That’s the exact kind of thing you have to run by me first.”

“I agree, Byron,” Carla said soothingly. “In Cody’s defense, he said to me there was no *way* he’d let Philippe touch Cheyenne, even if Cheyenne begged for it. It was a little exhibition play, a little examination and humiliation. Cody figured it would wind Cheyenne’s crank. But, he was

adamant: there was to be absolutely *no* three-way play. Now that, he says, he would never do. Not without giving you a head's up."

"You make it sound like a minor mix-up," Byron said.

"You have every right to be mad, Byron. Go find Cody, and I implore you"—she lay a hand over her heart—"tell him how you feel. Tell him why you're mad. He needs to hear it. This was your guys' first time and Cody went way too hard."

"I am going to confront him," Byron said.

"Good," Carla said, eyeing him up and down. "Go get him. Put your baby-batter shirt on and find him down on the swim deck. I need to talk to Cheyenne alone, anyway."

Byron fuffed the semen-soaked shirt toward Carla like he would toss it in her face and Carla yelped and put up a hand to block it. But Byron held on to it and hiked a right. He came around the back of the couch and leaned over it, his face near hers. He said, "You okay here?"

"Yeah," Chey whispered, looking up at him. Byron was looking good in the light and she had warm after-sex feels for him. She held his wrist and put a kiss up where she would tempt him. Byron put his lips to hers and they held the kiss a long while. It felt good to display their togetherness to Carla.

Byron walked off, topless, his slender back showing some muscle and the beginning of summer sun. Carla said after him, "Go throw that shirt in Cody's face, if you're so mad about it."

"Maybe I will," Byron said, voice growing thin as he passed from the lounge, going around the glass-walled elevator shaft and heading out to the back that overlooked the swimming deck.

Carla chuckled and said, "Cody'll fucking kill him if he does."

Cheyenne said, “Why do you have to be so nasty about all of this?”

Carla looked honestly shocked, touching the fingers of one hand to her chest, not saying anything but her expression as if she were saying in French, “Moi?”

“Byron’s not going to fight Cody. Why would you say that?”

“I know they’re not going to fight, Cheyenne. I’m just joking around.”

“Not everything’s funny, Carla. We’re both a little touchy after last night.”

“Of course you are,” Carla said in a smooth conciliatory tone, all full of understanding. Then she sighed and looked around the room, gathering her thoughts. Cheyenne got the impression Carla was re-evaluating her tact, given she wasn’t winning any friends here in this lounge. Carla was a woman who wanted things and found ways to get them. Not necessarily a manipulator, not a Machiavelli, but definitely a natural-born student of policy-as-provocation and other *Mirrors Of Princes*. Carla considered herself above it all, a maestro of pleasures and possibilities where rules were for the common folk and she pretended to play by them only so she could bend them to shape her life the way she desired. She rose from the chair and padded across to join Cheyenne on the couch. She didn’t sit close, not side by side, but quarter-facing and a foot apart. “Let me hear it, Chey. I know you’re mad at me, so let it out. I only want the best from this situation. Not for me, but for all of us. Tell me what I did wrong.”

Chey eyed Carla’s sly face—the knowing arch to a brow, one eye covered by her shaggy crop of silvery blonde hair, and the sagely angle to her smirk—and sought to decipher what Carla wanted from her. She wasn’t even mad at Carla. Who the hell was she mad at?

Carla said, “If you weren’t jealous, I’d think something was wrong with you. Or wrong with your marriage to Byron.”

“So, I’m jealous,” she said sullenly and shrugged.

“Work it out with me, Chey,” Carla said and leaned a little closer, looking sincere. “I know I’m a prickly pear, but we’ve been friends long enough to know I’m not out to hurt anybody. Talk to me. What you went through last night, I’ve done it myself. There was a first night where Cody was with another woman. Thank god switchblades are illegal, you know what I mean? All I was armed with were eye daggers. The good news is the eye-daggers you’re sending me aren’t poisoned. There’s hope, right?” She flicked a manicured forefinger, arm draped on the couch back, to tap Chey’s shoulder.

“Yeah,” Chey said, Carla’s nail giving her the goosebumps and getting her shivering. She scooted sideways so they faced. “There’s hope. I had a great time last night—”

“Cody told me.”

“It was good. It was a lot and I went further than I ever anticipated.”

“The hard part is your own jealousy. Work it out with me. Tell me what’s a no-go. Tell me what is verboten.”

“I don’t even know. It’s not any act that gets me riled, it’s the *sharing* itself.”

“But you had such a good time with Cody. Aren’t you worried Byron’ll think you’re selfish?”

“Oh, I’m totally selfish,” she said flatly and unabashedly, and when Carla chuckled at that she joined in. “I need to get over it.”

Carla said, “Perfect. What you told Byron you wanted . . .? That’s the way to get over it.”

Chey scoffed. “Make him watch me?”

“Mm. Let me tell you a little something about your husband. Not that I know him better than you do, just that I’ve seen couples like you before. I have a little experience. Byron was so skittish last night. All he could talk about was you. You were the only thing on his mind. I’m not insulted. But when I mentioned him joining in and watching you, you should have seen the resistant little dance he did.”

“I know. He hates to even hear about it.”

Carla shook her head, lips thinned.

“No?”

“Surface level? Yeah. He hates it because he thinks he should hate it. Byron wants to watch you. You’re going to have to beg him and make him feel like it’s all your idea and he’s doing it for your benefit—but he wants to do it, Chey. Trust me.”

“Do you ever watch Cody?”

Carla smiled, even showing it in her eyes. “I *love* watching Cody with another woman.”

“I could never watch Byron.”

“Sure you could.”

“No way,” Chey laughed nervously.

“Think about it, Chey. Think about it.”

Her brow lowered as she contemplated it, savvy Carla putting something awful in her mind, challenging her to accept it. She could picture Byron

with some nameless, faceless girl. He's on top and all she can see is the other girl's legs hooked around her Byron's hips. "Oh no way," she said.

"You love him don't you?"

"Yeah," she said indignantly, offended that love was measured in your ability to endure something awful.

"Hey, okay," Carla said, showing her palms again. "Another my bad. I'm only offering help. Offering fun. Oh, hey, I know . . ."

"Know what?"

"How about this? Don't picture Byron with me, picture him—"

"I wasn't picturing him with you."

Carla got real close and held Chey's wrist. "Picture him with someone you trust completely. Picture him with someone you really love."

"Like who?"

"Picture him with your good buddy. Picture him with someone kind. Picture him with Scarlet."

CHAPTER 36

From the hand railing above the swimming deck, Byron peered down to see Cody and Philippe hanging out in the sunshine, having a good time. Cody's back was to him, but Philippe leaned the small of his back on the railing, smiling at whatever Cody was telling him. Philippe's eyes trailed up to see Byron watching and the smile waned. He gave Byron a good morning nod and then made a face to Cody, nudging his chin up to Byron. Cody turned, shielded his eyes from the sun, saw Byron, and said, "Morning." They all knew it was time to talk.

Only thing was, Byron didn't want to face Cody and Philippe one-on-two. He'd rather talk to them individually. But this was the way he found them and there was no time to be squeamish. Plus, two birds with one stone and all that. At least he'd only have to go through this once.

Cody said, "Hey Byron, stay there, we're going to come up."

Byron nodded, grim-faced, then assumed a spot on one of the loungers. Then changed his mind, not wanting to be too horizontal—that wasn't a power position. Instead he got up and took a spot that had him sitting upright, his back to the view. The sun was in his face a little but it was better than to be seen taking it easy while you were chastising two guys who were bigger than you. From this angle he could see into the yacht's

third floor cabin, Chey engaged with Carla somewhere beyond. Cody and Philippe appeared, the two of them mounting the steps then coming around through the lounge to join him out in the sunshine.

Already, Cody's expression had contorted to a look of apology. There was no doubt they both knew what the conversation was to be. It would cut down on introductions. Philippe sat on the lounge on the left, and Cody the one on the right. Not reclining on them, but sitting on the footrests, elbows on knees, leaning towards Byron.

Cody put up a hand to pause anything Byron might want to say. "Before you start, man, right away—I'm a let you go off on us—but I gotta say first, for *me*"—touching five fingers to his chest—"I fucked up, Byron. I fucked up big time. But, look, it wasn't malice, it was carelessness. It slipped my mind how this was your guys' first time."

Philippe was right on Cody's heels: "Me too, Byron. It was really uncool to not throw you a signal, let you know Chey wanted that."

Byron scowled a dubious expression at Philippe. "Don't try to tell me she asked for that."

Philippe was now the one contorting into apology. "Oh man, no, I didn't mean she asked for that. Cody just thought—"

"It was like spur of the moment, Byron. I know it looks like we shit on your chest here. I'm trying to think of the best way to convince you— Look, I forgot about you. I admit it. You matter, man, you totally matter. For real. But, Cheyenne, was like—" Cody puffed out his cheeks as he struggled to explain himself.

Byron said, "You guys usually disparage a guy's wife when you apologize? Sounds like you want to blame Chey for your fuck up."

Cody showed a pained expression, then sagged. He rubbed the bridge of his nose. Byron studied the guy's good-looking masculine hand—then thought how it had smoothed itself all over Cheyenne's naked flesh last night and how two—maybe even three—of those fingers had gone inside her. A sudden surge between his legs got him gulping in a hiss of air and raising his eyebrows. What an awful fucking thought.

Cody said, "You're right, man. That's how it sounds." He looked up now, lowering his hands, clapping them together between his knees and locking fingers. Now when he spoke, he moved the clasped hands up and down for emphasis, pleading with Byron. "I'm terrible at this, I guess. What I mean is, I was tuned into Cheyenne and—"

"And she was just so hog-wild, you took her for a swapping veteran?"

Cody winced. "Man, you're really mad."

"Of course I'm mad, Cody. I did what was expected of me with Carla. And what the fuck did you do?" In his periphery, Philippe grimaced, a conciliatory suggestion that Cody had indeed done terrible things to Cheyenne. Byron continued: "You brought in a stranger. Not to me, I know Philippe, but I had no idea he would know what was going on. So not only did you break my trust, you exposed what Chey and I were doing—a really private fucking thing—to someone else that I never agreed to." Then to Philippe, he said, "No offense."

Cody pinched his nose again. "Fuck, you're right."

Philippe said, "Me knowing is like *no one* knowing, Byron, cross my heart." He drew an x on his chest with the point of a big index finger.

To Philippe, he said, "But that's up to me to decide, wouldn't you agree?"

"A hundred percent," Philippe said.

“So how does it happen? How do you do something so wrong?”

Cody saw there was no excuse, no explanation Byron was looking for. Byron only looked for one thing. Cody said, “You’re right, Byron. I fucked up big time. Carla let me have it this morning. I know I’m an idiot. Dude, I am sorry. That fuck up is all on me.” He rested his hand over his heart and nodded once, solemnly, his eyes meeting Byron’s. The sunlight kicked up a sparkling Caribbean blue in Cody’s eyes, and the sudden revelation of deep and beautiful color hit Byron in the gut. Cody was kind of beautiful, for a man, and for sure he turned Cheyenne on.

There was an awkward expanse of silence for a long moment, and Philippe broke it. “Normally, Byron, you can totally trust Cody with this kind of thing. I swear it. He fucked up.”

Byron’s head swiveled toward Philippe. “And what about you?”

“I should have known better.” He exhaled and looked at the floor between them, eyebrows tented like he was forlorn. “Truth was, Cody texted me and I was so fucking excited, I jumped out of bed.”

“No time to think.”

Philippe looked up. “Honestly, no.”

“Any chance to get a look at Cheyenne, you were going to take it.”

“Pretty much.”

Something about that tightened Byron’s stomach and made him uneasy. “Have you guys talked about Cheyenne before? I mean about luring her into this?”

Cody and Philippe exchanged uncomfortable looks and each made a funny croaking sound in their throat—both of them obviously wanting to answer

in the affirmative but unwilling to commit to it.

“Really? You fucking lusted after my wife for years?”

They both looked caught and guilty and looking for his understanding.

“How come it took you so long to make a move?”

Cody said, “Carla *does* have a crush on you, dude—”

“Oh shit. I didn’t even think of that,” Byron said, palming his forehead.

“Like I was an afterthought. That this was all about getting Cheyenne into bed with you two.”

“Hey, not *me*,” Philippe said. “I’m only guilty of thinking Cheyenne is hot. This was Cody’s idea. Not a me and Cody idea.”

“For real, Byron,” Cody said. “We’re not some sex cult or something. I really, really like Chey, and Carla really, really likes you. Philippe ended up in the room last night only for Chey’s sake. This is what I’m saying: I wasn’t trying to include Philippe—though buddy here is in a long ass dry spell—I was playing along with Chey. I tried to rope you, you know, sending you a photo of her sucking my, you know, but she wasn’t into it—”

“Not yet, at least,” Philippe said.

Cody said, “Yeah. It’s her thing. I mean it. She’s a little reluctant. I tried bringing you in. Chey’s an exhibitionist, Byron, I swear. It’s her fantasy.”

Byron’s fingers tingled with cold. There was a great fear that Cody wasn’t bullshitting, that Cody was right. Chey had sexual desires she’d never have discovered and enjoyed if left to Byron. He never would have lured this sex demon inside his wife to the surface. She’d have been happy without it, but was happier with it. Or at least more satisfied.

“I thought she’d be cool with Philippe because she hung out with us all day. She’s a good sport, you know, tossing the ball with us, swimming and all that. Plus, you know, she went dipping with us—no suits, right? So I figured maybe she’d be cool with Philippe rather than you—to begin with.”

“And Cheyenne responded,” Byron muttered.

Both guys grumbled with lecherous affirmation. That charged Byron up even more. Two men who’d been with her last night acknowledging how hot his wife is and how horny she was. Paired with all the things Cheyenne had told him about what happened, his cock hardened painfully, and he squashed his thighs together on it. All of a sudden he had a strange urge to do it all over again. To get to tonight as fast as possible and maybe all five of them could get together in a room and they’d have a wild orgy and he’d get his cock sucked by Carla and he’d watch Cody pound the shit out of Chey while she bawled sexual nonsense and Philippe watched them all, stroking his monster cock.

Byron exhaled, squeezed his thighs tighter against his throbbing erection and swallowed, dry and hesitant. “Yeah, she told me what happened.”

Philippe said, “Told you what?” His tone was dull and clipped, showing no inflection. They didn’t want to rat Chey out by accident, not spilling all the beans just because Byron told him he knew what the beans were.

Byron regarded them. “You’d cover up for her?”

Cody said, “We’re just being considerate.”

Byron sat back, thighs still clamped on his cock so they wouldn’t see it. “I don’t like that.”

Cody and Philippe exchanged looks again, their eyes darting over one another’s trying to communicate without words. Cody leaned forward,

hands clasped again, head bowed. Then he looked up. “I fucked her while Philippe watched.”

God, his cock just about sprang up with the excitement of hearing his wife referred to as a function. He said to Philippe, “And what about you?”

Philippe looked up, like he was embarrassed. “Well, I watched.”

“Just watched?”

Philippe’s eyes darted from side to side. “More than watched.”

“Did you join in?”

Philippe jolted. “What? *No*. Did she say—”

“Easy,” Byron said. “No, she didn’t say that. She told me what you did.”

Philippe eased. “Okay,” he said, satisfied.

But the talk excited Byron and he couldn’t shut up. “Cheyenne watched you do it?”

Philippe nodded. Both Philippe and Cody had looks on their faces that probably mimicked his own. All three guys turned on by Cheyenne. Cheyenne Bishop. Byron’s wife.

An urge to find his sweet little woman tugged at him. Find her, grab her hand and march her into their estate room. Fuck her again. And again. Fuck her all day long. It had been years since they had a day like that. Maybe they hadn’t even had *one* day like that since they were married.

He faced Cody. “What happened to the condom?”

Cody bit his lower lip, then slowly let it plop out. “Sorry, dude. Cheyenne took it off me. I didn’t stop her.”

“I didn’t either,” Philippe said. “But I didn’t know it was a rule.”

“It wasn’t,” Cody said. “We just used them. I brought them but Cheyenne didn’t make me. Was that a hard rule, Byron?”

Byron sighed heavily and rubbed his eyes and his cheeks like he was using soap and water, though his hands were cold and dry as a bone. He ruffled his own hair, stretched back so far in his chair he could look straight up at the sky. His cock ached and was as hard an iron bar. He could strike it on the hand-railing and it would ping out like metal on metal. His balls rolled around in his sack and he could feel himself leaking pre-come. He thought of sunset and Carla and Carla’s mouth and, oh God yes, putting this iron bar between her milky jugs and ejaculating on her face. But foremost on his mind was Cheyenne. Watching the things Cheyenne wanted to show him.

He leaned forward and regarded both his friends. “Rules are made to be broken,” he said soberly.

CHAPTER 37

Nine people, forty minutes past noon, on a hundred-foot luxury yacht on bobbing black water somewhere near Watermelon Cay, off the coast of Saint John. Four married couples, making eight people, plus one man, newly divorced. A total of nine, all sitting on loungers in the sun, nobody saying anything. The sun beat down on them, a perfect dry and scorching hot blue-sky cloudless day. Music they listened to in college played from a speaker inside the yacht's second floor lounge.

Scarlet side-eyed Cheyenne. Chey had never finished her story. At least not to Scarlet's satisfaction. Philippe had interrupted them. One thing for sure was that Cheyenne's story of debauchery had pre-heated Scarlet's oven. That effect was unexpected. When Sully had delivered the unbelievable findings of his late-night bathroom safari, the first emotions were of course bewilderment, but also hilarity and disbelief. Not that Carla and Cody were swingers, but that they'd roped in her good buddy Cheyenne. Sweet and innocent Cheyenne, roped in by her well-hung, muscular cowboy. But since Chey had divulged some of the more nefarious activities she'd engaged in with Cody, Scarlet's consideration of Cheyenne's adventures in swinging aroused something inside her that purred low in her belly, a feline rumble that vibrated in the weirdest way against her intimate spaces. Sully had been off fishing again from the front deck on the third floor. If he hadn't been,

he'd have been dragged into their estate room and she would have shagged him rotten. Instead, she'd been left chatting with Philippe. And Philippe made matters worse. The way he'd studied her made her feel like Chey did when Chey had been out horsing around naked with Cody in the lake. The terrible things her saintly friend had done! Imagine innocent Cheyenne horsing with Cody, putting her hands on him and grabbing a handful of balls—and not letting go.

She twitched and rubbed her nose, feeling that pre-heated oven begin to steam like someone had inched it open to keek what was cooking.

And what the hell *was* cooking, Scarlet?

Nothing. Nothing at all. Right?

She uncrossed her legs, crossed them the opposite way, flexing her thighs. Now she side-eyed Byron. Byron stared holes out to the horizon—but not taking in the view. It looked like his eyes were unseeing and instead what Byron watched was a movie playing in his mind's eye. And what was he watching that made his jaw muscles flex like that, made his brow drop down low to a scowl? Was it the things he had done with Carla? Or was it the things he knew Cody had done to his sweet Cheyenne?

* * *

All Byron could think was how Cody had spent one night with his wife and had uncovered things about her sexuality that he himself would maybe never have discovered, even with a map and a GPS and headlamp and a flashlight and half a mile of spelunking ropes. Cody had figured out Cheyenne in an hour, like he was a master locksmith. Or perhaps a cat burglar lusting after a hundred-million-dollar pink diamond. Or more like a heist, really. Cody's plans were long and involved and the man had lusted

after this particular pink diamond—owned by another man—for quite a long time. How much preliminary work had gone into Cody’s master plan? For how long had last night’s actions been in planning? The more Byron thought of it, the less it seemed like it was a spur of the moment transaction. The more he thought of it, the more he considered the entire trip on this yacht was meant for Cody’s *Cheyenne* satisfaction. And if that were the case, then Cody surely wouldn’t stop pursuing Cheyenne. The trip had only just begun. They weren’t even on their third day. How many more times would Cody fuck Cheyenne on this vacation?

Cody had them arranged together on this yacht for weeks. Alone and secluded. The yacht’s staff nearby on a houseboat. No wait staff, no chefs. Nine people on board. No outsiders. All insiders. No one to watch them. No one to judge them.

Byron side-eyed Carla. Carla was unreadable behind her black sunglasses. But those pouting lips were so succulent and alluring. The point of her chin, the sharp angle of her jaw, and the sly sweep of her sharp intelligent brows—then everything below that lost the hard angles, everything below the neck was pillowy soft and fucking feminine and perfect. The overflowing breasts that the bikini top struggled to contain, the narrow waist swooping to the wide hips. The trade-off for donating his wife to another man’s desires was that he could do anything he wanted to that perfect female creature. And that female creature wasn’t some virginal doe-eyed innocent—oh no sir, that woman was sex personified. In his heart he knew Carla had a million dirty tricks to make him come. She hadn’t even shown him one of them last night. And that was probably Cody’s plan, too.

Don’t give it to him all at once, Carla baby. Keep that boy coming to feed from your hand, day after day. Don’t wear him out. Keep him happy, but keep him hungry.

A hungry man is easier to control.

* * *

Who ever would have thought Byron would ever do something as wild as having sex with Carla fucking Weber? Not Sully, that's for sure. Never in a million years would he have ever suspected something like that could ever happen. How the hell had Scarlet sussed it out? He thought *he* had a dirty mind. What if his wife had an even dirtier mind? God, the sex they'd had last night just after the revelation of Cheyenne and Byron swinging with Cody and Carla was a dozen times wilder than a normal night for them. Than a good night for them.

Though the prospect was impossible, he still couldn't shake a distinct jealousy that Byron was the one who got summoned to Carla's bedroom. That Byron was the one who got to titty-fuck that hot ass woman.

But if Cody ever thought Sully would let him get anywhere near Scarlet with that big dick, he was crazy. He wouldn't trade in Scarlet's virtue for a shag with Carla. The price of admission was too steep for him to afford.

Not that Scarlet was a virgin when he met her. That was not the case at all. Fuck, she'd been dating another guy when he met her. She'd broken up with that guy and since she was keeping it casual with Sully, she'd even dated *another* guy at the same time. At least in the early weeks, before they committed to each other, before they fell in love. There was a distinct heartache that, as a man, he'd pushed down into his core back then when he'd get this flashing errant thought that this girl he was kind of falling for big-time was out on a date with another guy. Like, what if she slept with that guy tonight, he'd worry. What if they were fucking? What if her phone calls and texts grew farther and farther apart as this other dude started to set his Scarlet's insides on fire. He'd worried how it would end. Would she just

stop responding to his texts? Is that how it would happen? Or would she sit him down, do the honorable thing, tell him that things with—what was that guy's name? Something Italian, he thought, like maybe Vince—Vince were progressing and she didn't want to waste Sullivan's time anymore. The worry was so palpable that even now, years removed and married to Scarlet, his heart tightened in his chest and his throat constricted. He laughed to himself and rapped his fist in light taps over his breastbone. He leaned aside to smile at his wife.

Scarlet wasn't looking his way. His wife was looking aside. She had her big paperback lying face down on her stomach and she looked to the left. Not out to the view, but over beyond Cheyenne to Philippe. Was Philippe just looking Scarlet's way?

* * *

What Cheyenne couldn't escape was the lusty thought of Cody's mouth on her. Not kissing her—because that didn't seem right—but the way his lips had grazed on her collar, had plucked at her nipples, had ravaged her pussy and suckled her sweetest flesh. Even sitting in the lounge, mouth shut, hiding behind sunglasses, with her friends but in her own little dirty world, her nipples tightened and bulged out the fabric of her swimsuit. She folded her arms to cover them before anyone noticed.

Carla and Cody were game. Carla and Cody were interested in trying out another nighttime session. Her heart raced at the thought. Her mind raced at what would transpire between now and nightfall. How the hell was she supposed to get through the day with the night—a night like last night—on her mind?

What, eight more hours? Nine? How was she supposed to pass the time? The worst thing she could do was sit and sun on a lounge like this, because

the peace and quiet let her mind obsess over things it shouldn't.

* * *

Scarlet stood, and Byron watched her, eyes tracking his wife's best friend as she passed everyone laying on the loungers and put her hands on the railing, looking out at the water. The wind lifted her crimson hair and exposed her long neck. There was something in the way she stood that attracted his attention and he couldn't quite figure out why. Scarlet was beautiful—but since she was also his wife's best friend, he never considered her that way. And he still didn't. What was it?

It hit him.

The way Scarlet tilted her head, the way one hip shot out and lifted one of her butt cheeks, the way she spread her arms wide on the railing, showing off how long-limbed and lean she was—she was trying to appear attractive. Not something he'd ever seen her do before. Why would he? She was married to Sullivan and if she ever got the hots for some other guy, he was pretty sure he wasn't her type.

Byron looked left then right. Yup. Cody noticed. So did Philippe. And her husband also noticed. Sully's face turned up to regard the woman he was married to. There was something in his expression that was more than a happy husband regarding his beautiful wife, there was something lurking behind his eyes the way a frightened fish at the aquarium might sequester in some coral structure. What was it? Byron could swear there was a measure of worry there. That's what it was. The more he thought of it, the more he became convinced that Sully regarded his wife with a green tinge of angst. Poor old Sully. Old Sullivan—he of the quick quip: did you titty fuck her?—had been thinking of what Byron said to him out on the deck today. How Sully had come to him wanting to know the dirty details and then had

departed that conversation with a simple statement. He'd said he couldn't trade a night with Carla Weber for Cody Weber to take a tour around his wife's body. The guy had probably been thinking about it all morning. Worried about it. Scarlet knew they were swingers now too—had predicted it—and Sully must wonder if his wife wondered *what if?* . . . It tickled Byron and he couldn't wait till he had a few beers in his belly and he would launch an afternoon campaign of putting bad thoughts into his friend's head. He couldn't wait.

Sullivan's eyebrows raised and the look of worry intensified.

Byron tracked Sullivan's gaze to Scarlet, who'd moved away from the railing toward the bottoms of the loungers where everyone could see her.

* * *

With everyone looking up at her, Scarlet's heart began to race. Everyone with meek expressions of question. *What's Scarlet doing?*

She took a steadying breath and smiled.

"It's an awesome day out there," she said. "What are we all doing laying around like this—who wants to go swimming?"

Mild interest showed on all their faces. Byron watched her, eyebrows raising above his sunglasses. Chey looked concerned. Carla looked unperturbed. Cody and Philippe showed curiosity. Arlo and Lily looked like they wouldn't mind taking a dip, showing pleasant expressions. Sully looked frozen. Frozen as if he'd been lurking Medusa's chamber and come face to face with the gorgon. This is what Sully would look like cast in stone with a look of horrific realization. *What was he so worried about?*

She finger-plucked away one shoulder strap of her sporty one-piece swimsuit and said, “Anyone who wants to join me is welcome,” and let the strap fall down her arm.

Byron looked to Sully, but Sully had turned to stone, eyes on her, face solemn but eyes wide in anticipation. Chey looked perplexed. Philippe smirked.

She turned away from them all, showed them her backside, shrugged one arm out of her swimsuit, then the other. Then she began to shimmy the stretchy swimsuit down her see-sawing hips.

* * *

Sullivan’s heart galloped in his chest in a way he’d never felt. In the first two years of college he’d played a little ball and right now his heart hammered in his chest like he’d gone four court lengths with no one sinking a basket. His neck swelled with sudden pulse-force. His eyes bulged. He held his breath.

Scarlet—his ever-loving and so damn sensible wife—had turned her back to them and stripped down her sporty swimsuit, showing everyone her naked back side. The suit peeled down as her hips swayed and then, just like that, that wonderful bare and freckled ass of hers appeared. For everyone to see. Cody saw it. Byron saw it. Philippe saw it for sure.

Philippe stood and Sully looked to him. Philippe was one-hundred percent into going swimming with Scarlet. And shit, if Scarlet was going skinny, then Philippe was going skinny, too.

* * *

Byron reeled seeing Scarlet's bare backside—worse when he caught a brief and dim glimpse of the strawberry twist of her sex flesh between her thighs. This was Scarlet, his wife's best friend, a person who had dinner at his house a few times a year, a person who he never thought he'd see naked in his lifetime. And he fucking loved it. His heart pounded and he looked to Sully, smiling awkwardly. But Sully wasn't looking his way, Sully was watching Philippe who stood now, joining in.

"Sounds like a great plan," Philippe said, untied the waistband string holding his swim trunks up and then shoved them down to his knees and stepped out of them. That enormous hairy penis swung against his thighs as he folded up his trunks and tossed them to the seat where he'd been.

Scarlet smiled, looking at Philippe's naked ass, then aside to Chey. "You coming?"

* * *

Byron's stupid eyeballs were going all over Scarlet's body, and she wanted to jump up and get between them. Byron never once expressed an ounce of interest in Scarlet in his life. The problem was in her own brain. The problem was the complex hydra posed by Carla. If it freaks you out for Byron to be with me, why don't you try to get Scarlet to sleep with him instead. Scarlet knew what they'd done. Scarlet knew and didn't hate it. Didn't hate it at all. And now this. Now Scarlet went naked, standing like it wasn't too big a deal, buck naked in the hot sun a few feet from everyone watching.

Philippe was game, getting up and taking his shorts off. Any chance for him to show off that enormous penis, the guy seemed to take it. She couldn't blame him—just look at meek Lily. Eyes averted, blushing, so worried Arlo would catch her taking a look. And yet, Lily did take a look. As soon as

Philippe untied that knot on his waistband, Lily's eyes moved between his legs, waiting to catch a glimpse.

"Uh, yeah, I guess so," Chey said to Scarlet, her eyes going to Byron—who should be ashamed of himself the way he was staring at Scarlet's pussy. She gritted her teeth and said to her husband, "Hey, over here." Byron looked, face showing guilt, knowing he'd been busted. "You want to come swimming with me today?" There was a purposeful tone that implied something unsaid: *or did you want to stay by yourself and rub lotion on Carla's naked back, and who knows, maybe she'll touch your dumb pecker and make you ejaculate again?*

But then she smiled, seeing something honest in his eyes. Fear. Things were getting a little too crazy for Byron and he was innocent. Somehow, seeing his big brown eyes on her, registering his compassion and a little bit of a lost puppy dog thing he had going, sharing a wild experience with him didn't seem so treacherous. Fuck, she'd be crazy not to acknowledge that if anyone should be mad over the other one's lecherous behavior, it would have to be him or her. And somehow, thinking that, it didn't seem like such a bad idea for Byron to be with Scarlet. She trusted them both, and both of them cared about her.

Before Byron could answer, she held out a hand, and wiggled her fingers. "I'm not taking no for an answer, babe. Come on with me, you are going swimming."

Byron said, "Do I have to take my trunks off?"

She took his hand and got him to stand. "You don't have to. Everything at your own speed. But we'll sure have a lot more fun if you're not wearing a thing."

* * *

Byron chuckled and rose to face his wife. "We are in this together," he whispered so only she could hear.

He shoved down his own swim trunks and tossed them on the lounge. Sully was shocked and disgusted, not enjoying getting a look at Byron's half-hard dick. Sure, Sully had streaked for them all during the Truth or Dare, but they'd been drinking, it was late at night, and he'd been on the lower level, a good distance from them. He said to Sully, "You're not shy all of a sudden, are you?"

Sully didn't smile, he wasn't looking at Byron's junk at all, he was looking between Byron and Cheyenne, at his wife, who now was talking to Philippe as they headed to the stairs that would take them down to the swim deck. Both of them naked.

"You should come," he said to Sully, now pale as a ghost. "Bring some beers and a football. What do you say?"

Sully's eyes tugged away from his wife and a man with a huge cock swinging between his legs and struggled to speak.

Chey disrobed. Right in front of Sully, Cheyenne pulled her top off and undid her bikini bottoms, and got naked. And just like Byron couldn't pull his eyes from Scarlet's cooch, here was Sully, eye level with Cheyenne's close-cropped growler, blinking and for sure getting hard. Chey reached a hand out to Sully, offering the same way she'd encouraged Byron. "Let's go, Sully," she said.

Byron turned to Cody and Carla. "What, you two prudes going to stay here and do crosswords?" His cock was growing and he didn't care. Cody was looking at it. Cody got a good look at what Byron put inside Carla last night and knew now he had nothing to worry about. And also probably knew Byron did have something to worry about.

But he wasn't bothered. In fact, he was thrilled. As scary as this could be, it was also a hell of a lot of fun.

Cody looked at Carla, then back to Byron. "We'll be down in a bit. "

* * *

Arlo watched the strange look Byron gave Cody.

This wasn't the first time this trip that Arlo had this weird feeling there were things happening between their friends that were hidden from view. Lily said the same thing. He agreed right away. Both of them before bed last night had tried to surmise what was swimming below the surface but neither came up with a scenario the other would feel safe investing in.

And now this.

He exchanged a look with Lily, and she showed in her keen eyes that she was on the same page as him. There were things happening in front of them but their viewpoint was foggier than the others. The nudity definitely supported his own interior musings on the matter. This was some sort of sexual thing.

The fact he thought it might be a *sexual* thing was kept from Lily. He'd hate for her to think such a thing would occur to her upright husband. What he feared most was that the same terrible thought had occurred to Lily, just as to him, and it made sense to Lily, as well, to keep such salacious thoughts to oneself.

As the others departed, all of them naked but for Sully, Arlo leaned forward to look past Lily and say to Carla, "What's got into them?"

Cody chuckled and lounged in his chair, slimming his eyes as his face turned to the sun. "Somebody slipped some Spanish Fly into the water

supply, if you ask me.”

Carla laughed at Cody’s comment then grinned at him. She said to Cody, “That might explain it, babe.” Cody smiled.

Carla looked back to Arlo, then to Lily, then back to Arlo. “So good to see you guys, I mean it. It’s been a horrible year. We really missed you.”

Lily cocked her head with affection, always a big fan of Carla’s charm and confidence. “This last week was so hard. We couldn’t wait for this trip.”

Carla practically purred, her long-lash eyes going to happy lines as she regarded Lily. “I couldn’t wait, either. Two weeks with my Lily.” Carla reached to take Lily’s hand, then leaned closer to kiss the back of it. Lily chuckled. Arlo got a good look at Carla’s pillowy bosom mashing together and struggling against her bikini top.

Cody caught him looking and Arlo felt his cheeks blush. Cody sat up, then scooted to sit at the bottom of the lounge.

Cody said, “What say we leave those high-schoolers to their shenanigans today and the four of us do some adult activities. What do you guys say?” He smiled wide, looking from Arlo to Lily. Lily loved the idea. Lily looked at Arlo and her expression showed joy at the possibility. Arlo nodded, so happy to see that look on his wife’s face.

Lily said, “Maybe we could go out on the jet-skis?”

Cody leaned forward, totally engaged. “You’d like that?”

Carla rolled her eyes. “Now you’ve got him going. Anything to do with going fast on a gas-powered machine and Cody is all in. Lily just said Cody’s magic words.” Carla looked past Lily, who was absolutely beaming, and said to Arlo, “While these two hot-rod around the lake, what do you say you and I cook up some lunch? You’re a chef, Arlo. Maybe you’d be kind

enough to teach me a thing or two.” Even though she cocked her head in a compassionate, *friendly* manner, there was something unnerving in the almost predatory way Carla smiled. “What do you say? We can use the grill out on the deck, get some sun, enjoy the weather. I know my way around a kitchen, as they say, but I’m *always* open to learn some new tricks.”

AFTERWORD

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